CHENNAI - THURSDAY - OCTOBER 1, 2026

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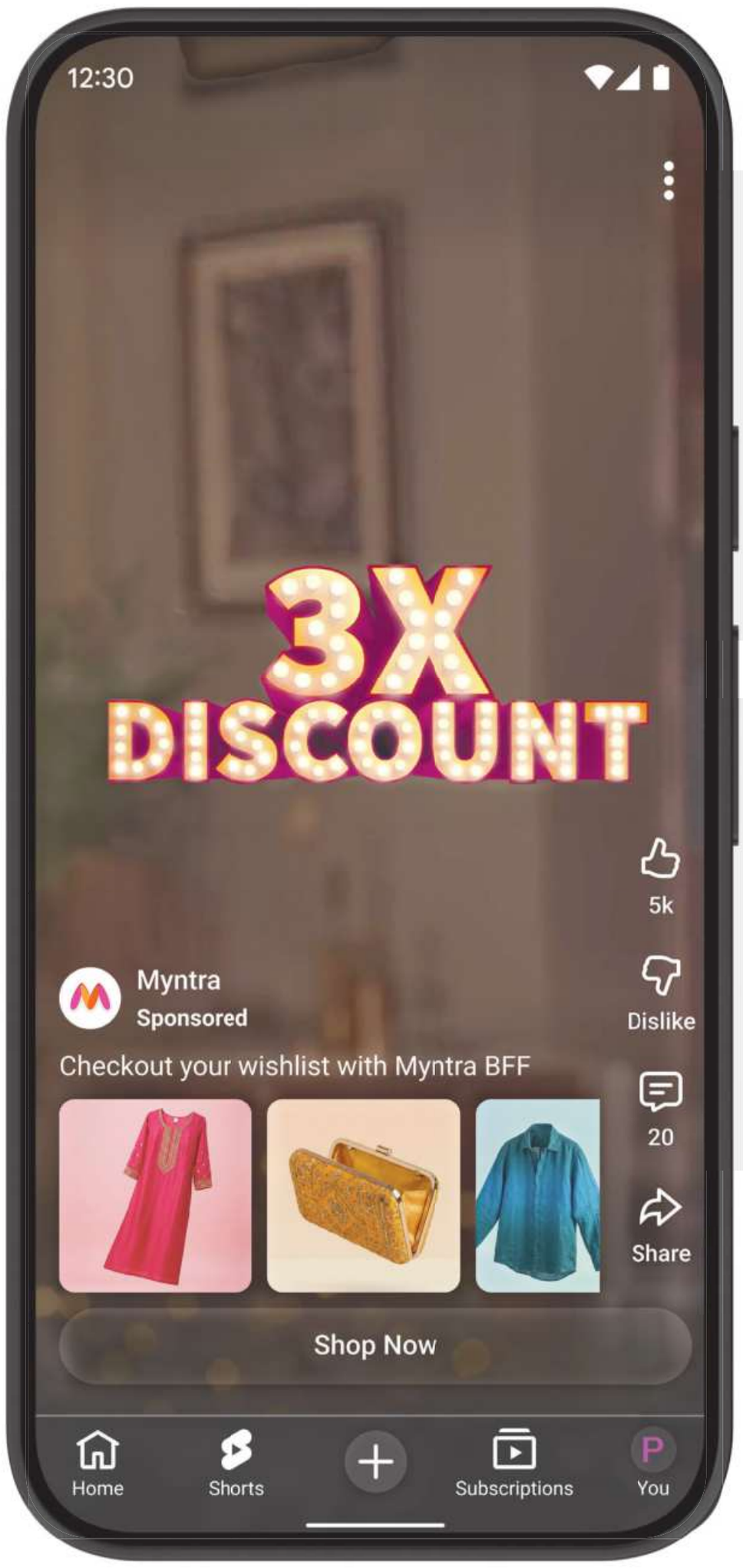
Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

YouTube

From sweet indulgences to trending fits

Turn every scroll into festive business growth



Myntra

Delivered **60%** lower cost per reach with **YouTube Shorts First Position**

Mondelēz International

Drove **40%** incremental reach with **YouTube Shorts First Position**

Maximise ROI this festive season

Simulated UI for creative purposes. Results may vary. Some elements edited or created with AI

Drive festive business growth

YouTube

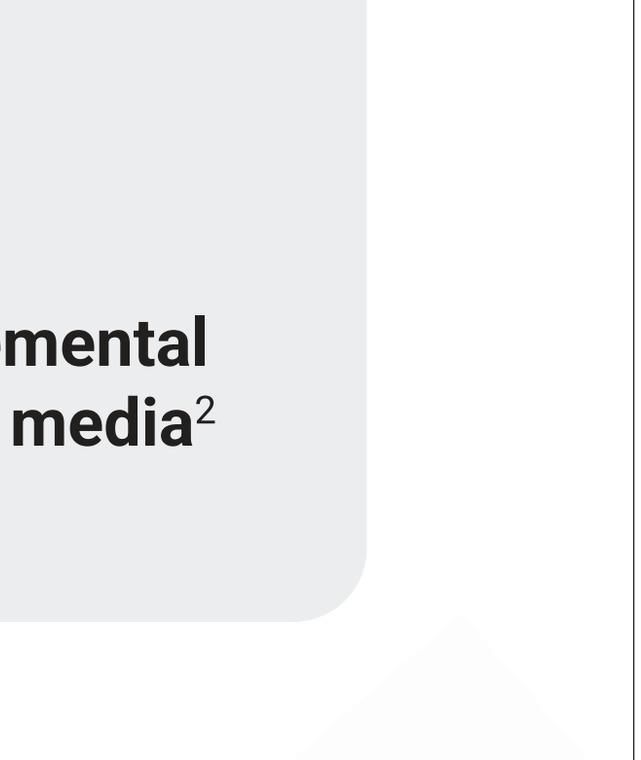
45%

of **YouTube Shorts** users in India don't use Instagram Reels[1]

2.3x

YouTube drives 2.3x **incremental ROAS** compared to **social media**[2]

Maximise ROI this festive season



Sources:
1. GWI, IN, 2025
2. Equity-to-Sales MMM Meta Analysis commissioned by Google, 2021-2023

*Some elements edited or created with AI

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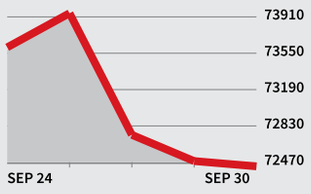

IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	22620.45	-95.75
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	19.24	-0.01
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.83	-0.15
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	147296.00	+220
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	220435.00	-1165

TECHNOPHILE.

iPhone 18 Pro Max raises the bar with variable aperture camera and sweeping hardware upgrades **p4**

INDIA DEBUT.

Apple Pay launches in the country, enabling app, online and store payments for users **p12**

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Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

QUICKLY.

SEPTEMBER ROUT

Nifty posts worst monthly fall in eight years

Mumbai: Equities ended the first half of FY27 under pressure, with September emerging the weakest month for the Nifty 50 since 2018 as elevated crude prices, higher global bond yields and sustained foreign selling weighed on sentiment. The Nifty 50 closed September at 22,620.45, down 6.1 per cent during the month. For the first half, NSE 50 index gained 1.3 per cent. FPIs turned risk-averse, amid inflation worries as oil prices surged above $100 forcing global central banks to hike rates. **p8**

DESPITE HEADWINDS

India Inc's credit quality remains resilient in H1

Mumbai: India Inc's credit quality remained resilient in the first half of FY27 despite prolonged geopolitical tensions, supply chain disruptions, volatile energy prices and inflationary pressures, as reflected in the credit metrics released by major rating agencies. **p3**

CAFE-III norms notified, push for fuel-efficient PVs

NEW RULES. No small-car benefit; super-credits for EVs, alternative-fuel vehicles

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

CLEANER FLEETS

- CAFE-III drops small-car carve-out, adopts weight-based targets
- Revised formula eases compliance for lighter fleets
- Heavier SUVs face progressively stricter emissions targets
- EVs, hybrids receive generous compliance multipliers

After much deliberation since April 2024, the Centre on Wednesday notified the third phase of Corporate Average Fuel Economy (CAFE-III) norms that end the debate of small versus big cars or electric vehicles versus non-EVs by replacing the proposed special carve-out for cars below 909 kg with a weight-based formula that still gives lighter fleets a softer target without creating a separate small-car category.

The September 2025 draft had proposed a 3 g/km CO_2 concession for petrol cars weighing up to 909 kg (with engine capacity not exceeding 1200cc), a provision that disproportionately benefited Maruti Suzuki and triggered opposition from Tata, Mahindra and other automakers.

MORE HEADROOM

The final rules raise the reference weight to 1,229 kg and flatten the weight adjustment, effectively giving smaller/lighter cars more headroom while making the targets progressively tougher for heavier sports utility vehicles. For example, a 909-kg car gets an FY28 target of 82.8 g/km under the final formula, against about 76 g/km under the earlier draft, while the target for a 2,500-kg vehicle is 142.4 g/km (151.4 g/km) — a redesign that settles the carve-out dispute without abandoning the recognition that lighter cars consume less fuel.

CLEANER POWERTRAIN

At the same time, the notification uses CAFE compliance math to push the industry towards cleaner powertrains rather than mandating an EV share: A battery EV counts as three vehicles for fleet calculation, range-extended EVs also get 3x, plug-in hybrids, flex-fuel, or strong hybrids 2.5x, strong hybrid EV 1.6x, and flex-fuel vehicles 1.1x.

Thus, a manufacturer can offset a heavier ICE/SUV fleet by selling more EVs or hybrids, making electrification and hybridisation a regulatory compliance as well as a product strategy. The introduction of tradable credits and two compliance blocks further allows manufacturers with cleaner fleets to generate surplus credits while those falling short can buy them, creating a market mechanism around the transition. OEMs will be permitted to offset any debit balance accumulated in their respective passbooks through the buyout of credits from the Bureau of Energy Efficiency. The prices of such credits are fixed at ₹2,500 for FY28; ₹3,000 for FY29; ₹3,500 for FY30; ₹4,000 for FY31; and ₹4,500 for FY32, the Ministry of Power said.

The CAFE-III norms will come into effect from April 1, 2027 and remain applicable for five years up to March 31, 2032. The new norms will apply to new passenger vehicles (PVs) manufactured or imported for sale in India.

The list of recognised fuel-conservation technologies has also been significantly expanded from four to 12 technologies in the final notification.

Shenu Agarwal, President, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers, said that the regulation lays down a structured roadmap with aggressive annual targets for next five years for the auto industry along with a market-based compliance mechanism.

More reports **p2**

Tata Trusts asks Charity Commissioner for hearing on Srinivasan's complaint

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Noel Tata, Chairman of Tata Trusts

Tata Trusts has asked the Charity Commissioner of Maharashtra (CCM) to hear it before passing any order on complaint of mis-governance in the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT).

Tata Trusts filed a caveat with CCM following trustee Venu Srinivasan's plea to restrict him from voting in Tata Sons Annual General Meeting (AGM).

Sir Ratan Tata Trust (SRTT), which is the second-largest shareholder, is already facing a regulatory probe and has been barred from holding meetings since May following Srinivasan's complaint. His latest objections escalate tensions that have divided the trustees on issues such as the listing of Tata Sons and the reappointment of N Chandrasekaran as Tata Sons Chairman for a third term. Tata Trusts did not comment on the developments. Srinivasan's complaint stems from issues surrounding the contentious Tata Sons board meeting of September 17.

'POWER GRAB MOVE'

In his complaint, Srinivasan said the SDTT tried to prevent him from participating in and voting on the issue of the listing of Tata Sons at a board meeting by issuing a circular. Srinivasan described this action as an attempt at power grab within the SDTT and, through it, to dictate what Tata Sons should do instead of allowing its board to objectively evaluate the available alternatives on their merits.

Srinivasan said Tata's views urging the board to explore options other than listing, and his involvement in discussions with the Shapoorji Pallonji Group over monetisation of its 18 per cent stake, raised concerns about the direct involvement of the SDTT in the commercial affairs of Tata Sons. This also poses risks to the charitable status of Tata Trusts, he said.

"Such conduct constitutes mismanagement of the affairs and property of the SDTT and a breach of duties owed by its trustees," he said. He has demanded an immediate inquiry into the administration of the SDTT, the appointment of Noel Tata as its Chairman, and the circumstances surrounding his son Neville's appointment to the board.

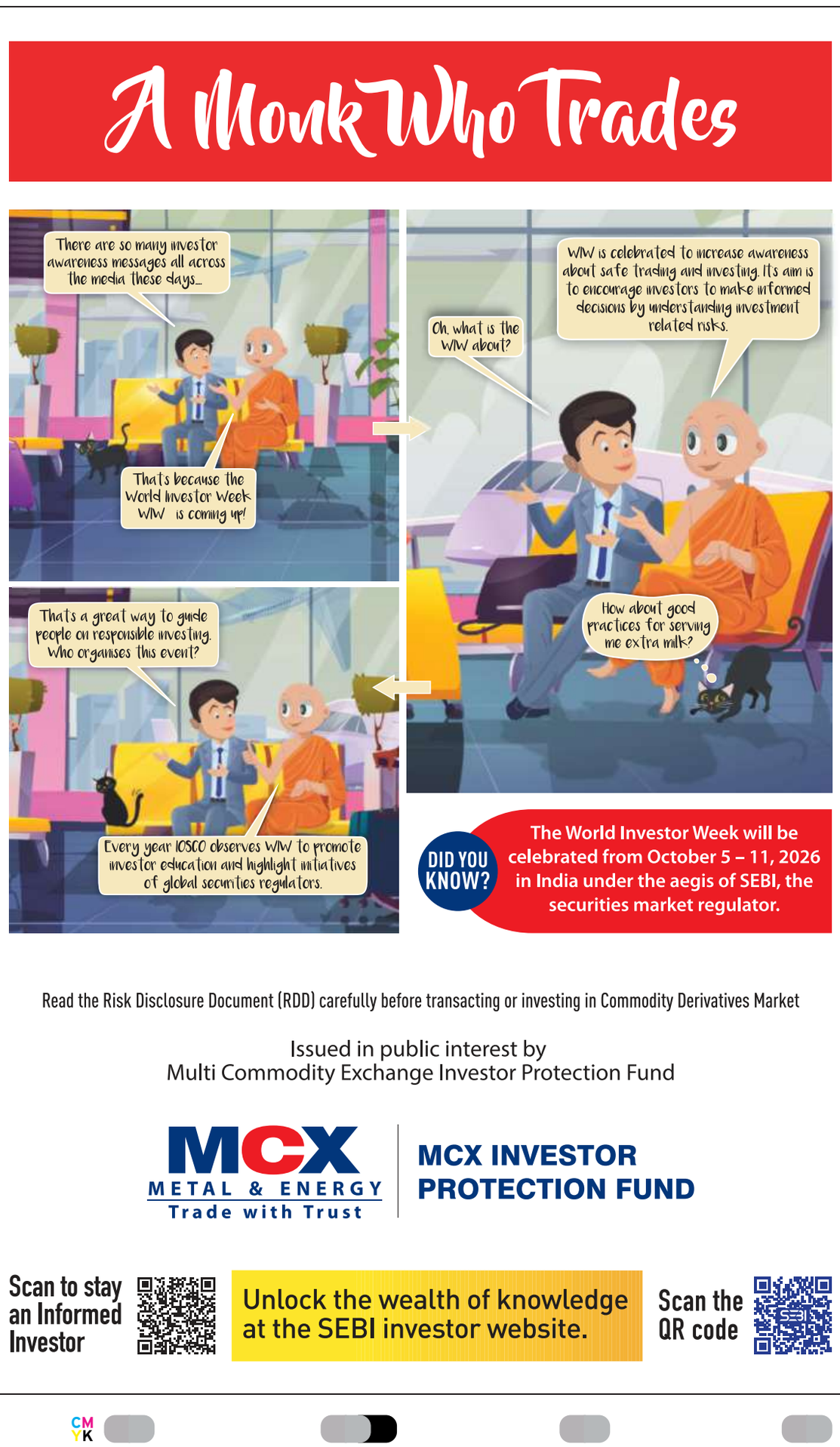
RESTRAINING ORDER

Importantly, he has asked the CCM to direct Noel Tata not to participate in or vote at any meeting concerning the appointment of a nominee or proxy for the Tata Sons AGM.

Vijay Singh files complaint against SDTT

A second complaint has been filed against Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) by former defence secretary and its trustee Vijay Singh. Sources said Singh's complaint is identical to the one filed by Venu Srinivasan which raises issues of lapses in governance at the Trust.

Singh was inducted into Tata Trusts in 2018. He was a trustee of Sir Ratan Tata Trust as well and stepped down from the position a few days before the end of his term in August. OUR BUREAU



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EVs should have been the destination, we missed it: Amitabh Kant on CAFE-III

SPOTLIGHT SCATTERED. Multiple compliance pathways dilute India's push towards electrification, says former NITI Aayog CEO

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India missed an opportunity to make electric vehicles the clear destination of its new fuel-efficiency regime, former NITI Aayog CEO Amitabh Kant said on Wednesday.

Instead, the final Corporate Average Fuel Economy (CAFE) III norms gave carmakers multiple routes, including hybrids, ethanol, CNG and efficiency credits to meet their targets, he said, while also questioning the Bureau of Energy Efficiency's (BEE) role in administering a mechanism to address compliance shortfalls.

"This was the moment to pole vault. We missed it," Kant said after the Ministry of Power notified the final CAFE norms. "EVs become one option among many when they should be the destination. The regulation follows the industry instead of leading it."

> This was the moment to pole vault... The regulation follows the industry instead of leading it
>
> **AMITABH KANT**
> Former CEO, NITI Aayog

'TECH-NEUTRAL'

Kant's objection goes to the basic design of CAFE-III. The government has chosen what it calls a "future-ready, technology-neutral and flexible regulatory framework", allowing manufacturers to decide how they meet progressively tougher fuel-efficiency targets.

Battery and range-extended EVs receive the highest 3x volume multiplier, but they are not the only technologies rewarded.

Plug-in hybrids and flex-fuel strong hybrids get 2.5x, conventional strong hybrids 1.6x, and flex-fuel ethanol vehicles 1.1x.

Biofuels provide another route. Flex-fuel ethanol vehicles receive a 22.3 per cent carbon-neutrality factor, eligible E20 or higher petrol vehicles get 8 per cent and CNG gets at least 5 per cent.

The government says these alternatives are deliberate, describing biofuels as an "additional pathway" for improving fleet-level CAFE performance alongside vehicle-efficiency improvements and electrification.

Kant's argument is that India should have gone further. With the country heavily dependent on imported oil while simultaneously building battery and EV manufacturing capacity, he says regulation should steer automakers towards electrification rather than leave EVs competing with several other compliance pathways.

Separately, Amit Bhatt, the India MD of the International Council on Clean Transportation, said: "The headline stringency is real, but the flexibilities stack up."

BEE ROLE QUESTIONED

The former NITI Aayog CEO has also challenged the compliance-credit mechanism. The final framework allows manufacturers facing compliance gaps to use eligible carried-forward credits, trade credits with other manufacturers or use a buy-out mechanism administered by BEE.

"How can BEE sell credits? A regulator can't be a player in the market it regulates," said Kant.

For Kant, the dispute therefore is not simply about how tough CAFE III is. It is about where the regulation is intended to take India's automobile industry.

Industry welcomes norms, says can offer choices to customers

WHAT VETERANS SAID

- Enables to plan investments, accelerate innovation and offer compelling range of cleaner mobility solutions: Shailesh Chandra, Tata Motors PV
- A pragmatic, forward-looking framework and a double win for the environment and India's energy security: Velusamy R, M&M
- Aligning to multi pathway approach, BEVs, REEVs, PHEVs, SHEVs and FFVs have all been fairly recognised: Vikram Gulati, Toyota Kirloskar Motor
- An important regulatory push for the next phase of India's ethanol journey: Deepak Ballani, ISMA

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

With the Corporate Average Fuel Economy (CAFE-III) norms in place now, the automobile industry on Wednesday said it will not only ensure reduction of the overall fuel consumption from new passenger vehicles (PVs), but also give the industry an opportunity to work on various technology pathways.

THE WAY FORWARD

"CAFE-III regulation lays down a structured roadmap with aggressive annual targets for next five years for the auto industry along with a market-based compliance mechanism," said Shenu Agarwal, President of the Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers.

"This will not only ensure the reduction of overall fuel consumption from new PVs but also provide an opportunity to the industry to work on various technology pathways providing multiple choices to the consumers."

The continued recognition of zero-emission technologies reinforces the critical role of electrification in achieving India's long-term decarbonisation objectives, said Shailesh Chandra, MD and CEO, Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles.

Velusamy R, President-Automotive Business, Mahindra & Mahindra, said, "The targets are appropriately ambitious and provide a clear trajectory through 2031-32. We also welcome the inclusion of a compliance block, technology credits, cleaner-fuel benefits and super credits for EVs and other advanced technologies... This is a pragmatic, forward-looking framework and a double win for the environment and India's energy security."

Toyota Kirloskar Motor's Country Head and Executive Vice-President Vikram Gulati also said the new regulation takes due cognisance of the importance of various clean technologies using an objective and scientific-based assessment methodology to arrive at a regulation that is best suited for our national interests.

"The provisions for credit trading, pooling and flexible compliance mechanisms offer manufacturers greater flexibility while promoting innovation, investment and competitiveness in India's transition towards sustainable mobility," Tarun Garg, MD and CEO, Hyundai Motor India, said.

According to Rahul Bharti, Senior Executive Officer, Corporate Affairs at Maruti Suzuki India, the regulation recognises the contribution of multiple powertrain technologies and fuels encouraging multi-faceted R&D and innovation. "A credit/debit mechanism is an improvisation over the previous CAFE-II regulation," he added.

GREATER FUEL CHOICE

The agricultural sector has also welcomed the development, saying the recognition of ethanol-based mobility is an important step towards encouraging greater fuel and technology choice in India.

"These measures can help create additional avenues for utilising India's growing ethanol capacity while reducing fossil fuel dependence, strengthening energy security and resilience, and advancing India's journey towards a more self-reliant and low-carbon mobility sector," Deepak Ballani, D-G, Indian Sugar & Bio-energy Manufacturers Association, said.

According to Vijendra Singh, President, All India Distillers' Association, CAFE-III norms give automakers greater clarity to plan and invest in flex-fuel technologies. "CAFE-III is not just an auto-sector regulation; it creates a formal policy bridge between India's expanding ethanol ecosystem and the future of clean mobility."

What does CAFE-III norms mean for carmakers, buyers?

bl.explainer

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

The objective of CAFE-III norms is straightforward: reduce fuel consumption, lower oil imports and cut carbon emissions from the country's rapidly growing vehicle fleet.

Will the car I buy after April 1, 2027 be much more fuel-efficient?

That is what CAFE-III is designed to push carmakers towards; but it does not guarantee dramatically higher mileage from every new car.

From April 1, manufacturers must meet progressively tougher average fuel-efficiency targets across the cars they sell. The benchmark starts at 3.996 litres/100 km in 2027-28 and tightens to 3.3273 litres by 2031-32, a 16.7 per cent improvement over five years. Put simply, that is equivalent to roughly 25 km/litre initially and 30 km/litre by 2031-32.

What is CAFE-III?

Think of CAFE as a fuel-efficiency and emissions exam for carmakers. Instead of every car having to score the same marks, the manufacturer gets one report card based on the average performance of its fleet. CAFE III runs from April 1, 2027, to March 31, 2032 and replaces the current CAFE-II regime.

What is the big change for small cars?

The September 2025 draft gave cars below 909 kg a special relaxation of 3 g CO_2/km. That concession is gone. Instead, the final formula changes the slope used to calculate targets. Under the earlier proposal, its target would have been 54.1 g/km after the relaxation. Under the final formula, it becomes 63.7 g/km, nearly 18 per cent more headroom. The flatter curve provides relatively softer targets for lighter vehicles and demands greater efficiency from heavier vehicles. This help small car-heavy portfolios such as Maruti Suzuki, Renault, and Nissan, while heavier SUV fleets have more efficiency improvement to find.

What changes for EVs and hybrids?

EVs remain powerful compliance tools, but their relative advantage has narrowed. The earlier proposal contemplated a 4x multiplier for BEVs; the final framework gives them 3x while extending benefits to other technologies. So selling 10,000 BEVs effectively counts as 30,000 in the CAFE calculation. REEVs also get 3x; plug-in hybrids and flex-fuel strong hybrids 2.5x, strong hybrids 1.6x and flex-fuel vehicles 1.1x.

"The multiplier is earned by label, not by capability," said Randheer Singh, former Director, Electric Mobility at NITI Aayog, and Founder of ForeSee Consulting. He argued that the multipliers are not explicitly graduated by battery capacity, electric range or actual electric-driving capability.

Where do ethanol and CNG fit?

They now provide additional compliance routes. The framework recognises ethanol-blended petrol, biofuels and CBG through Carbon Neutrality Factors, while the number of recognised fuel-conservation technologies expands from four to 12.

What if a carmaker misses its target?

There is more time to recover. Instead of annual penalty calculations, CAFE-III creates two compliance blocks (three years and two years), allowing a deficit in one year to be offset by surplus performance within the block. Better-performing OEMs can also trade credits with those falling short, while the framework provides for BEE credit purchases at ₹2,500-4,500 per g/km.

Range-extender EVs, hybrids to get more compliance options

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

India's final CAFE-III norms have opened two powerful compliance pathways for carmakers: super credits for electrified powertrains and separate carbon-neutrality benefits for biofuels, potentially strengthening the regulatory case for technologies ranging from JSW MG's planned range extenders to Maruti Suzuki's flex-fuel vehicles and Toyota's ethanol-hybrid offerings.

In simple terms, 10,000 qualifying REEVs generate an effective volume of 30,000 in the fleet-average calculation. The manufacturer does not sell an additional 20,000 vehicles; rather, the multiplier gives those vehicles three times their actual weight in the compliance formula. The actual compliance benefit, however, depends on their certified fuel or energy consumption relative to the manufacturer's broader fleet.

WHO BENEFITS?

The provisions give JSW MG's range-extender strategy added regulatory relevance. The company's MG ADAPT platform is designed to support BEVs, HEVs, PHEVs and REEVs.

In a REEV, the electric motor drives the wheels, while a small petrol engine acts solely as a generator to produce electricity when needed. A qualifying REEV receives the same 3x volume multiplier as a BEV despite having an onboard engine, providing makers with another route to address charging and range concerns.

THE UPSIDE. The framework allows manufacturers to combine EVs, REEVs, hybrids, ethanol, CNG and other technologies rather than rely on a single powertrain pathway BIJOY GHOSH

Maruti Suzuki has a different pathway. Its Wagon R flex-fuel prototype is compatible with fuel blends ranging from E20 to E100 and has been homologated on E85, per the company.

A qualifying flex-fuel vehicle receives a 1.1x volume multiplier, meaning 10,000 vehicles are counted as 11,000 for compliance calculations. In addition, it benefits from the 22.3 per cent carbon-neutrality factor accorded to ethanol fuels. Maruti's sizeable CNG portfolio provides another compliance lever alongside hybrids and EVs.

Toyota has already showcased a flex-fuel strong-hybrid version of the Innova HyCross at the Advantage Maharashtra Expo earlier this year. A qualifying model will receive the 2.5x multiplier applicable to flex-fuel strong hybrids, while benefiting from the carbon-neutrality treatment available for ethanol-compatible vehicles.

Carbon-neutrality factors and technology credits can each reduce a manufacturer's reported fleet-average fuel consumption, said Amit Bhatt of ICCT. Taken together, these provisions could mean the real-world reduction in fuel use and emissions is considerably lower than the headline targets suggest.

QUICKLY.

AM Green secures €585 m green ammonia deal

Hyderabad: AM Green Ammonia (India) has been selected as the sole winner of the Asian lot in the H2Global auction run by HINT.CO GmbH, securing a long-term purchase agreement for the supply of Renewable Fuels of Non-Biological Origin (RFNBO) ammonia to Germany. Over a period of 10 years, Hintco will purchase ammonia from AM Green for a minimum value of €585 million. The ammonia will be produced at AM Green's Kakinada project in Andhra Pradesh. First deliveries to Germany are expected in 2029. OUR BUREAU

TII to invest ₹250 crore in TI Clean Mobility

Chennai: Tube Investments of India (TII) will invest ₹250 crore in its electric mobility subsidiary, TI Clean Mobility Pvt Ltd, through Series C Compulsorily Convertible Preference Shares, as the Murugappa Group firm looks to scale up its clean-mobility business. TII and TICMPL have entered into a subscription agreement for the issue of 2.5 crore Series C CCPS, with a face value of ₹100 each. The company has also entered into an amended and restated shareholders' agreement with investors in TICMPL. OUR BUREAU

IOC's Gujarat refinery to hit targeted capacity by FY27-end

Avinash Nair
Vadodara

After five years of expansion, Indian Oil's refinery in Vadodara, Gujarat, is yet to fully utilise its targeted 18 million tonne-a-year crude-processing capacity.

That's because the downstream units needed to convert crude into finished fuels, lube base stocks and petrochemicals are expected to be commissioned only by the end of FY27.

STILL WORKING. The constraint comes as Indian Oil enters the final phase of its ₹17,825-crore Petrochemicals and Lube Integration Project. The expansion started five years ago BLOOMBERG

SLOW EXPANSION

The refinery currently processes somewhere between its old 13.7 mtpa capacity and the expanded 18 mtpa level, Biplob Biswas, the company's Executive Director and Refinery Head, said on Wednesday. "We can process 18 mtpa of crude even today. But every refinery has primary processing of crude and all the products we obtain from our crude unit go for secondary processing. We will touch 18 mtpa once we complete the secondary processing by the end of this fiscal," he said.

The constraint comes as Indian Oil enters the final phase of its ₹17,825-crore Petrochemicals and Lube Integration Project (LuPech).

"The expansion started five years ago. This being a brownfield expansion, most projects are being executed within the operating units. Last year, the two major revamps that were envisaged in the expansions were executed and commissioned successfully. This year, we have commissioned the first two grassroot units. In the near future, we will be starting the balance block. The last in the line will be the propylene unit," Biswas said.

The polypropylene unit, with a capacity of 5 lakh tonnes a year, is estimated to cost around ₹1,000 crore and will use propylene generated from soft gases.

The polypropylene addition comes at a time when India continues to import significant quantities of the polymer despite having substantial installed capacity.

CRUDE SOURCING

While the refinery's downstream configuration is being expanded, its crude sourcing has also become increasingly diversified. Around 30 per cent of the refinery's crude comes from domestic sources, Biswas said.

"We are gradually diversifying. We have taken some cargoes from the US in the past. Our portfolio remains very diverse. We have also got a couple of cargoes from Venezuela about three months ago," he said.

Asset-light, green and de-risked: The new blueprint behind Essar Group's comeback

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

US President Donald Trump terming Essar-backed Mesabi Metallics' $18-billion Iowa bet as the "largest steel plant in American history," narrates the once debt-laden conglomerate's over decade-long deleveraging and portfolio-restructuring exercise to create a business focussed on a sustainable capital structure, geography, and technology.

THE TURNAROUND

The integrated iron ore mining-to-finished steel push for the Group, controlled by the Ruia family, is in many ways a comeback to its past core expertise. But this time, with an asset light model and a new business strategy.

For instance, Essar purchased $260 million face value notes issued by Mesabi Metallics in 2019, paving the way for Essar Global to once again participate in the low-cost iron ore mining and pellet manufacturing project in Minnesota. Ironically, it was the steel plant in Hazira that triggered Essar's bankruptcy woes. Now, it is betting on integrated steel projects such as the one in the US to script a turnaround.

VERSION 2.0. The integrated iron ore mining-to-finished steel push for the Group, led by Prashant Ruia (right), is in many ways a comeback to its past core expertise BLOOMBERG

The Ruia family now prefers to be smart investors rather than promoters, a clear indication that the focus has shifted from a family-owned business to an eye on returns and shareholder interest. It has repaid more than ₹1.37 lakh crore of debt.

CHANGING PROFILE

The Essar group of the past was asset heavy, with total ownership of all the infrastructure in its portfolio. It still has assets, but it is executing them with partners.

What Essar brings to the table in many of its projects is its expertise, skills, and experience in the sectors, said a company insider. For instance, in February 2023, the group announced a $3.6-billion investment in low carbon energy transition projects. This will be done over five years and, more importantly, it will take on a partner who will provide a considerable portion of the equity.

Another important element is risk mitigation becoming a key strategy. Accordingly, it has de-risked operations by spreading them across India, the UK, the US, Vietnam, and Saudi Arabia. There is a clear focus on spreading steel assets across India, West Asia and the US, while the retail fuel business and low carbon economy is being expanded in the UK.

ENERGY FOCUS

Energy was the focus of the old Essar, and it remains so. "We've been involved in the energy sector for the last 30 years... the idea is to remain focused on energy," Prashant Ruia had told *businessline* in 2023.

The difference is in technologies, with the earlier focus on energy through refineries, exploration, production, downstream and retail. The theme has now changed to decarbonisation, investing in innovative technologies to deliver green and clean energies through renewable sources.

Essar is now poised to leverage these new assets with the latest, more efficient, and ESG-compliant technologies to last the next several decades.

The main assets under energy include a 10 million tonnes per annum refinery in the UK, 15 trillion cubic feet of reserves of unconventional hydrocarbons in India and Vietnam, and a 1,200 MW power plant in India. Infrastructure assets include a storage terminal in the UK of 3 million cubic meters capacity and a 20 mtpa port in India.

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QUICKLY.

Modi, Trump discuss trade ties over phone

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi and US President Donald Trump on Wednesday held telephonic conversation and agreed to maintain "close engagement" for taking Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership between the two countries forward. "Had a productive conversation with President Trump," Modi announced through a post on X. "We reviewed our bilateral cooperation in trade, defence, energy, critical technologies and other areas," he elaborated. OUR BUREAU

Govt keeps small savings rates unchanged

New Delhi: The government on Wednesday left interest rates unchanged for various small savings schemes, including PPF and NSC, for the 10th straight quarter, beginning October 1, 2026. PTI

External debt up at $778.2 b in June quarter

Mumbai: India's external debt rose by $15.4 billion to $778.2 billion at the end of June quarter 2026 as compared to the previous March quarter, according to RBI data. However, the external debt to GDP ratio moderated to 20.8 per cent at end-June 2026 from 20.9 per cent on March 31, 2026. Excluding the valuation effect, external debt would have increased by $16.4 billion instead of $15.4 billion at end-June 2026 over end-March 2026," RBI said. PTI

Mahesh Muralidhar Pai to head South Indian Bank

Kochi: South Indian Bank has announced that Mahesh Muralidhar Pai will take charge as its Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer from October 1. Mahesh Pai brings nearly three decades of experience across various facets of banking. OUR BUREAU

India Inc's credit quality stays resilient in first half of FY27

WORD OF CAUTION. West Asia crisis, higher oil prices may weigh on credit profiles in H2, warn rating agencies

Our Bureau
Mumbai

India Inc's credit quality remained resilient in the first half of FY27 despite prolonged geopolitical tensions, supply chain disruptions, volatile energy prices and inflationary pressures, as reflected in the credit metrics released by major rating agencies.

However, Crisil Ratings, ICRA, CareEdge Ratings and India Ratings & Research (Ind-Ra) cautioned that escalating tensions in West Asia, higher crude oil prices, deficient monsoon rainfall and global trade uncertainties could pressure corporate credit profiles in the second half of the fiscal year.

CREDIT METRICS

- Crisil Ratings' credit ratio improved to 2.18 times in H1FY27 from 1.50 times in H2FY26
- ICRA's credit ratio stood at 3.2 times in H1FY27
- CareEdge reported the strongest improvement, with its credit ratio rising to 3.95 times from 1.93 times in H2FY26
- In H1FY27, Ind-Ra upgraded 190 issuers and downgraded 63, resulting in an upgrade-to-downgrade ratio of 3.0 times

REAFFIRMATION RATE

Crisil Ratings' credit ratio, measuring upgrades relative to downgrades, improved to 2.18 times in H1FY27 from 1.50 times in H2FY26. The agency recorded 464 upgrades against 213 downgrades, with infrastructure-linked sectors accounting for nearly 40 per cent of upgrades. Downgrades were concentrated in ceramics and polyester textiles.

Its reaffirmation rate remained steady at around 81 per cent, highlighting the resilience of corporate credit quality despite geopolitical uncertainty. The upgrade rate of 13 per cent was marginally above the decadal average of 11 per cent, while the downgrade rate of 6 per cent was in line with long-term trends.

According to Crisil, Indian corporates have mitigated the impact of the seven-month-long West Asia conflict by diversifying sourcing channels, reworking logistics networks and selectively passing on higher costs. Combined with healthy balance sheets, reflected in a median debt-to-equity ratio of around 0.5 times, this has helped contain broader credit stress.

Subodh Rai, Managing Director, Crisil Ratings, said, "These strengths, operational adaptability and robust balance sheets, have been reinforced by strong domestic demand, recovering exports and targeted policy support, such as Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme 5.0. Together, they have enabled companies to partially, and in some cases fully, pass on cost increases and manage cash flow pressures."

ICRA's credit ratio stood at 3.2 times in H1FY27, unchanged from the previous half and well above its decade average of 1.5 times. While the annualised upgrade rate moderated to 14 per cent from 17 per cent in FY26, the annualised downgrade rate fell to a multi-year low of 4 per cent.

"Indian corporates enter H2 FY2027 from a position of strength, supported by healthy balance sheets and substantial liquidity buffers," said K Ravichandran, Executive Vice-President and Chief Rating Officer, ICRA.

DOMESTIC DRIVE

CareEdge Ratings reported the strongest improvement, with its credit ratio rising to 3.95 times from 1.93 times in H2FY26.

The agency recorded 300 upgrades against 76 downgrades.

"The domestic economy, meanwhile, delivered a stronger-than-expected performance despite global headwinds. Buoyant consumption, a pickup in investment, a healthy external position and India Inc's leaner balance sheets give us confidence in the resilience of the Indian economy looking ahead in fiscal 2027," added Sachin Gupta, Executive Director and Chief Rating Officer, CareEdge Ratings.

Ind-Ra said corporate credit profiles remained strong for the sixth consecutive year despite the energy shock triggered by the West Asia conflict. In H1FY27, it upgraded 190 issuers and downgraded 63, resulting in an upgrade-to-downgrade ratio of 3.0 times.

While rating agencies expect stronger balance sheets to buffer companies from immediate stress, they remain watchful of rising commodity prices, inflation, weather-related disruptions and global trade risks in the second half of FY27.

India eyes rebalanced ASEAN trade pact in ongoing review

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

ASEAN agreed to a review of AITIGA following India's concerns over the widening trade deficit

India is demanding a more balanced outcome from the ongoing review of its trade pact with the ASEAN bloc, as negotiators seek to resolve outstanding differences at the next round of talks in October ahead of the ASEAN Summit the following month, sources said.

At the recent ASEAN-India Economic Ministers consultation in Manila, ASEAN formally noted India's position that the review of the ASEAN-India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA) should result in a "balanced framework."

DISAGREEMENT PERSIST

"There is an overall acceptance within the bloc that there needs to be more balance in the AITIGA. But disagreements persist over the market access being sought by India to increase its exports and the extent of reciprocal access that ASEAN countries are seeking in the Indian market," a source tracking the matter said.

In 2025–26, bilateral trade between India and ASEAN reached $128.38 billion, with the bloc accounting for 10.55 per cent of India's total global trade, underscoring the importance of the partnership. The bloc, which expanded from ten members to eleven last year, includes Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand, Timor-Leste, and Vietnam.

However, India's trade deficit with the grouping continued to widen, touching $51.55 billion, compared with about $7 billion when the ASEAN-India trade pact was implemented in 2010. India's exports to the bloc were estimated at $38.41 billion, while imports stood at $89.96 billion.

ASEAN agreed to a review of AITIGA following India's concerns over the widening trade deficit between the two partners, but reaching an agreement on the terms of the review has proved difficult. "There were expectations that the AITIGA review would be concluded at last year's ASEAN-India Summit in October 2025, but it was not possible as all differences could not be ironed out," the source said.

At the September 22 ASEAN-India Economic Ministers consultation, attended by senior officials from India and the ASEAN countries, the participants acknowledged the "complexities inherent in the negotiations," reflecting the diverse interests and sensitivities of all parties.

"The meeting reaffirmed its commitment to continue engaging in negotiations in good faith, with a pragmatic and flexible approach," the joint statement said. It added that the outcome of the review should make the agreement more effective, user-friendly, mutually beneficial, and trade-facilitative for businesses, while contributing to deeper regional economic integration and more resilient supply chains.

INDIA'S POSITION

More importantly, the statement specifically noted India's position that the review should result in a balanced framework.

As part of the review, India is seeking to correct tariff asymmetries and remove non-tariff barriers to expand market access for its exports across sectors. It also wants changes to the rules of origin to prevent the circumvention of tariffs by Chinese goods routed through ASEAN while providing greater flexibility to Indian exporters.

While India is seeking greater access for its exports and tighter rules to prevent trade diversion, ASEAN countries are seeking reciprocal access to the Indian market, as well as greater flexibility in rules governing their exports and simpler customs and origin procedures.

Capex grew 18% during April-Aug; fiscal deficit widened to 41% of BE

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

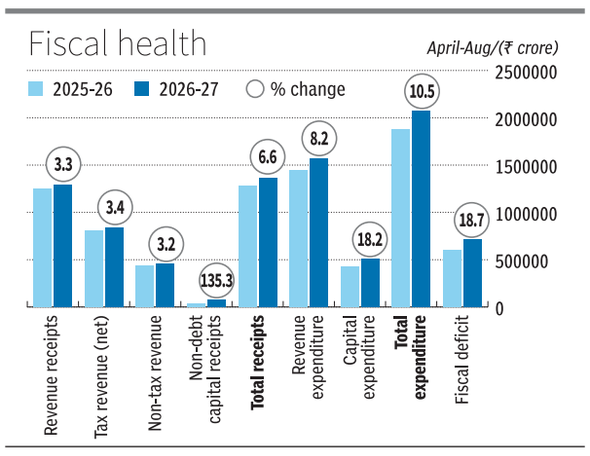
Capital expenditure recorded over 18 per cent growth during the April-August period of the current fiscal, data from Controller General of Accounts (CGA) released on Wednesday showed. However, lower growth of tax collection pushed fiscal deficit over 41 per cent of the Budget Estimates (BE) during the period and experts see pressure on the gap between income and expenditure.

The deficit was at 38.1 per cent of BE of 2025-26 during the corresponding period of last year. In absolute terms, fiscal deficit, or the gap between the government's expenditure and revenue, was over ₹ 7 lakh crore during the five-month period. This is nearly 19 per cent higher than the corresponding period of the last fiscal.

TAX REVENUE UP

According to the CGA, the Centre's net tax revenue up to August 2026 was about ₹ 8.38 lakh crore, or 29.2 per cent of the corresponding BE of 2026-27 of total receipts. In the corresponding period of the previous fiscal year, the net tax revenue was at 28.6 per cent of that year's BE.

The data on monthly accounts showed that the total expenditure during the first five months was at about ₹20.78 lakh crore, or 38.9 per cent of BE. In the year-ago period, it was 37.1 per cent of BE. Experts see mixed trends in government fiscal. According to DK Srivastava, Chief Policy Advisor at EY India, based on fiscal data for five months of 2026-27 provided by the CGA, some fiscal pressures are becoming apparent. The government's gross tax revenues (GTR) in this period showed a y-o-y growth of only 6.5 per cent which translated to a growth of 3.4 per cent in net tax revenues after transfers to the States. Direct taxes showed a fall in their monthly growth rates in August.



However, for the five-month period spanning April to August 2026, corporate income tax (CIT) and personal income tax (PIT) growth were still healthy at 15.4 per cent and 12.3 per cent, respectively. But indirect taxes contracted by (-)2.7 per cent, pulled down mainly by a contraction of (-) 3.4 per cent in GST revenues and of (-)22.6 per cent in excise duties.

On the expenditure side, growth in capital expenditure, though lower than the growth of 29.9 per cent in the first four months, remained healthy at 18.2 per cent during April to August.

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist with Bank of Baroda, opined that given that the economy is expected to grow by a little over 7 per cent in real terms and above 11 per cent in nominal terms, the fiscal deficit ratio should largely be contained in the region of 4.5-4.6 per cent this year assuming some slippage in non-tax revenue due to the OMCs not generating profit.

Cabinet clears green energy corridor scheme

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Cabinet on Wednesday approved the Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III) scheme, which aims to strengthen the Intra-State Transmission System (InSTS) to evacuate up to 135 GW of renewable energy.

The scheme also provides for deployment of 50 GWh of battery energy storage systems (BESS) at the renewable gnergy (RE) generator end for grid flexibility to address intermittency, congestion, peak-hour curtailment, and meet non-solar-hour demand. This will facilitate grid integration and power evacuation within the states.

Targeted for setup by FY33, the scheme's total project outlay is ₹1,86,405 crore, comprising ₹1,36,378 crore for the development of InSTS under GEC-III and ₹50,000 crore for 50 GWh of BESS. The Central Financial Assistance (CFA) of ₹54,082 crore will help offset

Santosh Kumar Sarangi, MNRE Secretary

intra-State transmission charges.

Speaking with reporters, Ministry of New & Renewable Energy (MNRE) Secretary Santosh Kumar Sarangi said that all the greenfield projects under the InSTS component will be implemented through tariff-based competitive bidding mode, while brownfield upgradation and network strengthening works will be executed under cost plus basis.

The state transmission utilities will be the overall implementing agency, and transmission service providers (TSPs) will participate under TBCB on a Build-Own-Operate-Maintain (BOOM) model, he added.

Vineet Mittal, Chairman of Avaada Group, said that bringing transmission and battery storage into one programme recognises that generation, delivery and availability must advance together.

"As storage deployment grows, it can create a larger market for daytime generation. Some batteries will initially absorb surplus electricity from existing plants. As demand and storage utilisation increase, additional renewable generation may be needed to charge them. However, this requires careful planning. Battery capacity alone does not tell us how much new solar must be built. That depends on charging sources, operating cycles, efficiency, local demand and the availability of existing surplus power. We should plan these investments as an integrated system," he told *businessline*.

Sarangi informed that GEC III projects will be monitored at three levels. A project monitoring unit (PMU) will be established at MNRE to track project progress and coordinate closely with the states. In addition, the MNRE Secretary will monitor progress quarterly, while the Cabinet Secretary will review it every six months. The scheme will help achieve the target of 900 GW of installed non-fossil capacity by 2035. The scheme will also contribute to the country's long-term energy security, he added.

MULTI-YEAR PIPELINE

Somesh Kumar, Partner and Leader of Power & Utilities at EY India,, said the focus is increasingly shifting from simply adding renewable generation to ensuring that renewable power can be evacuated, integrated, and delivered reliably.

For the industry, this should create a substantial multi-year pipeline across transmission lines, substations, transformers, grid-flexibility solutions and BESS, he added.

Banks notch up robust 18.8% credit growth in Aug

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Scheduled commercial banks' (SCBs) non-food bank credit grew by a robust 18.8 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) in August 2026, compared to 10.2 per cent in the year ago period on the back of a healthy growth in all four sectors — agriculture and allied activities, industry, services and personal loans, per latest RBI data.

Among the four sectors, the services sector recorded the fastest pace of credit growth (24.3 per cent y-o-y) and the personal loans segment recorded the slowest uptick in credit growth (16.9 per cent y-o-y).

Credit to agriculture and allied activities registered a 17.2 per cent y-o-y growth in the reporting month vis-a-vis 7.6 per cent in the year ago period.

INDUSTRY CREDIT

Credit to industry recorded an 18.2 per cent y-o-y growth (7 per cent in year ago period). In its "Sectoral deployment of bank credit – August 2026' statement, RBI said that while credit to 'large' and 'medium' industries grew at an accelerated pace, 'micro and small' industries sustained steady expansion.

Credit to the services sector registered a healthy 24.3 per cent yoy growth (10.3 per cent), supported by robust growth in segments such as 'non-banking financial companies', 'trade', 'professional services' and 'commercial real estate'.

Credit to personal loans segment recorded a 16.9 per cent growth, as compared with 11.9 per cent a year ago. RBI said that while segments such as 'housing' and 'vehicle loans' sustained double-digit growth, 'credit card outstanding' and 'loans against gold jewellery' decelerated.

The central bank said data on sectoral deployment of bank credit for August was collected from 41 select SCBs which together account for 95 per cent of total non-food credit by all SCBs.

SCBs' robust credit growth in August comes in the backdrop of their weighted average lending rate (WALR) on outstanding rupee loans declining marginally to 8.96 per cent in August from 8.97 per cent in July 2026. However, the WALR on fresh rupee loans of SCBs rose to 8.61 per cent in August (8.52 per cent in July 2026).

Meanwhile, deposits and credit of all scheduled banks declined by ₹2,47,748 crore and ₹58,813 crore, respectively.

Invesco Mutual Fund

Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd.
(CIN: U67190MH2005PTC153471), 2101-A, 21st Floor, A Wing, Marathon Futurex, N. M. Joshi Marg, Lower Parel, Mumbai - 400 013

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NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that Invesco Trustee Pvt. Ltd., (**the Trustee to Invesco Mutual Fund**) has approved the declaration of Income Distribution cum Capital Withdrawal (**'IDCW'**) in the following scheme, the particulars of which are as under:

Name of the Scheme	Plan(s) / Option(s)	Amount of IDCW* (Rs. per unit)	NAV as on September 29, 2026 (Rs. per unit)	Record Date#
Invesco India Balanced Advantage Fund, an open ended dynamic asset allocation fund investing in debt and equity instruments only	Regular Plan - IDCW Option	0.14	16.67	October 6, 2026
	Direct Plan - IDCW Option		21.15	

*Distribution of the above IDCW is subject to the availability of distributable surplus and may be lower to the extent of distributable surplus available on the record date. IDCW payable to the unit holder(s) will be lower to the extent of tax deducted at source, at applicable rates.

#or immediately following Business Day if that day is not a Business Day.

Face Value per unit is Rs. 10/-.

Pursuant to payment of IDCW, the NAV of the IDCW Options of the scheme would fall to the extent of payout and statutory levy, if any.

Unit holders of the aforesaid scheme, whose names appear in the records of the Registrar, KFin Technologies Limited, as at the close of business hours on **Tuesday, October 6, 2026** or immediately following Business Day if that day is not a Business Day (including valid purchase/switch-in application received till 3.00 p.m. on the record date, subject to the entire amount of subscription/ purchase as per the application / switch-in request is available for utilization by the scheme before the cut-off time on the record date) will be entitled to receive the IDCW.

Unit holders holding units in dematerialized (electronic) form whose names appear in the statement of beneficial owners maintained by the Depositories under the aforesaid scheme as at the close of business hours on **Tuesday, October 6, 2026** will be entitled to receive the IDCW.

With regard to Unit holders under IDCW options of the aforesaid scheme, who have opted for IDCW Reinvestment facility, the IDCW due will be reinvested by allotting units for the IDCW amount (net of applicable taxes and stamp duty) (on the next Business Day after the Record Date) at a price based on the prevailing ex-IDCW NAV per unit on the record date.

For **Invesco Asset Management (India) Pvt. Ltd.**
(Investment Manager for Invesco Mutual Fund)

Sd/-
Saurabh Nanavati
Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer

Date: September 30, 2026

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - OCTOBER 1 - 2026

TECH DIGEST.

Adobe rolls out Premiere mobile for Android

Adobe has launched Premiere mobile for Android, expanding its smartphone video-editing app beyond the iPhone. The free app is aimed at creators producing social videos, vlogs, tutorials and podcast clips on the go. Premiere mobile features a multi-track timeline for layering video, music, voice-overs, text and effects, alongside frame-accurate editing for precise cuts. Its Enhance Audio tool reduces background noise and improves voice clarity, while videos can be edited and exported at resolutions of up to 4K.

The app also has Adobe Firefly-powered generative AI tools, including Generative Fill, Image-to-Video and Generate Sound Effects. Adobe says Premiere mobile has no ads or watermarks and does not require a forced login. Core editing tools are free, with paid upgrades available for additional generative AI credits and storage. Upcoming additions include key frames, cropping, beat detection, enhanced captions, Adobe Fonts and the ability to continue mobile projects on Premiere desktop.

The premiere mobile is available on Google Play for devices running Android 13 or later with at least 5GB of RAM.

OpenAI introduces Dots, GPT-6.1 Sol

OpenAI has unveiled more than 20 updates across ChatGPT, its AI models and developer tools, including new autonomous agents and tools for collaborative work and coding.

Among the biggest announcements is Dots, a new class of always-on agents powered by GPT-6 Astra. Dots can use a cloud computer, contextual information and connected apps to execute multi-step tasks in the background. ChatGPT Space is a shared workspace where teams can work with ChatGPT and Dots using the same conversations, files and project context.

OpenAI also introduced GPT-6.1 Sol, aimed at agentic coding, computer use and professional workloads. The company claims it delivers near-GPT-6 Astra intelligence at one-fifth the price. A new Ultrafast tier promises up to 8x faster token generation in Codex with GPT-6 Astra. For developers, OpenAI announced plugin extensions for ChatGPT and Codex, alongside Codex Cloud, integrated code review and security tools.

Google Fitbit Air to launch in India on October 2

Google is launching the Fitbit Air, its compact screenless fitness tracker, in India on October 2. The Fitbit Air tracks heart rate continuously and supports irregular heart rhythm notifications. It also monitors sleep stages and duration, blood oxygen (SpO2) levels and automatically detects activities. Health and fitness data is synced to the Google Health app.

The tracker integrates with Google Health Coach, which uses health data to provide personalised guidance. Users can automatically log workouts, access guided sessions and use photos of gym equipment or workout routines to record activities. The screenless wearable is designed for round-the-clock health monitoring and offers up to seven days of battery life. Fitbit Air comes with a Performance Loop Band and is available in Obsidian, Berry, Lavender and Fog colourways.

The Google Fitbit Air will be available from October 2 through the Google Store, Flipkart and major offline retailers, priced at ₹13,999.

Dyson unveils the V16 Piston Animal cordless vacuum

Dyson unveiled the V16 Piston Animal, its all-new, anti-tangle cordless vacuum. The talking point of this new vacuum is Dyson's new All Floor Cones Sense cleaner head with two brush bar cones that eject even the longest hair, up to 25 inches in length, from the brush bar directly into the bin as you clean. This ensures you don't need to cut or pull out hair of tangled brush bars.

The V16 also intelligently senses changes in floor types and automatically adjusts suction power and brush bar speed for detailed cleaning on hard floors and deep cleaning on carpets. The Dyson V16 Piston Animal is engineered to help tackle hard-to-reach and easily overlooked areas in most homes and offices. According to Dyson, its LED illumination reveals dust hiding under furniture and in corners, while its fully sealed, five-stage whole-machine HEPA filtration system captures 99.99 per cent of particles as small as 0.1 microns. It is priced at ₹79,900.

Where the camera takes centre stage

IPHONE 18 PRO MAX. Stellar hardware, a variable camera aperture and improvements all around

Ashwin Rajagopalan

EYE CANDY. iPhone 18 Pro Max offers a vibrant, 6.9-inch, LTPO Super Retina XDR OLED display (1320 x 2868 pixels) that peaks at 3000 nits ASHWIN RAJAGOPALAN

Apple's annual September iPhone reveal this year was notable for more than one reason. Apple unveiled its first ever foldable smartphone – the iPhone Duo – and didn't launch an entry-level iPhone 18 (tipped for an early 2027 reveal).

The launch also comes a year before a significant milestone for the iPhone; 2027 will mark the 20th anniversary of the iPhone, and the rumour mills have already swung into action. Apple's strategy for the iPhone 18 Pro and Pro Max to arrive in stores about five weeks ahead of the iPhone Duo ensured that Apple's Pro twins got their shade of the spotlight, with customers showing up early for their first brush with the 2026 iPhone Pro versions.

Throughout the 2020s the iPhone Pro series has remained at the pinnacle of the smartphone world with cutting-edge performance and pro-level camera performance. The iPhone camera made significant leaps with the iPhone 11 Pro (which introduced the first triple camera system) and the 14 Pro that shifted the baseline from 12 MP to 48 MP. Of all these Pro versions, it was last year's 17 Pro Max that impacted my iPhone camera experience the most. It also saw one of the biggest performance jumps in the battery department. It all means that the 2026 iPhone 18 Pro and Pro Max have big shoes to fill. This gains even more significance given the 20 per cent price increase over last year's 17 Pro Max. Should you upgrade to the iPhone 18 Pro Max? That might well depend on which iPhone you're upgrading from.

DESIGN

I wasn't bowled over by the design refresh of last year's iPhone 17 Pro series when I first saw the phones. The shift from the titanium build of the 16 Pro and its predecessors may not have appealed to some iPhone die-hards. However, the choice of an aluminium chassis has been a pragmatic choice that brings multiple benefits, including thermal performance and battery optimisation, aside from more flexibility with colour finishes.

I gradually overcame that initial first impression; the all-new Glacier colourway has won me over. It might not be getting as much attention as this year's hero shade – Burgundy, but it's easily one of the coolest shades of blue on any smartphone. This year's new colours are probably the only way you can differentiate the 18 Pro twins from their predecessors. You get the same Ceramic Shield 2 over the display and a Ceramic Shield glass cover at the back that conceals the wireless charging coil.

Apple has colour matched the glass and aluminium across all four colourways this year, adding to the overall premium aesthetic. The 18 Pro Max is 16 g heavier than its predecessor, but it's not something you're likely to notice even if you held each of these phones in both your hands. At 249 g, the 18 Pro Max is not lightweight, and it weighs almost the same as the iPhone Duo. But the extra heft comes with a worthy trade-off: improved battery life.

This new iPhone offers one of the best camera experiences on any smartphone

DISPLAY

The iPhone 18 Pro Max shares a near-identical display with the 17 Pro Max. You get a vibrant, 6.9-inch, LTPO Super Retina XDR OLED display (1320 x 2868 pixels) that peaks at 3000 nits. There's one key difference, though. The pill-shaped Dynamic Island cutout is even smaller than last year's model and now supports three Live activities at a time. It's not something that is likely to have a big impact on everyday usage, though. The Pro Max's display is one of the best out there with punchy colours and deep blacks, as I experienced while watching the first episode of the second season of *The Gentlemen* on Netflix.

CAMERA

The biggest talking point that has dominated most of the post-launch buzz for the iPhone 18 Pro and Pro Max is the variable aperture camera. iPhone Pro phones have raised the bar for smartphone photography with arguably the best video capture capabilities. While most of the camera hardware hasn't changed much over the last year, the introduction of the new variable aperture has added a new element to the photography experience. The iPhone has always kept the overall photography experience simple even as it keeps upping the performance of the camera. That intuitive experience has worked well for most iPhone loyalists who have chosen to stick with iPhones instead of lugging DSLR cameras.

The big change is the mechanical variable aperture on the main camera. Apple uses six laser-cut blades inside the main lens assembly that physically contract or expand. The system typically moves between four mechanical settings from f/1.48 to f/4.0 that you can adjust in the lens aperture menu. While the f/1.48 offers better results in low light, the f/4.0 gives you more depth of field. If you're already using a 17 Pro Max, this variable aperture feature might be the only reason to consider an upgrade. There are some other additions too – you can now apply cinematic effects on video post capture.

The improved camera experience now offers new texture and grain controls in photographic styles that allow you to change the mood of your photos. The iPhone 18 Pro Max offers one of the best camera experiences on any smartphone, especially in the video department. However, quite a few Android flagships that are leveraging partnerships with imaging companies now offer stellar camera experiences too, especially in areas like zoom and low-light photography.

PERFORMANCE

Every new Pro iPhone comes with a significant performance improvement thanks to the next-generation chip. The A20 Pro chip sets new benchmarks and Apple claims it's 40 per cent faster than last year's A19 Pro chip. The new chip also accelerates on-device AI models and computational photography. The iPhone 18 Pro Max blazed through our Geekbench 7 benchmark tests, consistently topping 4,000 (single-core score) and 11,500 (multi-core score). It's truly in a league of its own and rivals high-end desktop chips.

One of the key changes you will notice, especially in intense-gaming scenarios, is how heat dissipates thanks to next-gen vapour cooling. While all these new performance gains and stats are great for tech geeks, most everyday users just care about lag-free performance even through demanding tasks like gaming or editing videos. This is where the iPhone 18 Pro Max takes it to the next level. The new and improved battery offers performance gains over last year's 17 Pro Max with faster charging speeds (now up to 60W).

VERDICT

The iPhone 18 Pro Max marks the next chapter of the iPhone's flagship Pro line, offering the best ever performance across the board, including camera and battery life. But this is something we've come to expect over the years. The bigger question is who is the 18 Pro Max for? You don't need to consider an upgrade (unless it's an annual ritual) if you already own the 17 Pro Max and don't particularly need the variable aperture. If you're stepping up from an iPhone 16 Pro/Pro Max or earlier, the 18 Pro Max offers a whole new hardware experience with the comforting familiarity of iOS 27 and all its new AI smarts.

If you're deciding between the iPhone Duo and the iPhone 18 Pro Max, that choice will boil down to one thing – the rear camera. Wait for a few weeks and check out what Duo will bring to the table. If that matters more than a pro-grade camera, then the Duo could be your next iPhone. The iPhone 18 Pro Max might seem like an iterative upgrade, but the big changes are under the hood.

SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹1,79,900 onwards
Pros: Stellar camera, cutting-edge hardware and performance, battery life, overall iOS experience
Cons: Not a major overhaul over last year, significant increase in price

Laptop ambitions, tablet limitations

HP OMNIPAD 12. Can the HP OmniPad 12 tablet double up as a laptop with its 2-in-1 design?

Siddharth Mathew Cherian

DEMAND DRIVEN. With the OmniPad 12, HP is looking to bridge the gap between tablets and laptops for users who want one device for work and entertainment BIJOY GHOSH

HP has long been a mainstay in the laptop and desktop space. With the OmniPad 12, the company is looking to bridge the gap between tablets and laptops for users who want one device for work and entertainment. Here's how it fares.

DESIGN

The HP OmniPad 12 is an all-aluminium tablet designed for 2-in-1 use with its detachable keyboard cover. The full-size keyboard and trackpad are integrated into a soft cover that attaches via pogo pins and doubles as a stand. The Denim Blue review unit, complete with a matching keyboard cover, stood out nicely, while a subtler Meteor Silver finish is also available.

At 600 g and 7.3 mm thick, the OmniPad 12 slips easily into a work bag. Add the 650g keyboard and cover, and the package weighs around 1.25kg, putting it in 13-inch ultrabook territory. Despite the added heft, I found it easy enough to carry every day, with the sturdy cover taking most of the scratches and wear inside my work bag.

DISPLAY

Featuring a 12-inch 2K (2000 × 1200) multi-touch display with a 16:10 aspect ratio, the HP OmniPad 12 delivers an 85 per cent screen-to-body ratio, 240 ppi density, 400 nits of brightness, and up to a 90 Hz refresh rate.

The panel shines when streaming video, delivering crisp visuals and accurate colour rendering. Skin tones looked natural, while the large display brought out the colours and details of the Indian settings in shows like *Panchayat* and *Waiting Hai* on Amazon Prime Video.

SOUND

The quad speakers positioned along the top and bottom of the OmniPad 12 complement the large display, making it a capable multimedia device. The sound with DTS tuning remained clear without noticeable distortion at higher volumes, with a good balance between the highs and mids while listening to Guns N' Roses' *Knockin' on Heaven's Door*. Catching up on my '90s Spotify playlist and watching movies also revealed a fairly engaging soundstage, making the OmniPad 12 enjoyable for multimedia consumption.

PERFORMANCE

The OmniPad 12 is powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 6 Gen 3 processor (SM6475Q), with six cores clocked at up to 2.40 GHz and integrated Adreno graphics. My review unit came with 8 GB of LPDDR5 memory and 256 GB of UFS storage, with a 128 GB variant also available. Storage can be expanded by up to 1 TB via microSD.

In Geekbench 7, the OmniPad 12 scored 880 in single-core and 2,636 in multi-core tests, putting its performance towards the lower end of the tablet segment. It remains competitive with some mid-range Android tablets but falls behind more powerful options. In everyday use, however, it is capable enough for media consumption, note-taking, and office work, though demanding workloads and gaming are not its strengths.

The 12-inch display felt a little too large for comfortable touch-based gaming, but pairing it with a console gamepad and propping it up with the cover stand made for a much better experience. Rainbow Six ran smoothly at low-to-medium settings, with little noticeable lag or stutter. I did encounter the occasional freeze after leaving the tablet on standby for a while, although it happened rarely and wasn't something I could consistently reproduce. Overall, it didn't significantly affect my experience. The OmniPad 12 runs Android 16, with HP adding a PC-like interface designed to make switching between tablet and keyboard use more seamless. HP says that the OmniPad will receive one major OS update to Android 17, along with two years of software and security updates from July 2026.

Features include floating windows, a persistent taskbar and a system tray, alongside a conventional touch-first tablet mode. I found myself using the OmniPad more often with the keyboard attached, as the desktop-style interface felt more natural in this setup. Floating windows allow apps to be resized and managed side by side, while the taskbar provides quick access to pinned and running apps. The system tray brings Wi-Fi, battery, notifications and quick settings together in a familiar laptop-like layout.

The clip-on keyboard folio cover was a joy to type on, with good key travel and a tactile response, and I typed much of this review on it. Despite its relatively small size, the trackpad was accurate enough for precise cursor movements and scrolling.

The lack of keyboard backlighting isn't a dealbreaker, though it would have been useful when working at night or in dimly lit spaces. The folio cover also doubles as a kickstand for laptop-style use, while its faux-leather and plastic construction held up well against everyday wear inside my work bag.

My main disappointment was the lack of wired display output via USB-C, a notable omission for a tablet aimed at home and office users who may want to connect to an external monitor.

The detachable keyboard connects through pogo pins, with no option to use it wirelessly when detached. Bluetooth connectivity would have added more flexibility, but the keyboard and tablet still come together as a well-integrated package.

CAMERAS

The OmniPad 12 features a 13 MP rear camera and an 8 MP front camera. The rear camera is adequate for casual pictures and scanning documents, while the front camera performed well during video calls, with decent exposure, contrast and natural-looking skin tones.

BATTERY

The OmniPad 12 packs an 8,133 mAh (31 Wh) 2-cell Li-ion polymer battery, with HP claiming up to 18 hours of battery life. Spread across a few working days of video streaming, document editing, video calls and general media consumption, I managed close to 18 hours of cumulative use, putting it broadly in line with HP's claim. The tablet also supports 33W Quick Charge 3.0 and ships with a 33W adapter. In my testing, it charged by around 32-33 per cent in 30 minutes, with a full charge taking about 2 hours and 10 minutes.

VERDICT

Starting at ₹48,999, the HP OmniPad 12 makes a compelling case in a segment dominated by the iPad and Samsung Galaxy Tab. Its large display, capable keyboard and multimedia experience are highlights, while performance is sufficient for everyday work and entertainment. For those looking for a versatile second device that can move comfortably between home and work, the OmniPad 12 is worth considering.

SNAPSHOT

Price: ₹54,999 (as reviewed)
Pros: Great display, good sound, capable keyboard and strong battery life
Cons: No wired display output, modest performance for the price and limited software support

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Guardrails challenge

Self-regulation not enough for AI. Govts must step in

The AI safety pact unveiled by US President Donald Trump and leading technology companies is a step towards putting guardrails around increasingly powerful artificial intelligence systems. The framework is significant because it goes beyond a general promise to develop AI responsibly and proposes four layers of controls within companies.

The first layer requires companies to put in place internal controls to monitor AI capabilities and alignment, particularly for risks such as cyberattacks, biosecurity and chemical threats. This should also be incorporated at the design stage. The second calls for an internal team to monitor whether those safeguards are working. The third and fourth layers are particularly important. The pact calls for independent external auditing of these safeguards. It also envisages independent board-level oversight, under which an independent committee would receive reports from internal teams and external auditors and oversee corrective action. These mechanisms are a significant improvement over merely asking technology companies to make voluntary promises. However, the four-layer framework raises a fundamental question: can an industry driven by fierce competition and commercial incentives be left to regulate itself, when the consequences of failure could extend far beyond individual companies? The pact remains, in the words used to describe it, a "morally binding" commitment rather than a legally enforceable regulatory framework. The experience of social media offers a warning on the limits of self-regulation. The EU has responded through its Digital Services Act, giving regulators investigative and enforcement powers. AI could require a similar evolution.

The four-layer corporate framework could form the first part of a broader six-layer system. The fifth layer should be public accountability. Governments would establish legally enforceable standards defining the responsibilities of AI developers and deployers, including requirements for testing, reporting, incident disclosure and corrective action. Anthropic's latest threat report documents AI being used in cyber operations, fraud, surveillance and other harmful activities. The Hugging Face incident is a reminder that autonomous AI systems can operate in ways their creators may not fully anticipate. Where an AI agent causes harm by operating outside prescribed safeguards, the response should not end with an internal review. Regulators should have powers to investigate and impose proportionate penalties.

The sixth layer has to be international coordination. AI competition between countries could create an incentive to weaken safeguards. Governments could consider a multilateral mechanism — potentially modelled on the G20 in its broad international representation — to establish common safety principles, share information about serious AI incidents and discourage a race to deploy systems beyond agreed guardrails. Coordinated, enforceable rules are the way forward.

G VENKAT RAMAN

China+1 gains may be getting harder to earn

NEXT PHASE. India cannot base its manufacturing ambitions on the expectation that deteriorating US-China relations will continually push MNCs towards it

REUTERS

Xi Jinping's visit to the US is unlikely to end the strategic rivalry between the world's two largest economies. Tariffs, technology controls, critical minerals, artificial intelligence and industrial policy will continue to divide Washington and Beijing. What the visit may reveal, however, is something potentially more consequential for India: strategic competition between the US and China need not produce economic disengagement.

For much of the past several years, governments and businesses have worked with a relatively straightforward assumption. As geopolitical tensions between Washington and Beijing intensified, multinational firms would progressively reduce their exposure to China. Production would move elsewhere, supply chains would diversify, and countries such as India, Vietnam and Mexico would capture part of the resulting investment.

The assumption was never entirely wrong. But it may have been too linear.

What is emerging instead is a more complicated form of economic competition. Washington continues to restrict Chinese access to sensitive technologies and scrutinise strategic dependencies. Beijing, meanwhile, has demonstrated its ability to exercise leverage through critical minerals, manufacturing ecosystems and its enormous domestic market. Yet neither side appears interested in dismantling the broader commercial relationship.

This is not détente. It is better understood as compartmentalised interdependence.

Some parts of the economic relationship are increasingly being treated as matters of national security. Advanced semiconductors, artificial intelligence, critical minerals, telecommunications and certain forms of high-technology investment fall increasingly within this strategic perimeter. Outside it, however, trade and investment can continue — even expand — provided political risks remain manageable. That distinction matters for India.

India has benefited from the geopolitical reorganisation of global production. Apple's growing manufacturing footprint in India is perhaps the most visible example. Electronics, pharmaceuticals, renewable energy equipment and other sectors have similarly become part of a wider effort by firms to diversify their production networks.

But diversification should not be confused with the wholesale relocation of industrial ecosystems.

China remains deeply embedded in global manufacturing because it offers something considerably more difficult to replicate than inexpensive labour: dense supplier networks, logistics infrastructure, engineering capabilities, scale and the ability to move rapidly from product design to mass production.

A factory can move faster than the ecosystem surrounding it.

This is why China+1 has generally meant precisely that — China plus another production location, rather than replacing China altogether.

A more managed US-China relationship could reinforce this pattern. If firms conclude that the geopolitical relationship can remain competitive without repeatedly threatening a complete economic rupture, the incentive to leave China simply because of geopolitical risk becomes weaker.

Companies will still diversify. But they will become much more discriminating about what they diversify, where they move it and how much redundancy they are prepared to pay for.

India needs to distinguish between dependencies that create genuine strategic vulnerability and commercial relationships that can contribute to domestic capability

DIFFERENTIATED RISK

The corporate question is therefore changing. It is no longer simply: How much production should we move out of China? Companies increasingly need to ask which dependencies actually create strategic vulnerability.

Four questions become important. How critical is a particular input or production process? How concentrated is its supply? How easily can substitutes be found? And how quickly would disruption begin to affect operations?

A component sourced almost entirely from China, essential to production and difficult to substitute presents a very different risk from an easily replaceable consumer product manufactured there. This produces a more differentiated geography of globalisation.

Some supply chains will be duplicated. Some strategic inputs will be re-shored or friend-shored. Firms may deliberately maintain excess capacity in particularly vulnerable areas. But other commercial relationships with China will continue because replacing them would impose substantial costs without generating equivalent strategic benefits.

The result will not be de-globalisation. Nor will it be a return to the hyper-globalisation of the 1990s and early 2000s. It will be a world in which economic efficiency and geopolitical resilience are continuously traded against each other.

This creates an uncomfortable implication for India. India cannot base its manufacturing ambitions on the expectation that deteriorating US-China relations will continually push multinational firms towards it.

Geopolitics can create an opening. It cannot substitute for industrial capability. If Washington and Beijing learn to manage their rivalry while maintaining substantial economic interaction, multinational firms will have less reason to relocate production merely to insure themselves against geopolitical rupture. Alternative locations will increasingly have to compete on conventional but demanding criteria: infrastructure, logistics, supplier depth, skills, regulatory predictability and the speed with which firms can scale production.

This also changes how India should think about China itself. The objective cannot simply be reducing Chinese economic involvement wherever possible. India needs to distinguish between dependencies that create genuine strategic vulnerability and commercial relationships that can contribute to domestic capability. That may require a more differentiated approach towards Chinese capital and technology as well. Investment in sensitive digital infrastructure or strategically critical sectors raises very different questions from investment that creates manufacturing capacity, employment and supplier networks in non-sensitive industries.

The relevant question is therefore not whether an investment is Chinese. It is what kind of dependency — or capability — it creates.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR INDIA

Xi's visit should therefore be read carefully in New Delhi. If Washington and Beijing are moving towards a relationship in which intense strategic competition coexists with selective economic engagement, India should not assume that permanent US-China confrontation will do the work of industrial policy for it.

Indeed, the more effectively the two powers learn to manage their economic rivalry, the more demanding the competition for global investment may become.

India still has a significant opportunity. Firms want greater resilience. Boards are more conscious of geopolitical concentration than they were a decade ago. Governments are willing to support diversification in strategically important sectors.

But the next phase of China+1 will be different from the first. Geopolitics may determine why companies look beyond China. Capability will increasingly determine where they go.

The writer is professor, Humanities and Social Sciences, IIM Indore. Views are personal

India can no longer overlook its pasture lands

Apart from benefitting livestock keepers, healthy rangelands support biodiversity and strengthen drought resilience

Bishwa Bhaskar Choudhary
Amit Kumar Singh
Pankaj Kaushal

India's rangelands rarely make headlines. While forests attract policy attention, rivers shape environmental debates, and agricultural land is embedded in economic planning, rangelands and pastoral landscapes remain largely on the margins. Yet they quietly sustain India's livestock production.

According to ICAR's 'Comprehensive Assessment of Feed and Fodder Resources', India's rangelands and permanent pastures cover about 11.5 million hectares and produce around 28 million tonnes of forage annually. For millions of livestock-owning households, these commons provide in-kind income by supplying fodder, reducing feed costs and supporting livestock production. When they degrade, the cost shifts to households through higher feed expenses, lower productivity, smaller herds and greater reliance on purchased fodder. Yet much of these value remains invisible in conventional accounting because grazing on commons rarely involves direct monetary transactions.

The case for conserving rangelands becomes stronger when their wider ecosystem services are recognised. Healthy rangelands benefit not only livestock keepers but society more broadly by protecting soil, supporting biodiversity, storing carbon and strengthening drought resilience. This creates a clear gap between private and social returns: livestock keepers may receive modest direct financial benefits from maintaining common pastures, while society gains from water regulation, carbon storage, and reduced land degradation.

The UNCCD report illustrates this gap through a restoration initiative in Jordan, where every $1 invested by herders generated about $0.80 in direct returns but an estimated $18 in benefits to society, largely through groundwater recharge. The lesson is relevant to India: when communities bear much of the cost of managing rangelands while society captures a substantial share of the benefits, conservation cannot rely solely on market incentives. Public policy has a role in closing this gap.

BRIDGING THE POLICY GAP

India still lacks a dedicated national framework for rangelands and grasslands. Their management is fragmented across sectors, programmes and jurisdictions, making it difficult to assign responsibility or reconcile competing claims. ICAR–IGFRI, Jhansi,

RIGHT PATH. Livestock production and conservation must be aligned

has highlighted this gap and the need to bring rangelands firmly onto the national policy agenda. The International Year of Rangelands and Pastoralists-2026 offers an opportunity to address this blind spot through developing a National Rangeland/Grassland Policy, with clear institutional responsibilities across levels of government. Rather than creating a new delivery architecture, it could build on existing schemes while strengthening local community participation.

The starting point should be better information. Existing statistics on permanent pastures and grazing lands need strengthening through systematic monitoring and a national Rangeland Atlas mapping their extent, condition and productivity. Degraded rangelands and grazing commons should then be restored through scientifically sound, locally adapted management that combines pastoral knowledge with existing programmes. At the village level, the principle of "one Gram Panchayat, one grazing land" could provide a simple institutional anchor for protecting and managing common grazing resources.

Pastoralists and local livestock keepers should be recognised not merely as users but as economic stakeholders and potential stewards. The objective should not be to choose between livestock production and conservation, but to align the two through appropriate grazing practices, restoration and incentives. Payments for ecosystem services and suitable carbon-credit mechanisms would enable communities maintain rangelands while sharing in the wider ecological benefits they generate.

The message is simple: India cannot afford to treat rangelands as empty spaces awaiting a "more productive" use. They already produce fodder, support livelihoods, provide ecosystem services and strengthen resilience. What is missing is not their value, but its recognition in policy and economic accounting.

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POCKET RAVIKANTH

LETTERS TO EDITOR

Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to 'Letters to the Editor', The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Digital tech in farming

Apropos 'Digital agriculture and the problem of exclusion' (September 30), digital tools can improve farming through better weather information, market access, crop monitoring and efficient use of resources. Yet technology should not widen existing inequalities among farmers. Women, tenant farmers and agricultural workers may lack land records, smartphones, reliable internet access or the skills needed to use digital platforms. Government programmes should therefore provide assisted access through local centres and farmer organisations. Training must be available in regional languages, with special attention to women and smaller cultivators. Technology must complement agricultural extension services, not replace human support.

K Sakunthala
Coimbatore

Impact of high bond yields

This refers to 'Why bond yields are staying high' (September 30). Persistently high bond yields can raise borrowing costs for governments, businesses and households. Inflation expectations, fiscal requirements and global financial conditions all influence yields, so monetary policy alone cannot address every pressure. The RBI should continue communicating its policy intentions clearly while monitoring inflation and liquidity conditions closely. The government needs a credible fiscal strategy that keeps borrowing requirements manageable. A deeper domestic bond market can also provide investors with greater choice and improve monetary policy transmission. For businesses, predictable interest rates are vital for long-term investment decisions.

SM Jeeva
Chennai

Investors' predicament

This refers to the cartoon 'POCKET' by Ravikant (September 30). The cartoon aptly captures the predicament of an ordinary family man who is also an investor. When markets fall, the family worries about losing money; when they rise, they fear that he may invest even more. It reflects the constant tension between household security and the desire to build wealth. For a middle-class family, every investment decision involves balancing present needs, future goals and market uncertainty. The cartoon also conveys a practical lesson: investing should not be driven by fear during downturns or excitement during rallies.

M Barathi
Bengaluru

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Boosting Norway-India ties

EFTA pact has helped fuel bilateral trade

May-Elin Stener

What connects Norwegian salmon on a dining table in Delhi to a shipyard more than 2,000 kilometres away in Kochi? Or a sludge-to-biogas project in Mumbai to cutting-edge medtech improving healthcare in Bengaluru?

They are all part of the growing and diverse Norway-India partnership, made stronger by the India-EFTA Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement (TEPA) that came into force on October 1, 2025.

STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP. On a strong footing

REASONS TO CELEBRATE

As we mark the first anniversary of this landmark agreement, we have encouraging numbers to celebrate: bilateral goods trade between India and Norway grew by 9 per cent, and Norwegian exports to India grew by 34 per cent in the first nine months of TEPA. But TEPA is about more than trade and tariffs. It is about bringing companies and people together who are working towards a shared, sustainable economic future.

TEPA is the first trade agreement signed by India to incorporate investments and job creation targets. Under the agreement, the EFTA countries (Iceland, Liechtenstein, Norway and Switzerland) will promote $100 billion in investments into India over the next 15 years, with the ambition of creating one million jobs.

Around 160 Norwegian companies are doing business in India, and what I am hearing from them is that they see India as a partner for long-term growth. Norway's strengths lie in sectors that are becoming increasingly central to India's development journey.

We offer expertise in maritime industries, renewable energy, sustainable ocean technologies, medtech and circular economy solutions. India brings scale, manufacturing capacity, entrepreneurial energy, talent and an enormous innovation ecosystem.

During Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit to Oslo in May this year, both nations advanced bilateral relations to a Green Strategic Partnership. We are already seeing growing collaboration in renewable energy, low-carbon technologies, energy efficiency and energy storage technologies. The Green Strategic Partnership gives political direction to this cooperation, and TEPA provides an economic framework through which businesses can help deliver it.

The maritime sector offers another example. Norway's maritime heritage and India's ambitions to expand port infrastructure, strengthen shipbuilding and enhance coastal shipping, make this sector a natural area of cooperation for the two ocean nations. About 10 per cent of the current orders by Norwegian shipowners are placed at Indian shipyards.

Behind these figures are engineers, shipbuilders and technology specialists working together across both countries. With TEPA, it has become easier for Norwegian companies to bring technology and expertise to India, from green shipping and maritime equipment to digital port solutions and offshore technologies.

BLUE ECONOMY

The Blue Economy more broadly represents an area of enormous potential. Norwegian seafood exports to India have, in the past, faced significant tariff barriers. TEPA changed this and the result has been quick and promising. Tariffs for frozen whole Norwegian salmon, for example, dropped to zero from the agreement's entry into force, while several other seafood categories are seeing tariffs phased down over time. The value of Norway's seafood exports to India grew 53 per cent between October 2025 and June 2026, compared to the same period a year earlier.

One year is too short a time frame to judge a trade agreement by the number of investments or jobs generated, but not too soon to see if businesses are responding. Norwegian companies are exploring new partnerships and collaborations are expanding. The real measure of TEPA will be how we build on this momentum in the years to come.

The writer is Norwegian Ambassador to India

India emerges as leading refiner

While the US turns protectionist and disrupts supplies, India is rising as a vital force to plug the global gap

CAPITAL IDEAS.

RICHA MISHRA

The global energy architecture is undergoing a structural realignment, but whether it represents a permanent role reversal between traditional powers remains a subject of intense geopolitical debate. In what some critics view as a politically motivated retreat from free market principles, the US has increasingly weighed protectionist measures, including floating the radical notion of refined product export bans to shield domestic consumers from inflationary shocks.

In contrast, India, moving beyond its historically cautious, non-aligned past, has emerged as a vital stabilising force in global trade, leveraging its massive refining capacity to maintain liquidity and keep the lights on across the Western world.

Yet, as Washington balances domestic anxiety against global leadership and New Delhi converts pragmatic self-interest into systemic influence, a critical question emerges: are we simply witnessing a more fragmented, transactional era of energy diplomacy?

RAPID TRANSFORMATION

For India, the numbers reveal a story of rapid transformation. Having overtaken Russia to become the world's second-largest exporter of seaborne diesel, India has dramatically scaled its shipments.

While Washington debates locking down its domestic fuel with a 90-day export ban, New Delhi is taking centre stage as a vital global supplier. By stepping into this vacuum, India is doing more than just capturing market share. This move by New Delhi is not mere geopolitical posturing. Speaking at the 13th Public Affairs Forum of India recently, Petroleum & Natural Gas Minister Hardeep Singh Puri had reportedly countered the Western protectionist trend.

Pointing to long-term pacts, such as India's five-year supply agreement with Mauritius, Puri had highlighted a structural reality the West can no longer ignore. While global refining capacities choke, India is aggressively expanding its refining power at 5.8 million barrels per day. In August, during Puri's official visit to Mauritius, a government-to-government MoU for cooperation in oil and gas sector, alongside a long-term sales and purchase agreement between Indian Oil Corporation Ltd and State Trading Corporation (STC) of Mauritius for supply of petroleum products, was exchanged.

POWERING AHEAD. India has emerged as a major global refining hub, with an annual output of 267 mmt of refined petroleum products across 23 refineries GETTY IMAGES

India is definitely turning into a dependable energy partner as it has emerged as a major global refining hub, with an annual output of 267 mmt of refined petroleum products across 23 refineries, making it a net exporter of refined products. India already meets the petroleum demand of Nepal and Bhutan, and supplies significant quantities to other countries. Even during the West Asia crisis, India fulfilled its supply commitments to Nepal and Bhutan, making it a dependable energy security provider.

The US ban risks triggering local refining bottlenecks and driving global prices higher, but it presents an opportunity to Indian refiners to plug the Western supply gap

While a US ban risks triggering local refining bottlenecks and driving global prices higher, it presents a market opportunity to Indian refiners stepping in to plug the Western supply gap. If Washington decides to lock down its fuel, it is likely to leave its European allies utterly stranded. By stepping into this vacuum, India becomes Europe's primary energy stabiliser.

If Puri's statement is seen in this context, then it is providing a critical lifeline. The move will also make it politically impossible for the West to criticise India's broader strategic and trade ties with Moscow. Europe cannot condemn the source of the crude while surviving on the refined diesel.

So, can India turn this 90-day US window, if it happens, into multi-year dominance? By duplicating models like its recent supply agreement with Mauritius, New Delhi can pitch itself to stranded European utilities and global distributors as the ultimate, predictable and reliable alternative. Indian refiners stand to gain an unprecedented commercial advantage here. But much of their windfall profits in all probability will be clawed back by New Delhi's tax mechanisms.

The ban would send global diesel prices and refining margins skyrocketing. Complex refiners such as Reliance Industries would be perfectly positioned to step into the vacuum, capturing market share across European and Latin American trade routes, while supercharging their double-arbitrage model of processing discounted crude for premium international export. However, this massive profit potential comes with a built-in regulatory ceiling.

EXPORT LEVIES

New Delhi recalibrates export levies fortnightly to prevent fuel shortages and curb excess corporate profiteering, which means any explosive surge in global margins would instantly trigger a sharp hike in export duties to protect the domestic economy first. Meanwhile, there is an interesting development in India's power sector.

The government has invoked Section 11 of the Electricity Act, and directed 112 captive coal-fired plants above 50 MW to maximise generation from October 1 through December and sell the surplus power to the grid. Plants have also been asked to report generation, spare capacity and coal inventories weekly to the CEA, underlining the concern around fuel availability and system reliability.

"For refining and demand, this is relevant because the order also includes captive plants linked to Reliance, IndianOil and Nayara. It could mean higher captive coal burn and utility costs, but also potentially some incremental support for liquid-fuel demand if power availability tightens further," said Sumit Ritolia, Lead Research Analyst, Refining & Modeling at Kepler.

One wonders if this internal grid management will trap diesel at home, causing New Delhi to miss out on an unprecedented export boom? However, this is not an opportunity lost. It is a calculated policy blueprint to shield domestic assets while aggressively capturing global market share.

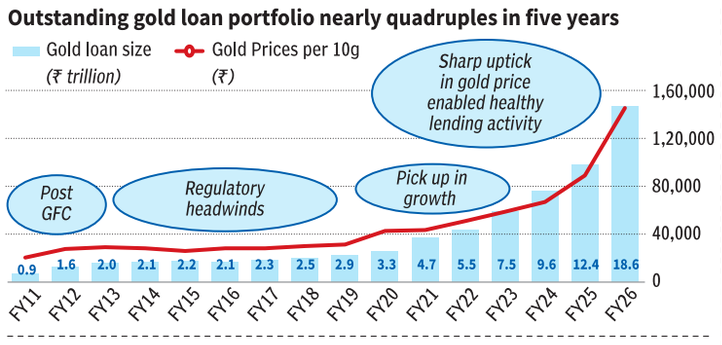
STATISTALK.

Compiled **Dhuraivel Gunasekaran** | Graphic **Visveswaran V**

The new gold economy: untapped wealth fuels credit boom

India's gold loan market has entered a new growth phase, with outstanding loans nearly quadrupling to ₹18.6 trillion in five years, according to Motilal Oswal. Rising gold prices, growing acceptance among households and small businesses and a shift from informal to organised lending have fuelled this expansion. Yet, penetration remains low, with organised gold loans accounting for just 8% of household gold value. Gold loans have also overtaken personal loans. Growth is increasingly spreading beyond southern India, with Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh witnessing rapid expansion. However, the industry is becoming increasingly reliant on existing borrowers rather than first-time customers. Key facts:

Outstanding gold loan portfolio nearly quadruples in five years

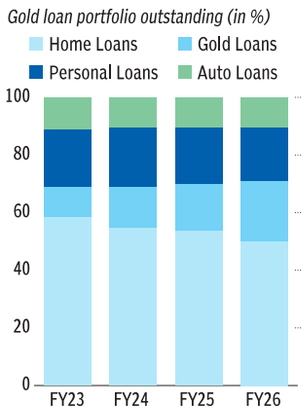


India's vast gold reserves remain underutilised

Particulars	Units	Penetration
Household value of gold (E) = (D) x (A)	₹ trillion	391.24
Gold Loan outstanding	₹ trillion	18.6
LTV at industry level assumed at 60% (I)	₹ trillion	31
Penetration of gold loans (I)/(E)*100	%	7.90

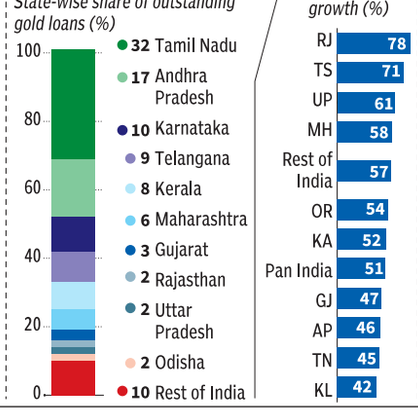
Gold loans overtake personal loans

Gold loan portfolio outstanding (in %)



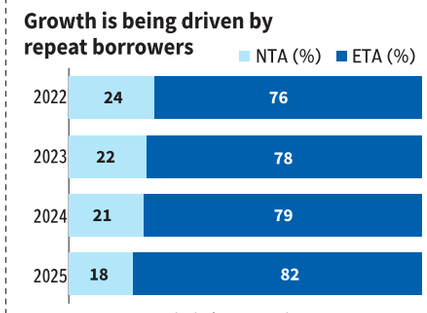
Gold loans spread beyond southern strongholds

State-wise share of outstanding gold loans (%)



FY26 y-o-y growth (%)

Growth is being driven by repeat borrowers



Source: Motilal Oswal Financial Services

On businessline.in

GST numbers: Stronger on the surface, weaker underneath

Stripped of base effects, the underlying tax buoyancy looks weak across the board, says **Dhananjay Sinha**

https://tinyurl.com/2b97uabv

US tariff threat: India's dual test on energy and exports

Export diversification, new trade agreements and diversification of energy sources could reduce Indian economy's vulnerability to external trade shocks, point out **Anup Kumar Mishra, Manoj Kumar** and **Rahul Ranjan**

https://tinyurl.com/5h5pssp8

A critical reading of ANI vs OpenAI

India's first big AI copyright ruling protects the machine's research. It has far less to say about the reporter whose work fed it, says **Anson CJ**

https://tinyurl.com/39u4w3ek

thehindu businessline.

TWENTY YEARS AGO TODAY.

October 1, 2006

Sugar mills say exports viable at current rates

The crash in world prices is not deterring sugar millers, who feel exports are viable even at ruling levels of $370-375 per tonne. All this is, of course, assuming that the Centre would lift the current ban on sugar exports by November.

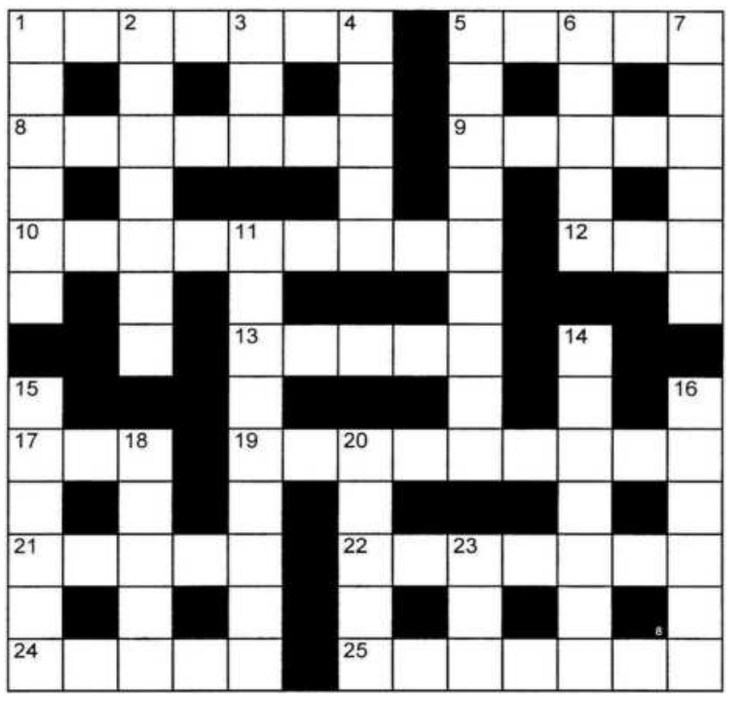
External commercial borrowing cap may be raised

The Finance Minister, Mr P. Chidambaram, has indicated that the Government may raise the overall external commercial borrowing (ECB) limit in the coming months to enable corporates to access lowcost funds from abroad. "This (ECB) is constantly under review. At an appropriate time, we may have to look at the cap," said Mr Chidambaram.

Airlines may not nip fares despite fuel price cut

The domestic air traveller is unlikely to get any immediate relief despite an almost eight per cent reduction in the cost of aviation turbine fuel. Major domestic airlines have indicated that they have no immediate plans to reduce airfares or adjusting the fuel surcharge despite the steep drop in ATF prices.

BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2747



EASY

ACROSS

1. Abrogate, annul (7)
5. Disentangled (5)
8. Three-pronged spear (7)
9. Portent, symbol (5)
10. The rest, residue (9)
12. Take one to court (3)
13. Undecorated (5)
17. Young wolf (3)
19. Treated with deference (9)
21. Remove knot (5)
22. One more; a second (7)
24. A number of ships (5)
25. Old county division (7)

DOWN

1. Come, send back (6)
2. A bather (7)
3. Keen resentment, anger (3)
4. No longer fashionable (5)
5. Way of, power of, speaking (9)
6. Nobles (5)
7. One who moves to music (6)
11. Incomplete, defective (9)
14. Ewer, jug (7)
15. Skin at back of neck (6)
16. Greatly loved (6)
18. Soak in water (5)
20. Dash; a flourish on a letter (5)
23. Be proprietor of (3)

NOT SO EASY

ACROSS

1. Cinders had to change before she could cut away (7)
5. Found idea that would show how one opened it (5)
8. Neptune held it when I'd gone in the river (7)
9. Symbolic payment it's all right to have in number (5)
10. Name rider adopted for what was over (9)
12. In short, a girl will prosecute one at law (3)
13. It is clear one is involved in a plot (5)
17. Castro's country lost a small creature (3)
19. Thought well of the crest, deep as it might be (9)
21. Remove the knot the Mounties made inside (5)
22. Have one more unnamed player (7)
24. As nimble as a number of cars can be (5)
25. Ton of carbon sharing abbreviation (7)

DOWN

1. Profit shown by true manoeuvres in the Navy (6)
2. Gently boil tungsten in it while he is in the pool (7)
3. Keen resentment felt by some directors (3)
4. Old-fashioned way boys took girls out (5)
5. Aren't cute as to such expression in speech (9)
6. Gloucester and Norfolk, say, make fists of them (5)
7. How can Red become a ballerina's partner? (6)
11. I am ideal, but I'm tense (9)
14. Baseball player could hold his drink (7)
15. The back of the neck of an untidy person (6)
16. Loved to have a party, but was embarrassed by it (6)
18. Wash all over and be about to change hat (5)
20. Flourish on letter was called for in a call for silence (5)
23. How to be the possess (3)

SOLUTION: BL TWO-WAY CROSSWORD 2746

ACROSS 1. Bosom 4. Dubious 8. Amber 9. Gondola 10. Doe 11. Oversleep 12. Note 13. Char 18. Habituate 20. Sic 21. Unified 22. Khaki 23. Endless 24. Ridge

DOWN 1. Boarding-house 2. Subject 3. Marrow 4. Digger 5. Banish 6. Ozone 7. Sharp practice 14. Husband 15. Strike 16. Caddis 17. Pecker 19. Blind

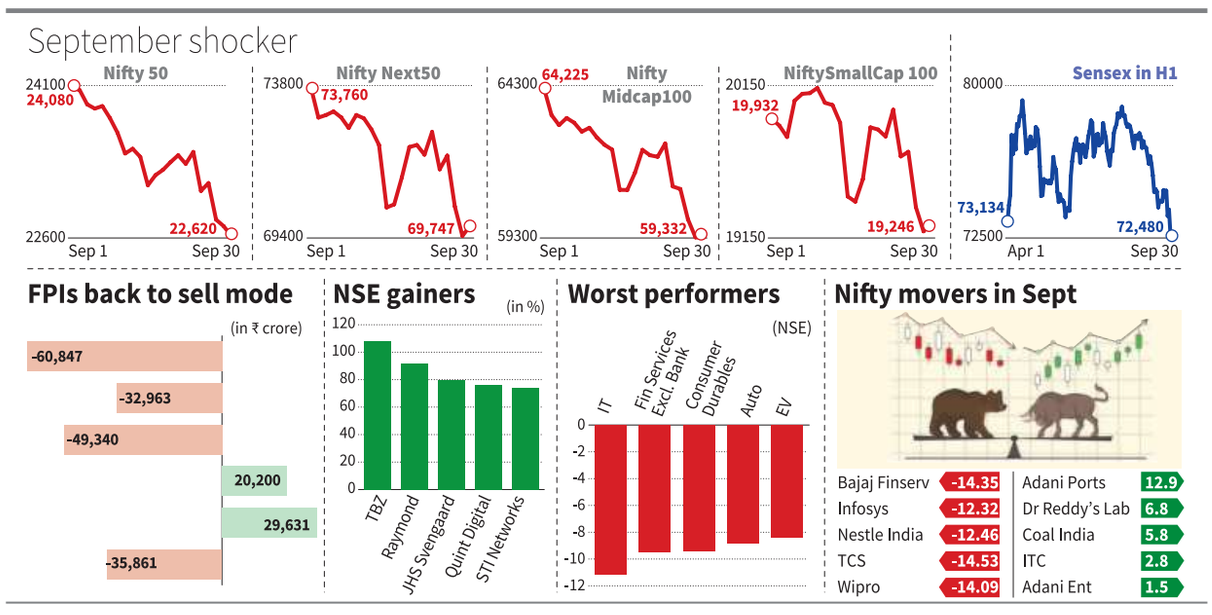
For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

CHENNAI
businessline.
THURSDAY - OCTOBER 1 - 2026

Nifty posts worst monthly fall in 8 years

MAJOR HEADWINDS. Firm crude oil prices, spike in interest rates by global bankers, FPI heavy selling weigh on market sentiment

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai



Indian equities ended the first half of FY27 under pressure, with September emerging as the weakest month for the Nifty 50 since 2018 as elevated crude prices, higher global bond yields and sustained foreign selling weighed on sentiment.

The Nifty 50 closed September at 22,620.45, down 6.1 per cent during the month. For the first half, NSE 50 index gained 1.3 per cent.

RATE HIKES

FPIs turned to risk-averse mode in September amid inflation worries, as crude oil prices surged above $100/barrel that forced global central banks to hike interest rates. The US Fed raised its key interest rate in September, followed by central banks in Europe, Japan and Australia. Analysts expect the RBI to hike the rate in the upcoming October 7 meet.

FPIs withdrew ₹25,662 crore from Indian equities through the secondary market in September, ending a two-month buying streak.

Domestic institutional investors (DIIs), however, continued to absorb a substantial part of the foreign selling. DIIs invested ₹52,617 crore during September. The divergence between FPI selling and DII buying was also visible through the latter part of the month, with foreign investors selling ₹9,980.22 crore on September 29 while DIIs bought ₹6,952.71 crore.

The market capitalisation of NSE-listed stocks was at ₹467 lakh crore as of September 2026, down from ₹469 lakh crore as of June 2026. But it rose nearly 14 per cent in the first half from ₹410 lakh crore in March 2026.

Meanwhile, the September decline came after the market had recovered from the lows seen at the start of the financial year.

Ajit Mishra, SVP - Research, Religare Broking, said the Nifty had been undergoing a prolonged correction since its September 2024 peak, with the recent decline erasing gains made over the preceding months.

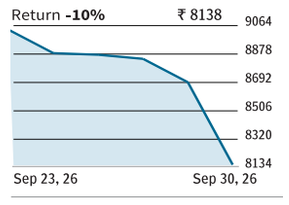
IT HITS A LOW

None of the sectoral indices closed in the green in September. Nifty IT was the worst performer, tumbling nearly 12 per cent. Bajaj Finserv and Infosys were the worst performers by falling 14 per cent and 12 per cent.

Looking ahead, the September sell-off has shifted attention to corporate earnings, crude prices, foreign flows and monetary policy. Mishra said crude remains the key risk.

SC remarks on drug prices, a bitter pill for hospital stocks

Madhu Balaji
Bengaluru



Hospital and pharma stocks came under significant selling pressure on Wednesday after the Supreme Court raised concerns over steep mark-ups on essential medicines, particularly cancer drugs, and described the pricing disparity as "carnage".

The Nifty Healthcare index shed 2.5 per cent. Apollo Hospitals fell nearly 6 per cent to end at ₹8,165.50 on the NSE, while Max Healthcare shed over 5 per cent to ₹929.80. Yatharth Hospital & Trauma Care fell nearly 7 per cent to ₹1,032.50.

Fortis Healthcare declined 6 per cent, while Aster DM Quality Care and Manipal Health Enterprises fell over 5 per cent each. KIMS was down over 3 per cent. Dr Agarwal and Narayana Hrudayalaya ended flat after declining in early trade.

Pharmacy sales are a key revenue contributor for large hospital chains, particularly from in-patient treatments, and carry healthy margins. Investors are also factoring in the risk of broader price regulation, including potential caps on medical devices, which have been sought in the petition.

According to Nitant Darekar, Research Analyst at Bonanza, the Supreme Court's observation on a uniform 16 per cent retail mark-up cap on medicines and its questioning of in-house pharmacy requirements at corporate hospitals could put pressure on the sector's high-margin pharmacy revenue pool. He estimated a consolidated EBITDA margin drag of around 50-150 basis points for pharmacy-heavy integrated hospitals.

Inox Clean Energy files DRHP for ₹10,000 crore IPO

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Inox Clean Energy, the renewable energy platform of the INOXGFL Group, has filed its draft red herring prospectus (DRHP) with SEBI for an initial public offering of up to ₹10,000 crore, as the company seeks to raise capital after a year of aggressive expansion through acquisitions.

The IPO will comprise a fresh issue of up to ₹8,000 crore and an offer for sale of up to ₹2,000 crore by the selling shareholder. Proceeds from the fresh issue will primarily be used to repay or prepay borrowings of the company and its subsidiaries, with the balance earmarked for general corporate purposes.

HIGHER CAPEX

businessline had reported in July that the company had spent more than ₹25,200 crore over the preceding year on acquisitions across India, West Asia and South-East Asia, spanning renewable power generation, solar manufacturing, project development, operations and maintenance, and international assets.

The company had also secured ₹1,500 crore from the Motilal Oswal Group in August. Other investors in the company and its subsidiaries include the Adar Poonawalla Family Office, CalPERS, RJ Corp, Hero Group, Authum Investments, Akash Bhansali, and other family offices and high-net-worth investors. Promoters Devansh Jain and Avarna Jain will be the selling shareholders/promoters associated with the offer.

SEBI, RBI work on bond indices, faster FPI onboarding

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI and the RBI are working on a framework to enable trading in bond indices and associated derivatives, while jointly working to cut the time taken by foreign portfolio investors to enter the Indian market, SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said on Wednesday.

"One of the points that we are working on is bond indices... how we can have bond indices trading on exchanges," Pandey said on the sidelines of the third annual conference of the Association of Portfolio Managers in India. "I believe the RBI has prepared some draft guidelines and asked for comments, and we are pursuing with RBI to finalise," he said. The regulators have been working in closer coordination on easing access for foreign investors and to make the process fast, seamless and digital. "There is much more active inter-regulatory coordination...on FPI onboarding, SEBI and the RBI are currently engaged very actively on ironing out many issues."

DIGITAL SHIFT

SEBI has also moved towards digital signatures, e-Power of Attorney, a common application portal and tracking mechanisms, reducing reliance on physical documents, notarisation and apostille requirements. Pandey said the RBI is also looking at allowing certification of FPI registration documents by foreign commercial banks and using the SWIFT network to transmit the certification.

Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Chairman, SEBI PTI

The measures are part of a broader effort to reduce the time and paperwork involved in bringing foreign capital into Indian markets.

SEBI is also working on a market-making framework covering liquidity, market infrastructure and repo access, besides proposals for Fixed Income Channel Partners to expand distribution through regulated online bond platforms.

ON SELF LISTING

Pandey clarified that SEBI has not formed any committee to examine allowing stock exchanges to trade their own shares on their platforms, including via the "permitted to trade" route.

Speaking at the conclave, Pandey said SEBI's focus would increasingly be on simplifying regulation while expanding investment options. He said the next phase of market development would require greater use of technology, but accountability for investment decisions must remain with identifiable human decision-makers

He said there is scope for the PMS industry to expand at a faster pace. The AUM in the PMS industry has reached around ₹9.2 lakh crore by August 2026, from ₹1.4 lakh crore by FY16.

Adroit jumps 85% on Day 1, Swastika Infra rises; but ArMee, Elevate end weak

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

STRONG OPENING. (from left) Saurabh Sangla, CMD, Adroit Industries (India), Mukesh Sangla, Director, and Jaswant Jain, Chief Manager, NSE, at the listing ceremony

Four companies — Adroit Industries (India), Swastika Infra, ArMee Infotech and Elevate Campuses — made their debut on the NSE and BSE on Wednesday, delivering mixed performances.

Adroit Industries made a strong debut, listing at a 75.3 per cent premium on the NSE at ₹235 against its IPO price of ₹134. On the BSE, it debuted at ₹250, a premium of 86.5 per cent. The stock closed at ₹248.39 on the NSE and ₹248.35 on the BSE, retaining a gain of over 85 per cent. Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth at Swastika Investmart, said the strong debut reflected improving profitability and EBITDA margins. However, she cautioned that the sharp listing premium had reduced the margin of safety.

SWASTIKA INFRA

Swastika Infra began trading at ₹200 on both the NSE and BSE, marking an 8.1 per cent gain over its IPO price of ₹185. The stock subsequently hit the upper circuit at ₹210 on the NSE and ₹209.95 on the BSE, a rise of 13.5 per cent over IPO price.

Nyati said the strong debut reflected healthy market interest, supported by the company's 15-year track record in power transmission and distribution EPC, robust growth and reasonable valuation.

ARMEE, ELEVATE

ArMee Infotech debuted flat at ₹375 on the NSE, matching its issue price. On the BSE, it listed at ₹368.85, a discount of 1.6 per cent. The stock subsequently fell 20 per cent to hit its lower circuit at ₹300 on the NSE and ₹295.10 on the BSE.

Elevate Campuses debuted at a 1.9 per cent discount at ₹355.10 on the NSE against its IPO price of ₹362. On the BSE, the stock listed at ₹356.50, a discount of 1.5 per cent.

The stock settled at ₹322.95 on the BSE and NSE, marking nearly 11 per cent listing loss.

Marcellus gets SEBI final nod to launch MF biz

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Marcellus Investment Managers said it has received final approval from SEBI to commence its MF business.

The approval will allow the AMC to expand its research-led, long-term investment approach beyond its existing PMS and AIF offerings to a wider base of investors, the company said.

Founded in 2018, Marcellus said its platform will enable it to participate in India's growing MF industry and tap a larger pool of household savings. "Our focus now is on building a fund house that puts investors first, with disciplined processes, clear communication and a strong focus on execution," Pramod Gubbi, MD and CEO, Marcellus Mutual Fund, said.

Promoters dilute 6% stake in Avalon Tech for ₹871 cr

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

Three promoter entities of Avalon Technologies pared their shareholding by 6 per cent for ₹871 crore through separate bulk deals on Wednesday.

Bhaskar Srinivasan, KBS Family Trust and BBS Family Trust sold 13.36 lakh shares each, representing a combined 6 per cent stake in Chennai-based Avalon Technologies at prices ranging from ₹2,171.03-2,173.35 apiece, according to BSE data. The sale reduced the combined holding of promoters to 38.4 per cent from 44.39 per cent.

Meanwhile, Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund bought 24.01 lakh shares, or 3.59 per cent, in electronic manufacturing services firm Avalon Technologies, at an average price of ₹2,171. The other buyers could not be identified from the exchange data.

Avalon Technologies shares closed 0.49 per cent lower at ₹2,294.50 on the BSE.

TPG SELLS SHADOWFAX

Separately, global investment firm TPG's arm Newquest Asia Fund IV (Singapore) Pte sold 40 lakh shares, or 0.68 per cent stake in logistics firm Shadowfax Technologies for nearly ₹113.61 crore through an open market transaction.

The shares were sold at ₹284.03 apiece, taking Newquest's holding to 10.85 per cent from 11.53 per cent. TPG's arm will, however, continue to be the largest public shareholder.

Shadowfax Technologies shares ended marginally lower at ₹280.50 on the BSE.

BROKER'S CALL.

Emkay Global Services

ICICI LOMBARD GIC (ADD)
Target: ₹1,900
CMP: ₹1,583
'We attended ICICI Lombard's 'Digital Day 2026', where the senior management showcased the company's proprietary digital stack, cloud native digital architecture and AI-led operating flywheel. The transition — from viewing technology as a supportive back-office function to positioning it at the forefront of business generation — along with risk selection has enhanced operational agility and cost structures.
ICICIGI's fully in-house technology stack now powers a digital flywheel across distribution, product, risk, claims servicing and retention.
The regulatory recalibration of distribution economics, as led by IRDAI's proposed commission caps and tighter EoM limits, is set to trigger a structural reset across the industry. By eliminating aggressive commission-led distribution, the reforms transition the intermediary landscape to an environment where brand equity, digital execution and claims servicing reliability dominate the shelf space.
The management sees these reforms as a long-term positive for multi-product, multi-channel insurers like ICICIGI. While pricing can be commoditised, operational scale and servicing efficiency will emerge as primary competitive moats. By FY29, ICICIGI targets achieving 100-200bps growth alpha vs the industry, digital sourcing share of 15 per cent, a sustained 10ppt + CoR advantage over the industry, and 17-20 per cent ROE.
We reiterate ADD on the stock and retain September 2027E TP of ₹1,900.

Motilal Oswal Research

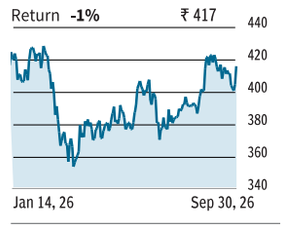
TORRENT POWER (NEUTRAL)
Target: ₹1,270
CMP: ₹1,245.60
We initiate coverage on Torrent Power (TPL) with a Neutral rating and an SoTP-based TP of ₹1,270. The company holds licences for distribution in Gujarat's major cities and Dadra & Nagar Haveli/Daman & Diu (about 2,050 sq km), in addition to franchisee operations (1,007 sq km).
TPL aims to expand its total RE portfolio to about 6.3G Wp by FY29 from about 2.1 GWp currently operational (1.8 GW contracted). In the Q1FY27 earnings call, the management noted that TPL plans to commission 1.2 GWp in FY27 and 1.4-1.6 GWp in FY28. In FY26, the transmission and distribution business contributed about 62 per cent of EBITDA, with the licenced distribution business recording a distribution loss of only 2.3 per cent with power availability of 99.9 per cent. TPL's distribution loss is significantly lower than that of Tata Power (5-19 per cent in Delhi/Odisha), Adani Energy (about 4 per cent), and CESC (6-8 per cent in Kolkata, Noida and Chandigarh). Overall, we build in a CAGR of 17 per cent/7 per cent in EBITDA/APAT over FY26-29E. As per our estimates, 37 per cent of FY29E EBITDA will be attributable to the RE business, in which contracted generation capacity is set to grow from 1.8 GW as of Q1FY27-end to 4.5 GW by FY29-end.
TPL is currently trading at FY27E EV/EBITDA of 13.6x vs its historical one-year forward average of 8.4x EV/EBITDA. TPL's EBITDA CAGR of 18 per cent over FY26-28E compares with 25 per cent for JSW Energy and 27 per cent for Tata Power.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

Kotak Mahindra Bank (₹417.60): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term outlook is bullish for Kotak Mahindra Bank. The stock has risen well in the last couple of days. This rise is significant as it has happened from 100-Day Moving Average, currently at ₹396. Immediate support is at ₹406. Below that, ₹400-396 is the next important support zone.

We expect the stock to sustain above ₹406 itself. Intermediate resistance is at ₹440. Kotak Mahindra Bank share price can breach this hurdle and rise to ₹460 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Kotak Mahindra Bank shares now at ₹418. Accumulate on dips at ₹408. Keep the stop-loss at ₹392. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹425 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹433. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹435 and ₹445 when the price touches ₹443 and ₹455 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹460.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

22705 » **Nifty 50 Futures**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
22640	22560	22780	22900	Go short on a rise at 22760. Keep the stop-loss at 22820

₹709 » **HDFC Bank**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
705	699	715	721	Take fresh shorts below 705. Keep the stop-loss at 707

₹995 » **Infosys**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
975	958	1010	1025	Go short now and at 1005. Stop-loss can be kept at 1015

₹262 » **ITC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
259	257	264	266	Go short now and at 263. Stop-loss can be placed at 265

₹224 » **ONGC**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
221	218	226	229	Go short now and at 225. Stop-loss can be placed at 227

₹1186 » **Reliance Ind.**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1180	1145	1200	1225	Take fresh shorts below 1180. Keep the stop-loss at 1185

₹962 » **SBI**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
960	954	967	973	Go short only below 960. Keep the stop-loss at 962

₹2056 » **TCS**

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2035	2000	2070	2095	Go short now and at 2065. Stop-loss can be placed at 2075

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers

▼ 95.75 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
ICICI Bank	1321.70	45.69	15.88	9.05
Kotak Bank	417.00	17.50	20.44	2.93
Axis Bank	1226.00	8.64	13.66	3.37
Reliance Ind	1187.00	7.22	18.22	7.58
IntGlobeAvi	4984.00	5.48	0.00	1.08
TCS	2050.60	4.02	14.82	2.00
Shriram Finance Ltd.	982.70	3.39	20.43	1.32
UltraTech Cement	10956.00	3.25	37.67	1.24
Hind Unilever	1879.10	2.93	42.07	1.59
L&T	3760.00	2.76	26.36	4.20
Maruti Suzuki	11967.00	2.53	26.25	1.49
Tech Mahindra	1524.00	1.85	28.93	0.92
HCL Tech	1230.00	1.82	19.15	1.24
Bajaj Auto	10874.00	1.49	25.87	1.13
Tata Motors PV	283.50	1.15	0.00	0.57
Bharat Elec	388.30	0.43	46.17	1.33
M&M	2950.00	0.42	18.12	2.52
Coal India	425.00	0.00	8.40	0.97
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	216.88	-0.48	69.30	0.68
HDFC Life	521.20	-0.55	57.33	0.54
NTPC	322.75	-0.77	11.05	1.47
Eicher Motors	7150.00	-0.86	34.00	0.94
Trent Ltd.	2621.60	-0.96	77.04	0.83
PowerGrid Corp	260.50	-0.98	15.24	1.13
Asian Paints	2402.60	-1.21	47.64	1.04
Bajaj Finserv	1731.00	-1.43	13.44	0.96
Dr Reddys Lab	1233.00	-2.49	32.33	0.72
TataConsumerProduct	949.50	-2.56	57.22	0.59
Grasim Ind	3061.90	-3.11	18.31	1.10
ONGC	225.80	-3.53	6.34	0.84
SBI Life	1696.40	-3.75	65.45	0.73
JSW Steel	1253.40	-3.95	10.95	1.15
Adani Ports	1798.30	-4.01	31.58	1.35
Cipla	1346.00	-4.05	32.40	0.72
Hindalco	941.80	-4.19	12.91	1.30
State Bank	959.50	-4.64	9.88	3.79
ITC	262.75	-4.90	16.31	2.42
Adani Enter	2903.40	-5.09	52.31	0.94
NestleIndia	1310.00	-5.53	66.28	0.90
Tata Steel	184.30	-6.63	20.43	1.46
Titan	4587.00	-7.86	70.70	1.81
Max Healthcare	929.80	-8.41	62.10	0.66
Bajaj Finance	959.40	-8.49	28.93	2.50
Bharti Airtel	1757.00	-9.33	30.11	5.10
BSE Ltd	3092.00	-9.54	44.70	1.21
Apollo Hosp	8165.50	-10.98	54.05	0.80
Sun Pharma	1816.60	-11.08	35.97	1.84
Eternal Ltd.	320.00	-12.29	713.19	2.22
Infosys	994.10	-16.26	13.30	3.35
HDFC Bank	708.70	-46.37	13.24	10.38

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▲ 286.75 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	Wt(%)
Adani Power .	204.00	91.51	27.07	3.48
Solar Industries	19700.00	73.05	86.94	1.97
Hindustanaeronautics	4668.00	64.32	33.49	3.63
Samvardmothersoninternatl	163.26	59.31	37.83	2.95
Dlf	674.00	38.46	37.53	1.77
Indian Oilcorp	134.93	38.42	5.33	2.06
Bosch	47100.00	34.69	58.79	1.67
Hdfc Amc	2280.70	33.48	33.20	1.91
Ltimindtree	4045.00	28.91	23.09	1.54
Union Bank	171.00	27.59	6.32	1.35
Avenuesuper	3801.40	23.69	81.09	2.51
Bajaj Holdings	10788.00	23.25	13.35	1.91
Bpcl	303.20	22.07	7.68	2.49
Abb India	6776.00	17.32	92.33	1.46
Adanigreenenergy	1278.00	17.24	98.09	1.75
Bank Of Baroda	230.55	15.21	6.48	1.75
Ambuja Cements	374.00	14.69	17.92	0.95
Wipro	158.50	13.23	11.82	1.76
Punjab Natl Bank	113.06	12.89	5.87	1.59
Tvs Motor Cmp .	4106.00	10.00	54.17	3.95
Adani Energy Solutions .	1314.60	8.20	52.02	1.76
Varun Beverages .	432.00	7.81	42.86	2.42
Power Finance	325.50	5.82	3.19	1.94
Mazagoan Dock	2113.00	5.62	29.87	0.66
Jindal Steel	1134.90	5.19	42.74	1.72
Siemens	3725.60	3.94	91.32	1.35
Gail (India)	170.55	3.93	11.36	1.88
Hindus Zinc	566.00	3.71	14.01	1.11
Pidilitind	1465.10	3.64	55.73	1.86
Siemens Energy India .	3200.00	0.25	76.59	1.16
Muthootfin	2737.10	0.09	9.59	1.20
Tata Power	359.00	0.00	21.82	2.47
Canara Bank	119.44	-0.67	5.46	1.64
Britannia Ind	4830.00	-1.68	44.57	2.33
Hitachi Energy	30630.00	-3.82	118.68	1.60
Vedanta	259.00	-5.03	6.07	1.87
Tata Capital	327.95	-5.34	25.41	0.74
Godrej Consumer	850.00	-5.74	45.46	1.40
Indian Railway Finance Corp	79.28	-6.27	14.41	0.73
Cg Power & Ind Sol	854.20	-7.54	108.69	2.40
Cholamandalamin&Fin	1620.00	-9.04	24.07	2.88
Polycab India	8026.00	-11.68	41.63	1.76
Cummins Inida	4760.00	-15.43	55.74	2.63
Zyduslifesciences	1162.00	-27.25	25.24	1.18
Hyundai Motor India .	2031.00	-28.04	33.33	1.18
Torrent Pharma	4800.00	-39.51	84.68	2.89
Idea Cellular	12.95	-47.97	3.75	1.46
Divis Lab	9291.50	-50.64	84.33	4.84
Tata Motors Cv	421.65	-50.78	37.09	3.61
Vedanta Aluminium	412.90	-104.34	0.00	2.87

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

DoorDash opens talent hub with 500 employees

Hyderabad: The US-based local commerce platform DoorDash has opened its first office in India with 500 employees. It plans to take the headcount to over 3,000 in the next two years. The hub will handle customer support for consumers, merchants and delivery partners (Dashers) across DoorDash's markets. OUR BUREAU

Linux Laboratories secures $70 m funding

New Delhi: Domestic formulations company Linux Laboratories has secured $70 million in equity capital from ChrysCapital and Tata Capital Healthcare Fund III. ChrysCapital acquired a significant minority stake in the Chennai-headquartered firm. This will fund Linux's expansion into core specialities, adjacent therapies, brand acquisitions, and manufacturing and R&D capabilities. PTI

One dead, 9 injured in MRPL blast; fire under control

INITIAL ASSESSMENT. The refinery's output not likely to be hit in the near term

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

A blast was reported at the coker hydro treating unit (CHTU) of MRPL (Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Ltd) in Mangaluru at around 12.15 pm on Wednesday.

One person was killed and nine were injured in the incident. The fire has been brought under control at the plant.

Though the exact impact of the damage to CHTU is yet to be assessed, initial reports indicate the refinery's output would not be hit in the near term.

BLAST AFTERMATH. Smoke emitting from the place following the blast at the MRPL unit in Mangaluru

MRPL STATEMENT
MRPL said in a statement that an incident involving the rupture of the 'Cold Separator' operating at high pressure in the CHTU occurred at MRPL, resulting in a fire. The battery limits of the affected unit have been isolated. MRPL's emergency response and firefighting teams controlled and doused the fire. The situation is being closely monitored, with safety of personnel and the facility being accorded the highest priority. The firefighting operation may continue for some time as part of the safe handling of the incident. A spokesperson of MRPL said the fire was put off at 2.47 pm on Wednesday, and there is no impact on operations at MRPL.

The total throughput of MRPL was 4.43 million tonnes (mt) during the first quarter of 2026-27 against 3.52 mt in the corresponding period of 2025-26. MRPL's throughput stood at 16.77 mt in 2025-26.

VISUAL INSPECTION
On the advice of the Dakshina Kannada district administration, the airport conducted a visual inspection of all vital installations in and around the airport, including the Precision Approach Lighting Category 1 systems and peripheral roads, for their operational readiness.

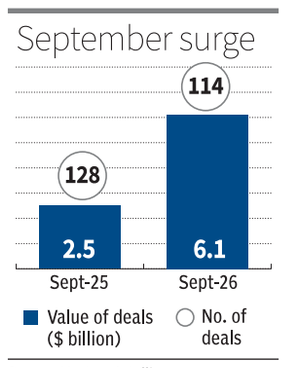
An airport spokesperson said that there is no damage to infrastructure at Mangaluru airport.

PE-VC investments hit four-year high at $6.1 b across 114 deals in September

Rohan Das
Chennai

Private Equity-Venture Capital (PE-VC) investments saw a surge in September, rising to $6.1 billion across 114 deals— the highest monthly investment level in over four years.

September investments were up 25 per cent from $4.9 billion across 103 deals in August 2026, while more than twice the $2.5 billion invested across 128 deals in September 2025, as per data from research firm Venture Intelligence. It was also the highest recorded in a single month since 2022, when PE-VC investments stood at $6.2 billion.



Source: Venture Intelligence

MEGA DEALS
The momentum was driven by a surge in mega deals (over $100 million) both in terms of value and volume, with 12 such deals in September 2026, that led to more than $4.9 billion in proceeds, markedly higher than the $1.35 billion in 8 deals in the same month last year.

The largest investment in the month was Canadian investment group La Caisse's purchase of a 24 per cent stake in Altius Telecom Infrastructure Trust (Altius), India's largest independent telecom tower platform, for $1.3 billion.

Other major deals included private airport operator Adani Airport Holdings from the Adani Group raising $1 billion from Alpha Wave Global, Premji Invest, Temasek and BlackRock-managed funds as well as global investment company Brookfield's $600 million investment in renewable energy major ACME Cleantech Ventures. Meanwhile, a resurgence in PE-VC activity in June, July and August has helped investments reach $31.6 billion across 1,042 deals in 2026 year-to-date as against $39 billion across 1,425 deals in the whole of 2025.

EARLY-STAGE FIRMS
Investments in early-stage companies dropped to $226 million in September 2026, down from $326 million in September 2025. Growth-stage investments doubled to $1.7 billion as against $850 million. Average cheques for early-stage investments stood at $4 million, while for the growth stage, it was $56 million ($25 million). For the late stage, it went up to $61 million ($46 million).

US to hike EB-5 Green Card fees

Press Trust of India
Washington

The US has decided to drastically increase fees for immigrants seeking to invest in the country and eventually claim permanent residency under the EB-5 investor programme.

This remains one of the most reliable ways for Indian entrepreneurs and families to obtain a Green Card.

The US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) finalised a rule on Tuesday that seeks to more than double the fees for applying to the EB-5 visa. The rule will be effective November 30.

US EB-5
The US EB-5 Immigrant Investor Programme grants permanent residency (Green Card) to foreign investors and their immediate families who invest capital into a US commercial enterprise and create 10 full-time jobs for American workers. The filing fee for Form I-526, used by standalone investors, will rise from $3,675 to $7,615. The fee for an initial Form I-526E petition, used by investors participating through an approved regional centre, will increase from $3,675 to $7,850.

Initial I-526 and I-526E petitions will also include a $75 technology fee.

The fee for Form I-829, filed by investors seeking to remove conditions on their permanent resident status, will increase from $3,750 to $5,000. Charges imposed on regional centres will rise more sharply. The fee for an initial Form I-956 application seeking regional-centre designation will increase from $17,795 to $44,115. The charge for Form I-956F, used to seek approval of an investment in a commercial enterprise, will rise to $42,675 from $17,795. The annual fee for Form I-956G will decrease from $3,035 to $2,165. The final rule also establishes Form I-527 for certain investors seeking to amend older Form I-526 petitions. The new filing will cost $10,330. Announcing the new fees, the USCIS said in a press release that the agency is largely funded by the fees it charges, rather than taxes.

BACKLOG DEVELOPED
"This means the cost of reviewing applications, conducting background checks, verifying eligibility, detecting fraud and maintaining programme operations must be paid by those who use the immigration system," the release said. However, like most employment-based immigration categories, EB-5 visas are subject to annual caps and country limits.

As demand from India has increased dramatically over the past decade, a backlog has developed that affects how long investors may wait for a Green Card.

Simple Energy raises ₹1,750 crore in Series C

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

EV-maker Simple Energy has raised ₹1,750 crore in its Series C round, led by the family office of Arokiaswamy Velumani, with participation from Founder and CEO Suhas Rajkumar, Co-Founder and CFO Ankit Gupta, Bengaluru-based HNI Amit Mishra and the Haran Family Office.

The latest round is the company's largest funding raise to date, coming three months after its ₹250-crore Series B round in June. The fundraise also follows Simple Energy's entry into the family scooter segment with the launch of Simple Wave.

With the latest round, Simple Energy's total capital raised has crossed ₹2,530 crore from family offices, HNIs and other investors.

'Phones below ₹10,000 saw sharpest hikes in H1 2026'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Phones priced below ₹10,000 saw the sharpest hikes of around 32 per cent on average in the first half of 2026, as per Counterpoint Research.

Memory now makes up a much bigger share of what these devices cost to build, pushing India's average smartphone selling price to a record $318 in Q2 2026.

AI data centres have been soaking up DRAM and NAND supply, and a weaker rupee has made imported components more expensive, leaving most brands with little to no choice but raise prices through the first half of the year.

As such, shipments in the sub-₹10,000 segment fell 65 per cent year-on-year in H1 2026.

Consumers in the entry and budget segments are now turning to 4G devices for better specifications and value at a lower price, as per another finding by the firm.

4G RESURGENCE. Consumers in the entry and budget segments are now turning to 4G devices

SHIFTING PRIORITIES
OEMs are expanding their 4G portfolios into the ₹10,000-20,000 band to cater to this demand and fill the gaps created, as 5G models move up the price ladder.

Meanwhile, the ₹10,000-15,000 band, known as one of the biggest in the market, dropped 20 per cent.

Phones above ₹20,000 kept growing, helped by higher launch prices, trade-in offers and no-cost EMIs that made pricier devices easier to afford. According to Senior Analyst Prachir Singh said, "India's 4G recovery is increasingly extending beyond the traditional entry-level segment, with demand gaining momentum across the sub-₹20,000 price range. The ₹10,000-20,000 segment is emerging as a key growth area as consumers seek better specifications and device experiences without the higher price associated with 5G. OEMs are responding to this shift by expanding their 4G portfolios beyond the entry segment."

As of 2026, 12 OEMs offer 4G models in the budget price band from just two in 2025.

ONEPLUS APPROACH
Interestingly, while most brands passed a large share of the costs on to buyers, OnePlus raised smartphone prices by 8 per cent on average in H1 2026.

Its biggest single price increase was 12 per cent compared with 113 per cent for the rest of the industry, so the gap held not just on average but at the extremes as well. Counterpoint expects this trend to continue in Q3 2026.

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Participate through **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in** . For details Contact: **9447701332,9847504867**
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CIAL/COMMN/CGCC/CCTV **TENDER NOTICE** 01-10-2026
Online item rates e-tenders are invited from reputed agencies for the work mentioned below at Cochin International Airport.

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Estimate Amount	EMD	Completion Period
1	SITC of CCTV, LAN and Wi-Fi Infrastructure at CIAL Golf and Country Club	Rs. 1.75 Crore + GST	Rs. 3.50 Lakh	06 Months

Interested firms may register themselves on the online E-Tendering portal https://etenders.kerala.gov.in and then download the Tender documents. For eligibility criteria and other details, visit our website www.cial.aero
Sd/-
MANAGING DIRECTOR

TATA
TATA POWER
(Corporate Contracts Department)
The Tata Power Company Limited, Smart Center of Procurement Excellence, 2nd Floor, Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Sahar Airport Road Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173917) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)
The Tata Power Company Limited invites tender from eligible vendors for the following tender package (Two-part Bidding) in Mumbai Distribution.
1. OLA for Execution of Rehabilitation Works for DSS (Ref: CC27AAM025)
2. Fire system work at Ramtekdi DSS, City Zone (Ref: CC27AAM026)
3. OLA for Providing HDD Services for Mumbai Distribution (Ref CC27AS022)
4. OLA for RI work at Mumbai Distribution (Ref CC27AAM027)

Interested bidders to submit Tender Fee, Authorization Letter and bid submission up to **21.10.2026**. For detailed NIT & Tender Document, please visit Tender section on website **https://www.tatapower.com**. Also, all future corrigendum's (if any), to the above tenders shall be informed on website **https://www.tatapower.com** only.

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(20-11-26): TAMBA; PET4SGL90889405, 41231580, 92191216, 94563112, 94587392, 44709066. TAMLUK - MECHEDA HALDIA ROAD; PQN4EGL93037187, 43477455, 95281867. Tandur - Indira Chowk; PDA6SGL23594240, 32026225, 35080512, 90833587, 91295928, 91426609, 93186979, 93524389, 93859091, 94380925, 43437814, 95348249, 95330789, 43768088, 96062082, 44323079, 44507914, 96703337, 44663916, 97024848, 96999705, 45083011, 97640087, 45422132. Tangi - Main Road; PG01EGL91407229, 42478256, 42484595, 94895134, 43593724, 44689181, 97568586. TANKARA - LATIPAR CHOWKDI; PLG9WGL93830777, 93951465, 97661700. TARANAGAR - RAJGARH ROAD; PQF1GOL91126120. TARAORI - SOUOUNKRA ROAD; PGP5GOL41291288, 41460666, 92997122, 94305347, 94620676, 94923652, 95285086, 44063957, 96467393, 45063815, 45025684, 45096932. Tarapur - Khambhat Highway; PB46GOL41577866, 43256168, 44333323, 96521973, 96773609, 97264122, 97558200. TAURU - SOHNA ROAD; PRZ4WGL93890755. 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Tiptur - B H Road; PG07SGL90861651, 90804901, 91069689, 91157197, 41017896, 91765438, 92126147, 92185461, 41623008, 92691447, 93178242, 93431775, 93419895, 93985010, 93831384, 93861955, 94382333, 94586867, 94627594, 94636190, 43097894, 94840272, 95106636, 95130744, 95278654, 95353497, 95523531, 96052464, 95957945, 96202728, 96535551, 96524345, 96720943, 96738520, 96708998, 96743633, 96744632, 97165100, 97589135, 97701821, 97614108, 97616228. TITLAGARH - BELGAN ROAD; PRG6EGL91069103, 91793183, 92651579, 92903368, 93019565, 93214244, 94678645, 94940389, 94908353, 94836499, 94931414, 94824588, 95112322, 96218104, 96555106, 96460407, 96719138, 97265967. TOHANA - CHANDIGARH ROAD; PPW2WGL91836210, 94882517. Tonk - Najar Bag Road; PG06GOL91137940, 40782953, 92699205, 94290691, 43092109, 96689001. TOOPRAN - RAMAYAMPET ROAD; PJT5SGL95099069, 43581617, 95518124, 95527492, 97622144. TOSHAM - BGL; PNX9GOL31020277, 31387602, 32824750, 40774303, 40757229, 92101003, 92113590, 92607508, 93420579, 93832784, 43284378, 43464419, 96696559. TULJAPUR - NALDURG ROAD; PLI1GOL32480090, 33328194, 40770943, 91410154, 92587175, 92663899, 92682313, 93423034, 93499420, 43085868, 95125906, 43413153, 95358464, 95541923, 95533214, 96016357, 44113289, 96320278, 96223880, 96532625, 44549760, 44475018, 96744267, 96726191, 97168186, 44967654, 45041463, 97677223. Tumkur - B H Road; PEL1SGL17164465, 91398123, 92643266, 92901358, 93447618, 93912615, 93929345, 95330623, 95623661, 96067618, 96516114, 96796316, 96953682. TURKAYAMJAL - RAGHAVENDRA NAGAR; PLP1SGL91136512, 41278707, 94871276, 95973022, 96311111, 96724078, 96714610, 96977825, 96983600, 96940480, 97157570. TUTICORIN - BGL; PNS3SGL40564251, 91044064, 91268188, 91255345, 92918969, 42057539, 93981595, 42627291. Udaipurwati - Jaipur Road; PEX6GOL40520444, 90821294, 91289111, 40945222, 93039397, 41902203, 93663045, 94276166, 94592044, 43078568, 43093890, 94899076, 94837586, 95120729, 95078243, 95136826, 95375051, 44163644, 96244169, 96202042, 44293639, 96938674, 97186067, 45053998. UDGIR - MONDHA ROAD; PQS2GOL31206625, 31746791, 90900053, 90926290, 91053974, 91443313, 92747678, 93980313, 93911550, 94353688, 94265366, 42904090, 94872584, 94884763, 95105074, 95328833, 96535243, 97676435. UDUMALAIPETTAI - TIRUPPUR ROAD; PRW1SGL90872476, 92623263, 92933938, 93257825, 93245425, 93207953, 93224704. Ujjain - Freeganj; PCP4GOL40512482, 91276930, 91251377, 91281389, 92201193, 92635182, 93207022, 93881644, 93895472, 93914231, 42645779, 94655974, 94867306, 94875865, 43257577, 43300093, 43475537, 43436404, 95292313, 95338342, 43586148, 43638120, 96058080, 95960347, 96041666, 96274648, 96238425, 96284052, 96528269, 97548746, 97590348. UJJAIN - INDORE ROAD; PUK4EGL97229952. ULUBERIA - BAZAR PARA; PTA5EGL90851336, 92644097, 92978150, 94270442, 94612908, 94603179, 94855981, 95089209, 95344836, 95396466, 96288767, 97645984. UMERKOTE - GULIPATNA; PJE3SGL30220568, 31790400, 33572960, 90841476, 40801000, 91251834, 41041980, 91862505, 91735901, 41600317, 92596687, 93011475, 93203040, 93463380, 93429668, 42476411, 93877026, 94393938, 94628568, 94846519, 95084955, 95058833, 43457547, 43447301, 95316875, 95392212, 43581256, 96013711, 96303535, 96452697, 96931650, 97663830. UMMEDABAD; PO10GOL92679135, 92597066, 95937384, 44106568, 44327847, 44330706, 96975655. UMRA; PG32PFI90903302, 40883961, 91880346, 92629753, 92890087, 42218949, 95297879, 95565186, 44697437, 96957101, 97201884. UNA - GIR GADHADA ROAD; PMV9GOL29629256, 34314603, 90840629, 40798116, 93187602, 42317245, 42462295, 94425067, 94904817, 96037506, 44332148, 96965108. Una - Hamirpur Road; PGS6GOL31628060, 90923318, 90832254, 91085133, 91315645, 91305501, 41018652, 91711296, 41248376, 93543520, 94284791, 94375786, 42960316, 42966567, 95172612, 95144927, 95307108, 43585945, 43651225, 43819559, 96051332, 96006476, 96476787, 97593161. UNNAO - ADARSH NAGAR; PPG8GOL91278487, 41593165, 41872828, 93554401, 42229922, 42350394, 93990875, 93939590, 95063062, 95936340, 96241454, 96501550, 96482296, 96959947, 97631261, 97563300. URULI KANCHAN - MAIN ROAD; PQU7WGL91070075, 93461641, 95382770, 95278456, 96701645, 97178869. USILAMPATTI - PERAIYUR ROAD; PRX8SGL90937621, 91046319, 92624221, 93960289, 96951839, 96972112. VADALI MFI GL; PG40PFI32733536, 91260537, 43153133. VADGAM - PALANPUR HIGHWAY; PKA6GOL33069112, 34277996, 91122051, 91089604, 91271127, 91710840, 92601053, 42046370, 94628078, 94601881, 94639496, 43131813, 95097022, 95081687, 95069322, 96077487, 97638290. VADJAI; PF38PFI42320524, 43764666. Vadodara - Raopura; PB41GOL19472898, 30023367, 31610563, 32516187, 91118146, 91324287, 91457357, 41461858, 92615230, 93504426, 93715269, 93696069, 42467647, 94389594, 94445862, 94453568, 94664518, 43586062, 96040334, 44706708, 44675242, 97666541. VAIJAPUR - STATION ROAD; PJA6WGL90855795, 91144768, 91106038, 91308913, 41043572, 91900747, 92612404, 93021871, 92990117, 93154860, 93468457, 93854006, 94373641, 94327645, 42917566, 42860232, 94596329, 94658092, 94656917, 94584841, 94624245, 43296020, 95088855, 96049495, 96036797, 44108871, 96229795, 96274625, 44305693, 96462476, 96478024, 96751917, 44662491, 44697939, 97246815, 97598811, 97540362, 97663315. VALLIYUR NORTH MAIN ROAD I; PJJ5SGL91867445, 91843919, 91824247, 91685611, 91797709, 94003183, 93959885, 94302381, 95599467, 96204445, 96723556, 97635637. Valsad - Bus Depo; PEM8GOL40496132, 92613745, 42070717, 42029213, 95097406, 43425369, 45394555. VANSDA MFI GL; PG24PFI97698390. VAPI - BGL; PNR1GOL40534215, 91923274, 93177988, 42083729, 42229592, 93738390, 94950403, 94903102, 96033873, 96535219, 96525789, 96539232. VARVADA; PAG4PFI93988476, 44320449, 44323607. Vashi - Sector Nine; PEP8GOL32921465, 40943048, 93548665, 93937435, 94395193, 94701583, 95074078, 95114426, 95384503, 96545600, 96802378. VAZHAPADI - THAMMAMPATTI MAIN ROAD; PKL5SGL91139870, 91092739, 91288758, 91290701, 91284247, 91744073, 92653838, 92648715, 92753585, 92763808, 92934549, 92973921, 93465565, 93926768, 94304826, 94587933, 95093703, 95353635, 95340798, 95347591, 96006079, 96491468, 96731540, 96764081, 97615469. VELLORE - ARCOT; PKJ9SGL30059416, 90832925, 90840093, 91115631, 91119466, 91124956, 91848732, 91799449, 91834384, 91733099, 91825821, 91808719, 92947324, 93508206, 94846733, 95113060, 96012741, 96028270, 96021234, 96716857, 96956284, 97656400. Vellore - Bharathi Nagar; PEL2SGL91258822, 93196183, 94300819, 95094587, 95592823, 96500760, 96803256, 97266668, 97694538. VELLORE - GUDIYATTAM; PQT2SGL92067453, 92935608, 93198307, 93273042, 93850653, 94595755, 95316410, 95306693, 95355886, 96220727, 96312230, 96230231, 96728919, 97672785. VELLORE - SANKARANPALAYAM ROAD; PJI9SGL92162299, 42030785, 93831367, 94920060, 95547746, 96267225. Veraval - ST Station Road; P21IGOL31222316, 32344703, 40538044, 90899251, 90891240, 91100318, 40771953, 91294360, 41224797, 92200578, 92605260, 93473803, 93421120, 42460470, 94327643, 94296220, 94356736, 94586654, 94576150, 43282678, 43431024, 43449562, 95276008, 43602665, 43570690, 43658571, 95540594, 96031005, 44153417, 96311731, 96208668, 44296644, 96499171, 44488631, 96736124, 44659637, 44685297, 96953713, 97569375. VIDISHA - KHARI FATAK ROAD; POX9EGL90888400, 93163779, 94348213, 95337598, 96220226, 97233928. Vidisha - Sanchi Road; PCP5EGL93863044, 95180451, 96024262, 96277277, 96708070, 97196793. VIJAYPURA - CHIKKABALLAPUR ROAD; PSZ5SGL91110823, 91118346, 91243585, 92703691, 92689636, 92701320, 92997137, 94289441, 94564293, 95063813, 95282536, 95518935, 95984509, 96926320, 97158111, 97215746, 97614176. VIKAS NAGAR - MAIN MARKET; POQ8WGL90903957, 91152954, 91414941, 93689204, 93701977, 93838115, 96956853, 97679884, 97694343, 97553454. VINCHHIYA - AMBALI CHOCK; PIX7GOL16068075, 34836079, 91404339, 91686472, 41124138, 41460930, 93178901, 42021240, 93456817, 42190093, 42462411, 95094378, 95362450, 96240800, 44700500, 97215323, 97573796. VINCHUR; PG46PFI43417330, 44973580, 45366006. VIRAMGAM - MANDAL ROAD; PLG7WGL91817864, 91848458, 92962024, 93228755, 42355146, 94355994, 43262063, 95304954, 44149271, 96296307, 44472704, 44691109. VIRAR WEST - COLLEGE ROAD; PQW4WGL97721475. VIROL; PAE6PFI13676786, 91125999, 91063227, 93697438, 93846391, 96579363, 96785130, 44729004, 44669040, 44646352. VIRUDHACHALAM - BGL; PNS7SGL92771405, 93243583, 93554439, 94387624, 96765620, 96987195, 96965563. Virudhunagar - Pullakottai Road; PEQ5SGL29711583, 91123215, 91280003, 91286132, 92645163, 95325859. VISNAGAR MFI GL; PAG1PFI92696890, 42593252, 95635157, 97278835. VIZAG - RAMATALKIES ROAD; PRU2SGL91117488, 91253972, 92163412, 92674552, 92634388, 93258818, 93273978, 94406849, 94596436, 95155481, 95147672, 95129003, 95284157, 95601426, 96040765, 96978865, 96969176, 97197704, 97691198. Vizag - Ravindra Nagar; PI95SGL34588867, 90902942, 90907777, 90844163, 90896467, 90910701, 90884868, 91400225, 91406106, 92093015, 41587608, 41583629, 92677285, 92743657, 92603012, 92627938, 93047386, 93230027, 93256888, 93289296, 93326507, 93476915, 42474224, 42467161, 42591287, 42906923, 42908719, 94664290, 43159440, 94822707, 95577296, 95570540, 96050634, 96212160, 96269584, 96216692, 96202170, 96443030, 44514267, 97020314, 97182695, 97265945, 97234427, 97275719, 97582376. Vizianagaram - Fort A G ROAD; PBX1SGL90909904, 91152969, 91290193, 91322259, 91292915, 91264610, 92078657, 92615534, 93880028, 93953057, 93850076, 94323022, 94868934, 94821984, 95139084, 95077376, 95349053, 95380234, 95537011, 95965165, 96051809, 96758311, 96928826, 97669388, 45392716. Vizianagaram - MG Road; PCZ4SGL90920806, 90935228, 91287229, 91389815, 41586141, 93212510, 93256168, 93501583, 94414871, 94313927, 94845261, 95515957, 96758836, 96754452, 97191235, 97168122, 97664739, 97656654. VYAPAR - VIHAR BILASPUR; PLI7EGL91873691, 91850291, 92669202, 94402618, 94709937, 43097536, 96742512. WADHWANCITY - MARKET ROAD; PLG6WGL90843958, 91434254, 91864388, 93238861, 95341059, 95314744, 95515100, 96548039, 97624980, 45381886. Waluj - Maharana Pratap Chowk; PGS8GOL19430596, 30774765, 33795270, 34840978, 41037272, 41858218, 42465683, 94405847, 43082365, 96201859, 44286591, 96942813. Wanaparthi - Rajeev Chowk; PCX9SGL91113600, 91235308, 41061886, 92112099, 92121794, 92130811, 92213913, 92760246, 92611352, 92631833, 42047368, 93483126, 93502678, 94398778, 43077660, 94862698, 95083700, 96080913, 44336280, 96701375, 44678568. Wani - Jatashankar Chowk; PEI1WGL92953899, 93203220, 93413125, 42483655, 94467336, 94301157, 94288423, 94386348, 94619306, 43156009, 94918123, 95372555, 96017879, 44657810, 97168112, 44993825. Warangal - Subedari; PB55SGL90809756, 90872415, 90890989, 91105943, 91073675, 91781285, 92185298, 92168321, 92221485, 92619469, 92650634, 92963279, 94328198, 94569072, 94686340, 95984921. Wardha - Main Road; PGM1GOL17046377, 21777514, 40521602, 90880686, 91064290, 91443383, 91839917, 92194033, 92642013, 93004596, 92935115, 41888853, 93195550, 93156662, 93444107, 93462497, 42365652, 93939018, 94340777, 94356163, 42854056, 94624738, 94628908, 94606018, 94667651, 95102710, 95066191, 95080427, 43443055, 95379654, 95565200, 43786328, 96206900, 96288522, 44324935, 96450509, 96443189, 96773375, 96757803, 44678896, 96940538, 97006055, 97177170, 97207496, 97619338, 97572212, 45418759. Warud - Indira Chowk; PGK4WGL90875406, 90899850, 91082909, 91148009, 91711421, 91808827, 92641053, 92647902, 92988148, 93433897, 94639495, 94604765, 94598409, 94608647, 95150699, 95077680, 96217442, 96486165, 96726652, 96990536, 96950238, 97197969, 97614081, 97630941. WAVI MFI GL; PG59PFI40510145, 90798762, 91290056, 92179958, 93221934, 94677558, 94701649, 94644718, 94858712, 94827202, 94912457, 43271888, 96054255, 96289961, 96276110, 96444390, 96689057, 97201587, 97555971. YADGIR - HYDRABAD ROAD; POK6SGL90874288, 91063465, 40940371, 91414887, 91387979, 92610272, 94560997, 95370498, 96319189, 96455162, 97181009. Yamuna Nagar - ITI Workshop road; PGU4GOL33909747, 96321636, 96790776, 96750151, 97563312. YAMUNANAGAR - PAYARA CHOWK; PPK3GOL31403538, 92608982, 42189084, 93888629, 42597657. Yavatmal - Datta Chowk; PCQ6GOL30184376, 41221777, 43107239, 95997294, 96722328. YELLABURGA; PMZ9SGL91710665, 92183230, 93155355, 94324670, 94330460, 97255328, 97613734. YELLANDU - BUGGAVAGU; PGC4SGL91845380, 42229018, 93908991, 94848604, 43298706, 95986977, 96073142, 95995898, 44164942, 97170863. YEOLA - THEATER ROAD; PK05WGL90871043, 91058589, 40766894, 91848934, 93254820, 93183296, 93455745, 43291595. Zahirabad - RTC Bus Stand; PER4SGL41595886. ZIRAKPUR - PATIALA ROAD; PEO9WGL91083256, 91150423, 41456334, 92622103, 42528463, 42614758, 94324146, 94302103, 94332761, 94644029, 43108690, 95343437, 43606099, 43783986, 96276523, 96716486, 44678115, 96939132, 45003248.

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QUICKLY.

Crude oil prices rise as US-Iran talks stall

London: Crude oil prices rose on Wednesday and were on track for a big monthly gain as US-Iran talks aimed at ending their war stalled and tight fuel markets continued to underpin prices despite recovering West Asia crude supplies. The Brent futures November contract, which expires on Wednesday, was up 57 cents to $103.16 a barrel at 0944 GMT. US West Texas Intermediate crude was up 82 cents to $90.20. REUTERS

Gold prices rise after cooler inflation data

Gold prices extended gains aftera softer-than-expected US inflation reading hurt the dollar andraised hopes that the Federal Reserve might not raise interestrates again as soon as October. Spot gold was up 0.7 per cent at $4,209.71 per ounce as of 9:05 am ET (1305 GMT). However, prices were down 5.4 per cent in September so far. US gold futures gained 1.5 per cent to $4,241.90. REUTERS

Normal North-East monsoon likely as South-West ends with 13% deficit

RAIN PROSPECTS. IMD predicts below-normal rainfall in Oct, but North-West poised to get normal precipitation

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

PARCHED STRETCHES. 15 States and UTs covering 40% of the country received below-normal rainfall during June-September

The North-East monsoon, expected to set in during October 15-21, will likely be normal, even as the South-West monsoon draws to a close, with rainfall so far being the 13th-lowest since 1901 and the fourth-lowest since 2001, the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has said.

Briefing the media, IMD's Director-General M Mohapatra said monsoon rainfall was 759.4mm. He said that IMD expects withdrawal of the South-West monsoon from most parts of the country by October 15.

"Seasonal rainfall during October to December over South Peninsular India, consisting of five meteorological subdivisions (Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal, Coastal Andhra Pradesh and Yanam, Rayalaseema, Kerala and Mahe, and South Interior Karnataka) is most likely to be normal (88-112 per cent of Long Period Average (LPA)," he said.

BELOW NORMAL IN OCT

Other parts of the country, barring these, are expected to receive below-normal rainfall during the period. However, North-West India is likely to receive normal to above-normal rain," Mohapatra said. Rain in October is likely to be below normal (less than 85 per cent of the LPA) over most parts of the country except some areas in North-West India, southern parts of peninsular India and isolated areas of East India, said the IMD Director-General.

The weather bureau said that the country's north-west region, a key growing area of wheat, may have normal rainfall in the main sowing period October-December. Punjab, which experienced a significant rainfall deficit of 64 per cent in September, and Haryana, which had a deficit of 44 per cent, may benefit from rains in November, a crucial month for soil moisture.

DEFICIT RAIN

On the other hand, the South-West monsoon ended the 2026 season with 87 per cent rainfall during June-September, even as its withdrawal has been stalled for the past week. As many as 15 States and Union Territories (out of 36), accounting for 40 per cent of the country's geographical area, received below-normal rainfall.

According to the IMD, as many as 313 districts out of 741 in the country are either deficient or large deficient, which means they have received at least 20 per cent below normal rainfall. Further, 217 districts have received less than 70 per cent rains, and out of those 71 districts have got only 50 per cent of normal rainfall during June-September season.

UNEVEN SPREAD

The country as a whole has received 92 per cent (or 8 per cent below normal) rains during September, the weather bureau said. Monsoon was 35 per cent deficient in June, 1 per cent surplus in July and 16 per cent less than normal in August.

The geographical spread of the monsoon was also uneven, with the east and north-east meteorological subdivision, including West Bengal, Bihar and Jharkhand, receiving 26 per cent below-normal rainfall during the June-September period. Similarly Maharashtra, Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh, Odisha and Chhattisgarh, received 3 per cent below-normal rainfall.

Cabinet approves 1% hike in wheat support price

Raising support *(marketing season 2027-28)*

Crop	MSP 2027-28 (₹/quintal)	Increase over 2026-27 (₹)	% MSP increase	MSP 2026-27 (₹ quintal)
Wheat	2,610	25↑	1.0	2,585
Barley	2,286	136↑	6.3	2,150
Gram	5,958	86↑	1.4	5,875
Lentil (Masur)	7,390	390↑	5.6	7,000
Rapeseed & Mustard	6,613	413↑	6.7	6,200
Safflower	7,215	675↑	10.3	6,540

Source: Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers Welfare

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government announced minimum support prices (MSPs) for the rabi marketing season 2027-28 after the Cabinet approved a 1-10 per cent increase on Wednesday, a day before the winter sowing season is set to commence. The lowest increase was for wheat, at less than 1 per cent, while the highest was for safflower, at 10.3 per cent. After the revision, the MSP of the winter season's main cereal, wheat, now stands at ₹2,610 per quintal, up from ₹2,585 per quintal announced for the 2026-27 marketing season (April-March). Briefing the media after the Cabinet meeting, Information and Broadcasting Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the Cabinet approved the MSP recommendations of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP), as proposed by the Agriculture Ministry.

REVISED PRICES

"The production cost of wheat is ₹1,264 per quintal, but the MSP has been kept at more than double that amount, at ₹2,610 per quintal for 2027-28," he said.

Among other rabi crops, the MSP for barley has been increased by 6.3 per cent to ₹2,286 per quintal from ₹2,150 per quintal; for gram (chana), by 1.4 per cent to ₹5,958 per quintal from ₹5,875 per quintal; for lentil (masur), by 5.6 per cent to ₹7,390 per quintal from ₹7,000 per quintal; for mustard, by 6.7 per cent to ₹6,613 per quintal from ₹6,200 per quintal; and for safflower, to ₹7,215 per quintal from ₹6,540 per quintal, an official statement said. Total payout to farmers is estimated at ₹90,962 crore for 324 lakh tonnes in the 2027-28 marketing year, the minister said, adding that the MSPs were decided after factoring in the cost of production, El Nino concerns, and global and domestic price trends.

PRODUCTION TARGETS

The government has fixed a production target of 177.72 million tonnes (mt) of foodgrains, including 121 mt of wheat, 17.20 mt of pulses and 22.30 mt of nutri/coarse cereals, for the current rabi season. As monsoon rainfall was only 8 per cent below normal throughout September, some parts may have adequate soil moisture for sowing.

However, some states that received 20 per cent or more deficient rainfall in September may have to depend entirely on canal irrigation, amid forecasts of further strengthening of El Nino in the coming months. During September, Maharashtra reported a 52 per cent deficit, Karnataka 57 per cent, Telangana 24 per cent, Punjab 64 per cent and Haryana 44 per cent.

Centre allocates 14 lt of sugar for sales in Oct 1-15

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Refiners get 1 lakh tonnes sugar quota, unchanged from previous two allocations

The Centre has announced 14 lakh tonnes (lt) as the sugar quota, including 1 lt to standalone refiners, for sales in the domestic market during the October 1-15 period as the new sugar season begins from Thursday amid mills gearing up to start sugarcane crushing earlier than normal from around October 15 in Maharashtra and from October 20 in western Uttar Pradesh.

In an order on Wednesday, the Food Ministry said that under the fortnightly quota, mills will be required to sell at least 45 per cent of the allocation in the first week and the remaining quantity in the succeeding week. It also said that mills that start crushing in October will be able to sell their sugar, in addition to the quota, at any time during October and November.

Mills in the top three sugar-producing States have been allocated 10.77 lt, or 83 per cent, of the total 13 lt allocated across the country. This includes 4.39 lt in Maharashtra, 4.18 lt in Uttar Pradesh and 2.20 lt in Karnataka.

EFFORTS TO COOL PRICES

Experts view the decision as an effort to further cool retail prices ahead of the Dussehra festival, which will be celebrated on October 20.

Refiners, who were earlier permitted to sell some imported sugar in the domestic market, have been allocated 1 lt, the same as in the previous two allocations. However, for the first fortnight of October, Shree Renuka Sugars has been allotted 50,000 tonnes and Shri Dutt India 50,000 tonnes, the same as in the first fortnight of September. The government had divided the 1 lt allocation to refiners in a 60:40 ratio for the second fortnight of September.

Further, sugar mills have already been directed to ensure that sugar sold is dispatched from the mill within seven days of sale. Accordingly, the quantity covered by the sale invoices generated or issued shall be considered as the quantity sold for determining compliance, the order said. Unlike the last order, which contained a direction on how to deal with unsold sugar quota, Wednesday's order was silent on the issue. Experts said this was intended to allow mills to sell the unsold quota in October, thereby making more sugar available in the market.

Govt nod for MSP buy of pulses, oilseeds in 3 States

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The government has approved procurement of 5.21 lakh tonnes (lt) of pulses and 1.90 lt of oilseeds at their minimum support prices (MSPs) in Uttar Pradesh, Telangana and Karnataka as the fresh kharif harvest starts arriving in *mandis* (APMC yards). The decision will benefit growers.

Under the price support scheme, the Centre's nodal agencies, Nafed and NCCF, step in to purchase oilseeds and pulses when market prices fall below the government-declared MSPs. From this year, the Centre has allowed these agencies to begin purchases without waiting for the State's request.

Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan has approved the procurement at MSP worth ₹5,547.99 crore in Uttar Pradesh, Telangana, and Karnataka for the 2026-27 kharif season, the ministry said.

ECONOMIC SECURITY

"The decision is aimed at protecting farmers from a decline in market prices and ensuring remunerative returns for their produce, particularly for pulse and oilseed growers," Chouhan said.

Go long in copper if futures close above ₹1,432

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl.research bureau

Copper (Oct) futures has been trading in a range for about two months now. While in August it was oscillating within ₹1,375 and ₹1,410, since the beginning of September, the range has expanded to ₹1,360-1,432.

COMMODITY CALL.

Given the prevailing price action, October futures can establish the next leg of trend only if it moves out of the ₹1,360-1,432 range.

In case the contract breaks out of ₹1,432, it can move up to ₹1,480. Resistance above ₹1,480 is at ₹1,500. Instead, if copper futures breaches the support at ₹1,360, it could fall to ₹1,300.

Nevertheless, the contract retains some bullish bias as the price is above both the 21- and 50-day moving averages. Also, since the trend prior to the sideways movement has been bullish and the support at ₹1,360 stays valid, the likelihood of a break-out of ₹1,432 is comparatively higher than the copper futures slipping below ₹1,360.

However, as it stands, until the breakout of ₹1,432, we suggest traders stay out.

TRADE STRATEGY

Go long on copper (Oct) futures if it witnesses a daily close above ₹1,432.

Place the initial stop-loss at ₹1,400. When the contract rises to ₹1,460, tighten the stop-loss to ₹1,440. Book profits at ₹1,480.

Government hikes anti-dumping duty on jute goods from Bangladesh and Nepal

Mithun Dasgupta
Kolkata

RELIEF AHEAD. With the revised duty in effect, the industry will see benefits in the second half of the fiscal year DEBASISH BHADURI

The Centre's increase in anti-dumping duty on jute goods from Bangladesh and Nepal is expected to safeguard domestic producers and support demand and capacity utilisation for Indian jute mills. With the revised duty already in effect, the industry is likely to see benefits in the second half of the financial year, supporting jute farmers, workers and mills on the back of stronger domestic demand.

The Ministry of Finance has notified the higher anti-dumping duty following a mid-term review by the Directorate General of Trade Remedies (DGTR).

The original duty, imposed in 2017 and extended in 2022, was found to have lost much of its bite: imports of jute yarn, hessian and sacking from Bangladesh and Nepal increased by nearly 50 per cent over the past four years and now account for about one in every seven tonnes consumed in India. The raised duty replaces the old rates with duties fixed for each exporting mill on the basis of its actual pricing, with sharply higher rates for exporters that did not cooperate with the inquiry.

SUBSIDIES' PROBE

The industry has welcomed the decisions as a correction that restores fair competition rather than closing the border. "It will increase domestic demand for jute goods for the Indian jute industry. With an increase in demand for jute products, the capacity utilisation of jute mills will go higher. There will be more employment," Indian Jute Mills Association (IJMA) Chairman Raghavendra Gupta told *businessline*. Notably, DGTR has also concluded a separate investigation, filed by the Indian Jute Mills Association, into subsidies received by Bangladeshi and Nepalese exporters. It found that mills in Bangladesh receive cash incentives from Bangladesh Bank on every consignment exported, together with income-tax concessions, and that Nepalese mills enjoy comparable export grants and tax breaks. These are classified as prohibited export subsidies under WTO rules.

Following this, the Directorate General of Trade Remedies has, for the first time, recommended a countervailing duty on the jute goods imports from Bangladesh and Nepal to offset the export subsidies these countries extend to their mills.

The DGTR recorded that the domestic industry has suffered material injury: subsidised imports have undercut Indian mill prices. The countervailing duty recommendation now awaits notification by the Ministry of Finance.

Restore 44% import duty on CPO: Telangana Minister

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Tummala Nageswara Rao, Telangana Minister for Agriculture, Marketing and Co-operation

Telangana Agriculture, Marketing and Co-operation Minister Tummala Nageswara Rao has asked the Centre to restore the 44 per cent import duty on crude palm oil (CPO) to protect domestic farmers and support oil palm cultivation.

In letters to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Ministers, including Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Agriculture and Farmers Welfare Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, he said the reduction in import duty could put pressure on domestic CPO prices and, in turn, affect the fresh fruit bunches (FFB) prices paid to farmers.

IMPACT ON FARMERS

He questioned the policy of encouraging farmers to cultivate oil palm under the National Mission on Edible Oils – Oil Palm (NMEO-OP) while making imports cheaper through lower duties. The Centre recently reduced the basic customs duty on crude soybean oil and crude palm oil from 10 per cent to 5 per cent and on refined soybean oil and refined palm oil from 32.5 per cent to 27.5 per cent. The Minister said relief for consumers should not come at the expense of domestic farmers. Policy should balance the interests of both.

He sought policy stability for farmers who had invested heavily and committed their land to the crop for years.

'EU making efforts to treat basmati rice as a generic variety'

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

European experts claim fragrant rice sales are 10 times origin-area output

Efforts are underway in the European Union (EU) to try to deny protected geographical indication (PGI) status for basmati rice from India and render it as a generic variety of the cereal. Some experts in Europe are claiming that the sales of rice labelled as fragrant rice are ten times the output in the origin areas. The experts, however, have no proof or laboratory findings to prove that 90 per cent of rice sold as basmati is non-basmati, said trade sources.

Giving PGI status provides a country with the right to market a product exclusively, stating that it has unique properties and is specially grown in a particular region within its borders. It also gets a premium. In a video on the German media outlet DW, Delphine Marie Vivien of CIRAD, a French public agricultural research institution, said the area under cultivation in the basmati origin areas did not match the production.

In 2024, she warned that a delay in granting PGI for basmati could make it a generic rice variety. In the same report, an unnamed European Commission (EC) source talked of a "balanced outcome" in the battle for PGI in the Union.

The source spoke of separate protection for Indian and Pakistani basmati, while favouring a joint solution to the issue. The EU has been urging India and Pakistan to submit a joint application for a GI. However, experts say that such a move will compromise India's sovereign rights, as Pakistan has given parts of India as regions where the long-grained rice is grown.

THREE ISSUES

India applied for PGI in July 2018, and the EU has been dragging its feet on the application. During this period, Pakistan applied for PGI in April 2024. There are three issues with the Pakistan application. One, it claims India's basmati areas as its. Two, it says basmati is a shared product with India. Three, it got domestic PGI registration for its basmati only in 2021. Though the EU-India free trade agreement (FTA) was concluded in January this year, a separate agreement for GI products is under negotiation. Sources said this is proof that the EC did not want the basmati PGI issue to derail a wider trade agreement. However, it did not resolve the basmati issue either. During the eight years in which the Indian application has remained unresolved with the EU, rice produced outside the recognised Basmati region has allegedly continued to be marketed under that name.

S Chandrasekaran, author of "Basmat rice: The Natural History Geographical Indication", said the prolonged uncontrolled use of basmati might eventually change what European consumers understand as basmati rice. "Using this, some in the EU are trying to construct a risk narrative. The current EU Basmati PGI registration *status quo* affects French interests through reciprocity and negotiating credibility," he said.

The separate GI agreement negotiation is intended to remove imitation competition for European origin products, in particular French, in India. "This opportunity would be worth $6 billion in wine, spirit, cheese and other indications of origin food products. The EU is aware of India's sensitivity in the case and it knows that the Indian government can take tough political decisions as basmati GI touches the sovereignty of India," said Chandrasekaran.

The EU and India have not crossed the "red lines" during the FTA talks.

Negotiations of other agreements between India-EU are pending and basmati may prove to be a tough nut to crack, he said.

Post-harvest losses in onion, soybean, custard apple cause economic loss

AJ Vinayak
Mangaluru

A poorly ventilated storage structure in the onion supply chain, a miscalibrated combine harvester in soybeans, and heat stress during unshaded aggregation in the custard apple supply chain can impact the quality of the produce, the income of the farmer, and can have an impact on the environment, shows a working paper by WRI India.

WRI India — along with field partners such as BAIF Development Research Foundation, Samunnati, and Centre for Advanced Research and Development — has come out with a working paper titled 'Counting the uncounted for people and climate: Post-harvest losses in onion, soybean, and custard apple in Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra'. The paper — which has mapped losses across harvesting, sorting, transportation, storage and handling — has identified the critical points where interventions could make the biggest difference.

The study assesses and quantifies the post-harvest losses between 2023 and 2024 at the harvesting, sorting, transportation, storage and handling stages of onion, soybean and custard apple in selected high-production districts of Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra.

ECONOMIC VALUE

When the study-derived loss rates were applied to annual production across the selected districts – and for onion, only to the estimated storage-relevant share of rabi production – the resulting indicative annualised quantities were 16.89 lakh tonnes (lt) for onion, 4.16 lt for soybean and 7,793 tonnes for custard apple. It estimated the associated economic value of these losses at ₹2,711 crore for onion, ₹2,087 crore for soybean, and ₹20 crore for custard apple.

The greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions associated with these post-harvest losses are estimated at 995,523 tCO_2e (tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent) for onion, 92,206 tCO_2e for soybean, and 6,314 tCO_2e for custard apple. The paper said these crops capture variation in perishability and policy relevance, ranging from a relatively durable grain to a highly perishable fruit and a storage-sensitive staple vegetable.

QUICKLY.

Milky Mist commissions 10 MW of solar capacity

Chennai: Dairy major Milky Mist has commissioned a 10 MW solar power plant at Arasanoor in Tamil Nadu. With a total 25 MW of solar capacity available now, the company said that renewable sources meet 100 per cent of its total power requirements. OUR BUREAU

BITS Pilani, IIT-M announce partnership

Chennai: BITS Pilani and IIT-Madras have announced a partnership to promote academic and research collaboration.
The five-year agreement establishes a framework for collaboration in areas of mutual academic and research interest and provides opportunities for the exchange of students and faculty, academic and scholarly information, materials, and publications. OUR BUREAU

BikeWo, Moonrider join to explore electric tractors

Hyderabad: BikeWo Green Tech, an electric mobility and logistics platform, has entered into a pact with Moonrider, an electric tractor company, to explore opportunities for deploying e-tractors across institutional, commercial and specialised operating environments.
The partners will identify applications where e-tractors can offer operational and economic benefits and evaluate deployment models aligned with customer requirements. OUR BUREAU

Number of employed in industries crosses 2 crore in FY25: Govt survey

TOP EMPLOYERS. TN, Maharashtra, Gujarat UP and Haryana account for 56% of manufacturing jobs

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The number of industrial employees crossed 2 crore at the end of fiscal year 2024-25, according to the Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) released on Wednesday. Tamil Nadu topped the list of States in the engagement.

The estimated number of persons engaged in registered industries rose to 2.10 crore at the end of FY25 as compared to 1.96 core in FY24, showing a growth of over 7 per cent. Total emoluments paid to the workforce also increased by over 12 per cent. "Tamil Nadu, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Uttar Pradesh and Haryana were the five leading States in terms of the number of persons engaged in the manufacturing sector. Together, these States accounted for about 56 per cent of total manufacturing employment during the year," the survey showed.

Top five States — *Share (in %) of GVA and establishments*

State	GVA		Establishments	
	ASI 2023-24	ASI 2024-25	ASI 2023-24	ASI 2024-25
Maharashtra	15.95	15.92	10.2	10.26
Gujarat	14.20	14.10	12.81	12.39
Tamil Nadu	10.26	10.90	15.43	15.44
Karnataka	7.47	7.31	5.76	5.86
Uttar Pradesh	6.80	6.64	8.51	9.35

Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) released the results of the ASI with the field work carried out during October 2025 to June 2026.

ASI is conducted with the primary objective to provide a meaningful insight into the dynamics of change in the composition, growth and structure of various manufacturing industries in terms of output, value added, employment, capital formation and a host of other parameters.

MANUFACTURING BASE
The registered manufacturing sector recorded broad-based growth during FY25, with most of the major economic indicators — invested capital, input, output, Gross Value Added (GVA), employment and wages — increasing over the previous year.

The total number of establishments in this sector increased from 2.60 lakhs in FY24 to 2.67 lakhs in FY25, representing a growth of 2.64 per cent. The highest number of establishments was reported in Tamil Nadu (41,221), followed by Gujarat (33,084) and Maharashtra (27,379).

During the same period, GVA increased from ₹24.58 lakh crore to ₹26.94 lakh crore (9.59 per cent) showing sustained growth. In terms of individual share of States in all India GVA, Maharashtra recorded the highest GVA in 2024-25, followed by Gujarat, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Uttar Pradesh.

Collectively, these five States accounted for more than 54 per cent of the country's total manufacturing GVA, and 53.30 per cent of total establishments. Over the last survey period, this sector reported a 11.10 per cent expansion in invested capital (fixed capital + physical working capital).

Net income increased by 9.68 per cent and net profit by 7.73 per cent. The top five industries, basic metal, motor vehicles, chemical and chemical products, pharmaceutical products and food products, taken together, have contributed more than 45 per cent of the total manufacturing GVA in FY25.

INDIA bloc announces nation-wide protest from Oct 2; seeks CEC's ouster

Our Bureau
New Delhi

As many as 19 political parties came together on Wednesday for the three-and-a-half hour meeting

Stepping up the pressure for fixing accountability, the INDIA opposition bloc on Wednesday announced a week-long country-wide protest march from October 2 to "save democracy" and seek the ouster of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, who is at the centre of controversy surrounding alleged electoral roll revision irregularities.

As many as 19 political parties came together on Wednesday for a meeting that lasted over three-and-a-half hours and decided to put up a united effort to bring people around '*vote chori*' issue. This follows an expose by a newspaper which stated that the two Election Commissioners wrote 14 letters in 10 months over vote deleting and related subjects — adding to lingering suspicion on the integrity of the electoral roll revision exercise. All opposition MPs will march to the Election Commission on October 6 and the leaders will meet the President to highlight the issues related to alleged irregularities in voter list revision, they said.

MIXED BAG
Top leaders from different political parties such as Congress' Mallikarjun Kharge, Rahul Gandhi and Sonia Gandhi, Mamata Banerjee of the Trinamool Congress and Tejashwi Yadav of the Rashtriya Janata Dal, NCP (SP) MP Supriya Sule, Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah and PDP Chief Mehbooba Mufti were among those who attended the meeting.

But, DMK and AAP skipped the meeting, while Samajwadi Party's Chief Akhilesh Yadav, busy with Rajya Sabha polls, was represented by MPs Harendra Malik and Maulana Mohibbullah Nadvi. Others like Shiv Sena (UBT) chief Uddhav Thackeray and Jharkhand Chief Minister and JMM Chief Hemant Soren, participated in the meeting online.

The Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, however, asserted at a joint press conference by the INDIA bloc leaders, that it is their "personal commitment" to ensure that those who have "destroyed" Indian democracy are punished.

CONCERTED EFFORT
Kharge stated a joint action plan has been agreed to. Under that "save democracy" marches will be taken out in all districts on October 2-8 and demonstrations will be held before the district magistrate's office, and added that youth and NGOs would also be invited for the event.

"We will hold five big rallies during October/November. We will tell people how the government is snatching the rights of the people to elect their government," he said. TMC Chief Mamata Banerjee, seated next to Sonia Gandhi, reassured that the INDIA bloc is "very much united" over the issue and sought immediate removal of CEC Kumar, alleging serious electoral wrongdoing and manipulation of the electoral process.

Launching a counter-attack,Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan saidthe INDIA bloc meeting showed the opposition leaders have "zero vision, 100 per cent frustration, and an advance excuse for poll defeats."

Oil Min seeks feedback on amending Petroleum Act 1934

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas (MoPNG) has sought responses from the public and stakeholders on amending the Petroleum Act, 1934 to decriminalise minor offences. The Petroleum Act was enacted to consolidate and amend the law relating to the import, transport, storage, production, refining and blending of petroleum (products), the Ministry said adding that it has been examining the issue of strengthening the existing legal framework relating to offences. Accordingly, the Ministry has proposed to amend Chapter three of the Act, which relates to "Penalties and Procedure".

"The proposed amendments, *inter alia*, seek to achieve the objectives of decriminalisation of regulatory issues such as breach of terms and conditions of licences and provides for a mechanism for imposition of civil penalty through an administrative mechanism. Further, the proposed amendments provide adequate deterrence against specific offences relating to various aspects of petroleum operations," MoPNG emphasised. Stakeholders

can share their responses with the Ministry till October 30, 2026.

GRADED FRAMEWORK
The Petroleum Act established the framework for offences that has remained largely the same and was last amended in 1970, which increased the fine from ₹500 to simple imprisonment up to one month or

Aim is to decriminalise some issues while ensuring deterrence against specific offences

with fine of ₹1,000. For repeat offences, it replaced the penalty of up to ₹2,000 with simple imprisonment of up to three months or with fine up to ₹5,000 or both, the Ministry said."The penalty, although significant in terms of the 1970s, is now insignificant, considering that in 1970, the price of petrol was ₹0.90 per litre and in 2026 it fluctuates between ₹95 and ₹105, which is an increase of over 10,000 per cent, it added.

Even the critical infrastructure that is integral to national security has increased manifold.

"The objective of the amendments proposed is to rationalise the otherwise generic offence presently under Section 23 of the Petroleum Act, 1934, which fails to achieve any specific deterrence against the specific offences but has created a framework whereby breaches of licenses become criminal offences," it emphasised.

Senior living and elder care sector seeks formal recognition, regulatory framework

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

As India's elderly population is set to reach the 350-million in the next 15-20 years, the senior living and elder care providers are seeking formal recognition and hoping for a national-level policy in the next 3-5 years.

"It is a new sector. So we are working with the government for creating a formal recognition and regulatory framework around it," Rajagopal G, Chairman, Association of Senior Living India (ASLI) and Co-Founder, Director and Chief Executive Officer, Lifebridge Group, told *businessline*. Any concessions or regulations can happen only if there is a recognition of the sector, he added.

The industry body is also hoping for a formal national-level policy for the senior living sector, an initial draft of which was first mooted in 2019.

"We observe a clear intent from the policymakers, but implementation hinges on coordination with various States too," Rajagopal said, noting that some States such as Kerala, Maharashtra and Haryana already have clear programmes.

GROWTH SEGMENT
As per industry estimates, India has around 150 million elderly people today, with the number potentially rising to around 350 million over the next 15-20 years. However, only around 25,000 organised senior-living homes currently exist, against demand

Rajagopal G, Chairman, Association of Senior Living India BIJOY GHOSH

for as much as 20 lakh homes, said Rajagopal.

As per a recent Colliers report, India's senior living market is currently at around ₹30,000 crore, almost 70 per cent higher than 2024 levels, and the segment is expected to exceed ₹1 lakh crore by 2030.

Rajagopal was speaking on the sidelines of the ASLI Annual Conclave, its 7th Ageing Fest, in Chennai.

He said there is a need for a more formalised and "prestigious" skilling ecosystem for caregivers to avoid a shortage as the senior population scales. "Japan is today under this intense problem where they don't have people as caregivers for the older population, and are seeking help from across the world; India should not get into that situation. If we don't act now, we can slip into that," he said. A recent NITI Aayog caregiving report, among other things, recommends establishing a National Caregiving Council (NCC) and developing a National Caregiving Qualification Framework to standardise education, training, accreditation and certification.

Better connectivity, specialist capabilities key to scale Coimbatore's GCC ecosystem, says EY-CII report

Our Bureau
Chennai

While Coimbatore has emerged as a reputable tier-2 location for Global Capability Centres (GCC), scaling this ecosystem will require improved infrastructure and connectivity alongside deeper specialist talent, according to a report by EY India and Confederation of Indian Industry (CII).

The report suggests that Coimbatore has been able to leverage its century-old industrial base across sectors like precision engineering, and automotive components as well as its engineering talent to attract over 75 GCCs, many of 'mid-sized' enterprises.

The city can further scale this ecosystem to 200 by 2032 by positioning itself as a secondary hub for companies that already have significant operations in tier-1 metros such as Bengaluru, Chennai, Hyderabad and Pune, the report added.

Manoj Marwah, GCC Markets Leader, EY India, suggests that this targeted approach bodes better than pursuing companies indiscriminately through incentives.

"We have had a positive experience with the local talent pool in terms of quality and across commercial, operational and engineering operations," Gangapriya Chakraverti, India Site Head and Managing Director, FBS said.

CONNECTIVITY GAP
Meanwhile, poor international connectivity especially to key European and North American destinations has been highlighted as a key roadblock to city's ability to attract GCCs. Similarly, limited supply of grade A office stock and other urban infrastructure has also been highlighted as challenges. Ravichandran Purushothaman, Chairman of the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) Southern Region told *businessline* that the organisation is discussing with relevant stakeholders on improving the international connectivity to city while also evaluating the possibility of a Sri City like SEZ at Coimbatore or in the region.

The report flagged that though Coimbatore has 300,000 strong IT/ITES workforce, the availability of experienced specialists remains limited.

The shortage is particularly acute in areas such as advanced AI, cybersecurity, risk, treasury and technology regulation, making lateral hiring of senior, niche talent difficult.

Spinning mills industry body seeks 24-hour power supply

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Industry body OSMA said that forcing textile units to switch to DG sets during peak hours could significantly increase production costs and erode competitiveness

The Open-end Spinning Mills Association (OSMA) has urged the Tamil Nadu government to ensure 24-hour uninterrupted power supply to HT industrial consumers.

The Association's request followed a recent notice from the power utility to all HT service consumers in Madurai to switch off the grid supply and switch on their DG supply, to facilitate grid management, he told *businessline*.

OSMA said that forcing textile units to depend on DG sets during peak hours could significantly increase production costs and erode their competitiveness.

"Factories should not be forced to manage power shortages through expensive diesel generator power. Reliable, competitive and uninterrupted electricity must be ensured for Tamil Nadu's industries," OSMA President G Arulmozhi said.

OSMA said textile industries, including spinning, open-end spinning, weaving, processing and garment units, operate continuous production processes, making them particularly vulnerable to power interruptions. Even a few hours of disruption can affect production, machinery utilisation, workforce planning and delivery schedules, it added.According to Arulmozhi, power generated through industrial DG sets could cost around ₹30 per unit. This would add significantly to production expenses at a time when the industry is already facing higher raw material, labour and logistics costs.

Reliable power supply was critical for the competitiveness of Tamil Nadu's textile sector, employment, exports, small and medium enterprises and workers' livelihoods, he said.

SC weighs in favour of limited relaxation on green crackers ahead of festival season

Krishnadas Rajagopal
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Wednesday backed suggestions by the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research-National Environmental Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-NEERI) for a "limited and conditional relaxation" to manufacture next generation joined green crackers in compliance with the applicable noise, emission and safety requirements ahead of the Deepavali festivities.

Appearing before a Bench headed by Justice MM Sundresh, Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the Centre, said the CSIR-NEERI has recommended that green crackers conform to specifications/formulations tested and approved by the competent authority and are manufactured exclusively by duly licensed manufacturers. The apex court had queried in July whether a "partial relaxation with respect to certain types of crackers may be possible, with specific reference to noise." A subsequent court order had asked Bhati to provide measures undertaken to limit the shell size and time between bursts of crackers.

The CSIR-NEERI report on the 'new generation joined fire crackers' said a series of the green variety had been developed without the use of Barium in their compositions.

These crackers are different from the conventional ones in terms of shell/tube size, formulation, bursting duration and frequency of bursting, with corresponding reductions in noise, particulate emissions and solid waste generation.

MIDDLE PATH
The court on Wednesday said it would take a balanced view about the issue of fire crackers, particularly with apprehensions of air pollution with the onset of winter and the festive season.

"Total ban will hurt certain sentiments. We will not agree on a total ban across the country. At the same time, we will not allow a 24-hour bursting anywhere, as it affects the sick, the elderly and children," the Bench remarked orally.

INDUSTRY WELCOMES
"This development marks an important milestone for the Indian fireworks industry and reflects the recognition of scientific research, technological innovation, and sustained efforts to develop environmentally improved fireworks,"

Tamil Nadu Fireworks and Amorces Manufacturers' Association reacted in a statement.

Multi-agency rescue averts tanker disaster off Odisha

Our Bureau
Chennai

A major maritime incident involving a Belize-flagged tanker carrying about 9,000 tonnes of palm oil and 23 crew members was averted off the Odisha coast after the vessel suffered a main-engine failure and ballast tank flooding, resulting in a 10-degree list.

The ship, *Sea Gull 9*, reported the distress on September 27, when it was approximately 37 nautical miles east-south-east of Paradip.

The Directorate General of Maritime Administration said that, in coordination with the Indian Navy, Indian Coast Guard and Paradip Port Authority, it mounted a multi-agency response through its Marine Casualty and Emergency Response Branch.

The response involved damage control, stabilisation of the vessel, aerial surveillance for possible pollution and arrangements for its safe entry into port, the Directorate said in a social media post.

The tanker reached Paradip Port on September 28, with the Harbour Master on board and assisted by a tug.

A minor palm-oil sheen was observed in the vicinity of the vessel following the incident, but it dissipated naturally, according to the Directorate.

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QUICKLY.

Gujarat start-up to launch payload on SpaceX rocket

Ahmedabad: SatLeo Labs, an Ahmedabad-based spacetech start-up, will launch its indigenous thermal infrared Earth-observation payload TAPAS-1 aboard a SpaceX Falcon 9 rocket on October 1, marking the company's entry into the commercial satellite-data market, the State government said on Wednesday. Weighing about 3 kg, TAPAS-1 will be deployed at an altitude of around 500 km and capture thermal infrared images that map heat and temperature variations on the Earth's surface — information not available through conventional optical satellite imagery. The data is expected to find applications in agriculture and water-stress monitoring, urban heat management, infrastructure and industrial monitoring, defence and forest-fire detection. OUR BUREAU

Apple Pay launches in India

NEW PLAYER. Customers can pay with iPhone, Apple Watch and iPad; Mac support soon

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Apple users in India will soon be able to make in-app purchases, online payments and store transactions using Apple Pay as the company rolls out the service over the next few weeks.

Customers can make payments across merchants using their iPhone, Apple Watch and iPad, with support for Mac coming soon. The service can also be availed by Axis Bank Credit Card customers across Mastercard and Visa networks.

Customers will be assigned a unique Device Account Number when using a credit card with Apple Pay.

This DAN will be encrypted and securely stored in the Secure Element, an industry-standard, certified chip designed to store the payment information safely on the device.

The card numbers are not stored on the device, Apple servers, nor is the information shared with the merchant.

WIDENING HORIZON. The service can also be availed by Axis Bank Credit Card customers across Mastercard, Visa networks

"India is home to a dynamic and digitally savvy population that continues to embrace a cashless future while expecting the highest standards of security and privacy, and we're so excited to bring Apple Pay to users in India today," said Jennifer Bailey, Apple's vice president of Apple Pay and Apple Wallet.

LARGE MARKET

Payment gateways like PayU, RazorPay and Cashfree have also partnered with Apple to make the service available across retailers.

The launch strengthens Apple's ecosystem in India and adds a services layer in what is now its third-largest iPhone market globally by volume, said Tarun Pathak, Research Director, Counterpoint Research.

"UPI will continue to dominate everyday payments, but Apple Pay is positioned differently: a convenience- and privacy-led experience that removes OTP friction at checkout. The key thing to watch is how quickly other leading banks come on board, because that will decide how far the addressable base expands," he said. For now, Axis Bank is the first Indian bank to offer Apple Pay to its customers with a Mastercard and Visa credit card. Once a customer adds a card to their Apple device, they can start using Apple Pay right away.

India's payment market is currently dominated by Walmart-backed PhonePe and Google's GPay.

However, experts doubt that Apple can compete right away.

"Apple Pay lacks UPI functionality. It will compete in the premium card segment through contactless transactions. Google Pay is deeply embedded in the UPI ecosystem. If Apple eventually integrates UPI into Apple Wallet, its competitive advantage could come through its vertical integration," said Prof. Juhi, Assistant Professor, Finance and Accounting, IMI Delhi.

"India is gradually creating clearer commercial incentives for companies participating in digital payments. That makes the market more attractive for a player such as Apple, which typically looks for a sustainable business model around its payments ecosystem," said Kriti Seth, Practice Director at Everest Group.

HC judgment shows a way to fix costly patented medicines issue

Ankita Upadhyay
New Delhi

The Kerala High Court's recent judgment in a case involving the high-priced cancer drug, Ribociclib, has opened another possible route for the government to make patented medicines more affordable — without necessarily waiting for a generic drugmaker to seek a compulsory licence.

The judgment recognises that the government can use a patented invention under Section 100 of the Patents Act, 1970, for public health needs. The ruling could allow the Centre to consider using the provision for medicines such as Ribociclib, where high prices or inadequate availability may prevent patients from accessing treatment.

Chetali Rao, Senior Scientific Advisor at Third World Network (TWN), said drug companies had argued for a narrow interpretation of Section 100, under which the government use will be limited to its own purposes and would not permit manufacturing patented medicines for free or subsidised supply to patients. The court rejected this interpretation, holding that government purposes include the State's constitutional duty to improve public health, including manufacturing patented medicines and supplying them to needy patients on a non-commercial basis.

In practice, Section 100 could allow the government to authorise another manufacturer to make a patented medicine for government use and supply it to patients through public-health programmes, subject to the statutory requirements and compensation to the patent holder.

This is different from compulsory licensing, which

generally involves a third party seeking permission to manufacture a patented product on specified statutory grounds. A generic company can approach the Controller of Patents for a compulsory licence, including when the reasonable requirements of the public are not being met. India has used compulsory licensing only once, when Natco Pharma was allowed to manufacture Bayer's cancer drug Sorafenib.

COMPULSORY LICENCE

Rao said compulsory licensing can be difficult because a generic company must come forward, be willing to manufacture the drug, and be prepared for potentially lengthy litigation. Section 100, by contrast, does not depend on a generic company taking the first step.

A key challenge, however, would be establishing that public access to a particular medicine is inadequate. Earlier, patent holders had to provide information through Form 27 on quantities manufactured, imported, or supplied in India. Rao said changes to the form have reduced the amount and frequency of information available, making it harder to establish unmet need through patent data alone.

The government would therefore need data on medicine prices, what patients are paying and how many patients actually need a particular drug. Ribociclib, for example, illustrates why simply looking at the overall number of cancer patients may not be enough. The government would need to assess how many patients with the specific breast-cancer subtype for which the drug is indicated actually need it.

AFFORDABILITY

But establishing unmet needs is not only about how many patients require a medicine; it is also about whether they can afford it. Affordability cannot be assessed simply by whether a medicine is included in the National List of Essential Medicines (NLEM), said Amulya Nidhi, Public Health Expert and National Convenor, Jan Swasthya Abhiyan India. Inclusion of Ribociclib in the NLEM does not by itself ensure that patients can afford the drug.

Companies can use combinations, branding, and other formulation strategies that may affect how price controls apply, and a wide gap can also exist between manufacturing cost and the price ultimately paid by patients.

PRICING TOOLS

Section 100 is not the government's only possible route to address high medicine prices. It also has pricing tools through the National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority. In 2019, 42 specified non-scheduled anti-cancer medicines were brought under a 30 per cent trade-margin cap covering the distribution chain.

Rao said the government could examine whether more cancer medicines should come under such controls, particularly where a large gap exists between the manufacturer's price and what patients pay.

The Kerala HC judgment does not automatically reduce the price of patented medicines. Its significance is that Section 100 can provide another legal mechanism for government intervention.

Reliance's ₹13,000-cr bond issue draws strong demand

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Reliance Industries' ₹13,000-crore 10-year bond issue attracted strong investor interest on Wednesday, with bids exceeding ₹15,000 crore against a base issue size of ₹12,000 crore, according to sources familiar with the transaction.

The issue included a green shoe option of ₹1,000 crore. A green shoe issue allows the underwriter to sell more shares than the original size.

NSE Electronic Bidding Platform (EBP) data showed the cut-off price at ₹100.02 and the weighted average price at ₹100.0662, both above the ₹100 face value, indicating investors were willing to pay a premium for the bonds.

A total of 80 qualified institutional buyers and one non-QIB participated in the bidding, while the ₹3,500-crore anchor portion was subscribed by 16 investors, sources said.

According to people familiar with the matter, State Bank of India emerged as the largest investor, picking up bonds worth nearly ₹5,000 crore, or about 40 per cent of the offering.

◉ LARGEST INVESTOR

SBI emerged as the largest investor, picking up bonds worth nearly ₹5,000 crore, or about 40 per cent of the offering

ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, SBI Pension Fund and ICICI Prudential Life Insurance were also among the major investors, a person familiar with the matter said.

BROAD-BASED DEMAND

The bonds carry a coupon of 7.90 per cent and are rated AAA by ratings agencies Crisil and CareEdge.

Market participants said the scarcity of long-tenor and high-quality corporate debt made the issue attractive to banks, insurers and pension funds.

"A total of 80 institutions bid and the anchor book was filled by 16 investors. This shows that the demand for the issue was broad-based," a person familiar with the matter said.

The transaction follows Reliance Industries' ₹12,000-crore five-year bond issue earlier this month at a 7.47 per cent coupon rate and marks another successful fundraise despite recent volatility in debt markets that has forced some issuers to defer offerings, sources added.

With input from agencies

GOLDEN ARROWS

ARCHERY SWEEP. After the mixed and women's compound archery teams defended their gold medals, men's compound team consisting Kushal Dalal, Sahil Jadhav and Ganesh Thirumuru won the gold at the Asian Games 2026 at Aichi- Nagoya, Japan, on Wednesday. RV MOORTHY

Walmart bets on AI to drive next phase of retail

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

AI-led shopping experiences are driving higher add-to-cart rates and repeat purchases at Walmart, as the retailer moves from search and recommendations towards agentic commerce, said Balu Chaturvedula, SVP & Country Head, Walmart Global Tech.

"Walmart grew with traditional AI and has adopted GenAI and agentic AI. Traditional search is task-driven. AI changes the experience based on intent. We have different levels of super-agent experiences for different personas," he said.

"With super agents like Sparky coming into the equation, we saw that the customer add-to-cart rate has gone up significantly, and repeat buys have grown. This is the new phase of retail shopping. It is purpose-driven engineering, where technology blends with what a customer does and enhances their persona. This is an example of how retail adoption of AI is going," he explained.

He noted that the company has grown its capabilities: ownership, maturity models, and awareness.

NEW PHASE

"Walmart is in a new phase: we are a people-led, tech-powered organisation," he said.

However, technology adoption is a secondary metric for the retailer, with the top four things in any retail ecosystem being assortment, pricing, convenience, and trust.

AI, or any other technology, only amplifies this journey, he added.

Walmart's AI journey has four phases: answering, recommending, acting with supervision, and acting autonomously. It has moved beyond traditional search and personalisation to generating customer carts with consent, while autonomous AI is still at an early stage and will require strong governance, access controls, logging, monitoring and observability. Delivery timelines have evolved from a week to the same day.

RISING COSTS

Meeting these expectations raises supply-chain costs, making Walmart's Omni strategy key to scaling faster delivery economically.

"For roughly 90 per cent of America's population, there is a Walmart within a 10-mile radius. Traditionally, we expected customers to shop in store and then found that last-mile delivery and pickup were becoming a big value proposition; we could look at the store as a node that does both. The front of the store serves the customers who walk in, while the back can serve orders from the nearby geographical area. That's how we converted 4,500-plus stores into 4,500 supply chain nodes," Chaturvedula shared.

CUSTOMER PRIORITY

Walmart's network velocity has increased significantly, with more than 90 per cent of the US population now able to receive orders in under an hour.

The retailer has also expanded into drone delivery, recently completing its millionth drone delivery.

"All of this is one of the reasons customers come back to us, shopping repeatedly. We are seeing how people's patterns and customer behaviours are changing where convenience is concerned. It's a huge value proposition for the customers who shop with us," he noted.

Walmart's GCC in India evolved from a partnership model to local ownership and eventually a global, value-driven model.

INDIA GCC

India's talent density and retail expertise led to greater business and technology sponsorship for local ownership, including supply-chain control towers in Bengaluru.

This was not about operating in isolation, but enabling teams in India to support Walmart's US and international markets as one global talent organisation.

"As Omni came together for Walmart, we realised we can have leaders independent of geography and based on the capabilities they can build, managing teams across geographies. Most of my two levels of leadership have global roles in India, which means they manage teams in the US and vice versa," said Chaturvedula.

"We are becoming more location-independent, which has changed the face of the organisation," he added.

Canon targets over 10,000 retailers by end of next year

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Canon India is expanding its retail and service footprint, targeting more than 10,000 resellers and retailers by the end of next year for consumer printing, from around 6,000 currently, as it looks to tap growing demand beyond major cities.

WHERE GROWTH LIES

The company is seeing faster growth in tier-2, tier-3 and tier-4 cities, driven by demand from households, students, MSMEs and institutions. While metros and tier-1 cities continue to account for a higher share of absolute revenue, Canon expects emerging markets to gradually increase their contribution. Its B2B and B2C verticals currently contribute nearly equally to its business.

Alongside its retail expansion, Canon India is also seeking to grow its non-imaging businesses, including surveillance and security, medical diagnostic imaging and industrial printing, over the next two years.

CAMERA MARKET

In imaging, Canon held a 31 per cent share of India's digital interchangeable-lens camera market in 2025, per its internal estimates. Globally, it has held the No. 1 position in the segment for 23 consecutive years.

Consumer printing has also maintained sustained double-digit year-on-year growth, with Canon India targeting a 30 per cent share of the inkjet market.

IATA against forced flights relocation to Navi Mumbai

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Airlines should be free to choose between Mumbai and Navi Mumbai airports, the International Air Transport Association (IATA) has said while opposing the "forced relocation" of flights.

THE DIRECTIVE

IATA has sought the Civil Aviation Ministry's intervention after the Mumbai International Airport Ltd (MIAL) asked airlines to shift one-third of all international flights from its terminal 2 to the Navi Mumbai airport from October 1.

While the transition has not materialised, the Mumbai airport has told airlines they may choose to relocate operations to Navi Mumbai or suspend operations effective October 25 until the new terminal 1 of Mumbai is commissioned in FY30.

FREE TO CHOOSE

"IATA and the airline community remain fully supportive of the Navi Mumbai airport and the long-term development of the Mumbai dual airport system. However, this should be based on market forces and airlines' choice rather than mandated, forced relocations," said the association's Director-General Amitabh Khosla in a recent letter to the Ministry.

IATA has said the MIAL's communication created a confusion and a transition framework should be developed in collaborative consultation with airlines.

"Airlines require certainty that the broader operating ecosystem will be fully established before any transition is implemented. This includes adequate ground handling capacity; airline engineering and line maintenance support; adequate catering services; cargo facilities; crew accommodation and transport arrangements; regulatory approvals, passenger connectivity solutions and associated service provider readiness," Khosla said.

In case of the Navi Mumbai airport, airlines have not been made aware whether the aircraft maintenance service provider possesses all necessary approvals to handle all types of aircraft. Similarly, the IATA said catering services, too, were not fully ready to handle meals meant for international flights.

"International airlines finalise schedules, aircraft deployment, sales inventory and resource planning many months in advance of a flight. Significant changes should also be aligned with the relevant industry scheduling season and communicated sufficiently in advance to avoid disruption to passengers and airline operations," Khosla added.

THE OTHER SIDE

In a statement, the Mumbai airport said its terminal 1 is scheduled for demolition in line with Airport Economic Regulatory Authority order.

"While the demolition work was originally planned to commence in mid-2025, MIAL voluntarily deferred it due to the absence of an alternative operating facility for airlines. With the Navi Mumbai airport becoming operational, airlines now have an alternative option.

Stakeholders including airlines have been informed that terminal 1 redevelopment will commence in January 2027, hence they may choose to relocate operations or temporarily suspend them until the new terminal is commissioned in 2029-30. "This is a temporary transition, and MIAL will honour airlines' slot rights once the new terminal is operational," MIAL said.

FSSAI suspends licence of Seven Seas Hospitality

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has suspended the licence of Seven Seas Hospitality Pvt Ltd for serious non-compliances observed during inspection of the premises. The company has been directed to cease all food business activities.

About 74 kg/litres of non-compliant food articles were destroyed on-site post inspection.

"Poor hygiene and sanitation conditions were observed, including water stagnation, foul odour, filth and inadequate housekeeping in food preparation areas," FSSAI said in a social media post.

For BSE/NSE live quotes, scan the QR code or click the link https://bit.ly/2FpossK

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
20 Microns [5]	212.80	214.59	211.29	221.80	211.29	76.78	238.10	130.50	12	214.05
360 One WAM	1029.20	1030.00	1029.20	1047.00	1029.00	1348.99	1236.20	906.05	-	-
3B Blackbio	1622.70	1710.40	1615.10	1740.00	1610.50	67.74	1740.00	1085.00	-	-
3M India	31890.00	32160.00	31890.00	32695.00	31890.00	3.55	38300.00	28747.30	82	32111.10
63 MoonsTe [2]	810.80	811.05	809.95	839.00	807.65	138.35	957.70	465.55	65	812.45
A										
AAA Tech	99.94	94.73	99.95	103.57	91.56	72.25	136.00	77.07	-	-
Aadhar Hsg	432.50	436.00	432.50	438.00	427.55	338.64	563.00	427.30	-	-
Aarey Drugs	99.92	102.72	100.18	103.69	99.22	392.67	103.99	50.31	-	-
Aarti Drugs	428.60	430.90	429.80	439.00	429.60	145.12	533.60	318.60	23	430.55
Aarti Ind [5]	469.90	475.70	472.00	489.95	471.40	723.01	551.45	338.20	33	475.95
Aarti Pharm	972.80	953.75	983.50	1002.40	943.00	951.36	1002.40	585.00	-	-
Aavas	1248.40	1211.90	1240.00	1250.80	1206.00	80.67	1774.95	1050.25	14	1213.10
AB Capital	378.00	380.60	380.15	385.55	379.95	3567.53	430.55	286.65	31	381.00
AB Real Est	1160.60	1130.70	1169.90	1183.00	1122.10	276.54	1914.00	1080.10	-	-
AB Sun Life	955.90	995.30	955.90	1033.90	947.90	214.65	1224.90	708.00	-	-
ABB [2]	6660.50	6776.00	6801.00	6927.50	6771.00	229.22	7923.35	4640.50	93	6753.55
Abbott (I)	27270.00	27125.00	27270.00	27495.00	27015.00	5.65	30598.00	25140.50	36	27149.40
ABFRL	46.24	46.32	46.60	47.29	45.97	3805.40	88.98	45.90	-	46.42
ACC	1202.60	1204.10	1205.00	1224.00	1200.80	63.79	1986.90	1189.50	12	1204.65
ACME Solar	437.95	439.00	441.30	444.60	436.00	1108.84	476.90	195.90	-	-
Action Cons [2]	1205.80	1232.00	1205.90	1245.60	1205.00	343.17	1267.05	746.10	33	1231.45
Acutaas Chem	3304.10	3279.40	3334.10	3344.00	3255.00	349.43	3740.00	1302.00	-	-
Adani Ent [1]	2972.90	2903.40	2910.00	2957.60	2880.00	1663.02	3245.00	1753.45	118	2900.25
Adani Green	1260.00	1278.00	1250.40	1284.80	1250.40	1452.23	1631.35	767.00	308	1277.00
Adani Ports [2]	1822.00	1798.30	1793.50	1803.20	1775.40	3199.51	1891.80	1293.10	150	1786.05
Adani Pwr [2]	196.30	204.00	198.69	204.49	198.65	21070.86	254.15	128.35	33	203.85
Adani T Gas	588.40	593.90	589.90	602.95	589.05	616.17	859.85	462.80	-	-
Adani Wilm	178.75	177.68	178.95	181.30	177.11	910.51	282.90	171.19	-	-
Adani.E.Sol	1305.80	1314.60	1319.00	1340.80	1308.90	1154.07	1789.00	803.10	-	-
ADF Foods [2]	268.30	273.10	268.30	274.95	263.10	59.41	346.95	153.65	29	273.45
AdityaBirlaL	76.98	76.52	77.39	77.80	76.11	2517.74	150.79	75.06	-	-
AdityaInfote	3817.60	3846.50	3840.10	3950.00	3766.00	237.69	4094.00	1227.00	-	-
AdityaVisi	585.80	594.35	591.00	599.80	576.30	107.34	705.00	436.55	-	-
AdorWelding	1612.00	1591.80	1625.10	1625.10	1585.20	15.86	1766.40	848.00	-	-
Adroit Info	14.23	14.67	14.69	15.84	14.26	1779.13	15.84	7.55	-	-
Advait Ener	1903.60	1901.80	1915.20	1935.20	1863.40	33.35	2485.00	1351.00	-	-
Advance Agro	120.19	121.19	120.19	125.45	120.00	261.92	154.00	84.10	-	-
Advent Hotel	124.70	126.32	125.74	130.50	123.90	194.45	345.05	120.02	-	-
Advenzymes [2]	282.15	281.60	282.10	287.50	280.25	122.18	419.80	251.90	38	280.75
Advit Jewels	290.97	285.98	296.00	300.00	282.50	654.38	308.40	161.60	-	-
Aegis Log [1]	1299.80	1380.10	1312.50	1400.00	1312.50	1090.55	1528.00	576.00	38	1378.75
Aegis VopakT	294.25	296.80	296.00	299.50	294.05	532.79	320.95	158.00	-	-
Aequs	271.63	279.48	274.64	285.95	273.21	1216.84	285.95	113.30	-	-
Aeroflex Ind	539.60	536.60	539.60	553.50	527.55	981.03	584.15	158.00	-	-
AeroflexEnt	124.70	124.00	125.50	126.99	122.71	231.67	159.60	62.20	-	-
Aether Ind	1749.90	1699.30	1758.20	1758.20	1685.60	292.46	1798.00	728.00	-	-
Afcons Infra	245.10	247.80	246.50	250.05	246.50	370.68	479.40	225.35	-	-
Affle [2]	1501.00	1511.00	1511.00	1547.00	1502.10	216.33	1997.85	1251.85	147	1510.95
AGI Greenpac	792.90	804.40	791.90	816.00	790.05	112.34	896.15	465.00	-	-
AGI Infra	264.85	264.70	265.00	268.95	262.55	319.37	1408.00	224.70	-	-
Ahluwalia [2]	551.55	550.05	552.05	563.70	542.80	77.72	1076.60	545.00	16	550.00
AIA Engg [2]	3835.70	3869.00	3850.00	3910.90	3804.20	51.96	5175.00	3048.45	28	3860.95
Ajanta Ph [2]	3557.50	3620.80	3570.00	3758.90	3567.10	344.07	3796.95	2335.00	45	3617.45
Ajax Engg	591.65	587.00	591.65	597.00	586.00	41.37	697.55	394.80	-	-
Ajmera [2]	120.16	118.74	120.15	121.09	117.45	165.08	221.23	98.10	20	118.10
Akums Drugs	819.55	818.50	828.20	828.20	811.10	196.57	838.80	409.30	-	-
ALEM PHA [2]	861.50	825.45	866.00	876.40	821.70	266.15	998.00	635.30	21	826.20
Alembic Ltd [2]	108.44	107.23	109.10	110.59	106.11	819.58	117.91	70.64	22	107.27
Algoquant Fi	65.64	66.03	65.15	69.10	65.15	1174.61	76.20	47.80	-	-
Alicon [5]	724.85	869.80	730.15	869.80	726.05	953.31	1024.95	580.55	33	870.15
AlivusLife	1356.80	1379.30	1350.00	1390.00	1350.00	186.61	1493.80	819.00	-	-
Alkem labs [2]	5250.00	5163.50	5249.50	5276.50	5135.00	146.58	5933.00	5052.05	28	5146.00
ALKYL AMI [2]	1781.30	1761.70	1781.30	1818.80	1751.30	31.65	2115.00	1212.35	40	1761.80
Allcargo Glo [2]	10.53	10.13	10.78	10.78	10.05	7854.28	16.18	7.10	-	10.13
Allcargo Glo	13.19	13.13	13.03	13.40	13.01	885.57	22.00	12.03	-	-
ALLIED DIGIT [5]	109.99	108.53	110.80	113.37	108.00	187.49	204.50	86.50	-	108.75
AlliedBlend	716.50	718.90	716.50	729.00	711.65	319.56	753.80	382.10	-	-
Alok Ind	7.06	7.09	7.10	7.24	7.07	12343.10	18.45	6.98	-	-
Alpine Texwo	48.95	47.80	49.70	49.70	47.53	111.76	105.00	47.22	-	-
Amagi Media	563.85	549.45	560.00	568.45	541.30	281.62	727.40	310.20	-	-
Amar.Raj.Enr	766.30	754.55	768.95	781.65	750.00	706.71	1023.00	670.00	-	-
Amber	6606.50	6672.50	6639.00	6786.00	6617.00	224.40	8970.00	5404.00	159	6679.75
Ambuja Cem [2]	365.75	374.00	369.00	376.65	368.65	3219.93	588.55	366.55	25	372.15
AmirChand Ja	202.08	206.57	205.00	210.00	200.00	776.06	212.07	117.02	-	-
Amrutanjan [1]	505.25	514.75	505.25	522.20	505.25	62.88	759.00	476.85	24	514.30
Anand RathiW	2100.60	2120.00	2111.10	2127.60	2072.00	552.95	3735.00	1710.60	-	-
AnandRathiS	500.45	515.10	503.10	525.80	502.90	370.04	794.85	416.00	-	-
Anant Raj [2]	602.30	598.90	605.00	611.00	597.00	1122.02	744.10	403.00	70	598.85
Anant Raj Gl	127.02	125.96	128.00	128.29	125.26	140.77	186.30	109.10	-	-
Andhra Paper	72.32	72.68	72.00	73.93	72.00	240.99	86.89	58.00	-	-
Andhra Sug [2]	94.40	93.15	94.40	95.95	92.70	186.33	107.00	63.27	10	93.12
AngelOne	273.50	274.00	274.25	278.20	273.25	2439.79	2867.00	208.63	-	-
Anlon Health	36.39	34.58	37.17	37.24	34.58	18707.31	172.75	12.91	-	-
ANNU PROJ	47.84	48.22	47.85	50.20	47.85	585.40	75.60	46.55	-	-
AntelopusSel	1162.50	1125.90	1174.15	1178.15	1119.00	316.48	1290.90	357.00	-	-
AnthemBiosci	869.75	858.60	871.00	878.20	855.05	189.87	977.55	579.15	-	-
Antony W Hdg	364.35	364.55	364.35	371.70	361.05	68.04	605.00	337.55	-	-
Anuh Phar	89.68	87.40	90.31	91.05	87.00	70.32	99.50	67.00	-	-
Anup Engg	1591.20	1596.30	1605.30	1635.00	1590.10	11.75	2524.00	1422.30	-	-
Anupam Ras.	1177.80	1181.00	1181.00	1188.50	1169.00	133.97	1415.00	1045.20	-	-
Apar Ind	17803.00	17384.00	17804.00	17882.00	17291.00	116.17	19269.20	6800.00	61	17385.30
Apcotex Ind [2]	595.45	595.60	600.00	607.40	592.00	40.63	712.45	310.15	19	594.30
Apex	343.10	336.50	343.10	348.30	335.00	66.13	514.20	218.80	21	337.45
APL Apollo [2]	2188.60	2190.10	2201.90	2224.50	2181.60	587.35	2300.90	1680.00	105	2181.05
APOLLO [1]	402.60	403.45	402.90	410.70	401.70	4344.77	466.70	180.80	116	403.05
Apollo Hosp. [5]	8659.00	8165.50	8582.00	8659.00	8053.00	2108.53	9326.80	6680.00	74	8138.50
Apollo Pipes	513.70	507.85	516.90	525.00	505.00	166.14	668.80	252.10	-	-
Apollo Tyres [1]	406.75	404.70	412.90	412.95	402.00	684.15	540.30	365.35	13	404.20
Aptus V Hsg	233.34	232.53	235.00	236.87	230.00	1838.84	332.00	193.03	-	-
Aqylon Nexus	17.11	16.26	17.11	17.39	16.26	476.19	2247.00	16.26	-	-
Archean Chem	490.60	485.85	487.00	496.45	481.50	231.29	704.25	446.00	-	-
Ardee Indus	51.17	50.77	51.55	52.95	50.40	3252.52	73.19	46.50	-	-
Arfin IndiaL	88.16	89.19	88.05	91.00	88.05	916.40	106.20	45.16	-	-
Arih.Capital	90.58	89.74	90.58	92.55	88.98	513.59	120.00	56.97	-	-
Arisinfra So	135.00	143.88	140.00	146.40	136.79	4654.57	178.30	82.18	-	-
Arkade Dev	121.92	119.39	122.50	123.48	119.00	136.89	180.00	92.62	-	-
Arman Fin	1711.40	1744.20	1711.40	1756.70	1707.10	31.16	2159.10	1302.30	43	1738.15
ARMEE IN	375.00	300.00	375.00	375.00	300.00	10736.79	375.00	300.00	-	-
Arrow green	872.50	856.05	876.50	886.95	840.15	48.12	950.00	342.00	22	854.45
Artemis Med	366.60	345.55	368.95	370.10	342.10	1002.07	378.80	203.35	-	-
Arvind Fash [4]	410.15	387.45	407.10	411.35	386.00	332.56	572.20	366.60	372	388.50
Arvind Ltd	545.45	539.90	545.00	549.95	535.75	644.22	607.00	278.00	54	539.60
ArvindSmart	609.70	601.75	615.80	615.80	596.65	40.39	707.20	490.35	41	602.65
Asahi Ind. [1]	957.95	958.85	956.10	974.70	956.10	85.21	1072.95	775.05	56	959.70
Ashapura [2]	518.80	504.15	526.60	526.60	502.50	261.59	924.70	456.50	32	504.25
Ashiana h [2]	390.55	386.00	389.30	397.95	382.95	34.95	448.00	269.95	31	387.65
Ashok Leyl [1]	153.44	154.19	154.41	156.19	153.35	17703.28	215.35	134.20	24	154.35
Ashoka [5]	108.53	107.75	108.74	111.83	107.31	413.07	214.35	101.00	16	107.85
Asian Energy	478.25	471.85	479.10	482.45	463.00	211.57	565.70	230.00	-	-
Asian granit	50.10	49.68	51.00	51.00	49.26	1065.83	79.08	42.50	-	49.99
Asian Paints [1]	2415.00	2402.60	2410.00	2430.50	2390.00	553.70	2985.50	2116.00	49	2413.25
ASK Auto.	619.85	640.10	621.95	652.20	614.75	479.51	687.70	375.30	-	-
ASSET RECONST	142.51	144.59	143.51	149.27	143.32	1943.69	157.00	124.50	-	-
Asso Alcohol	634.60	615.45	634.60	636.45	615.10	44.14	1277.00	615.10	-	-
ASTECFE	696.25	722.75	699.00	787.80	699.00	1100.75	936.00	512.35	-	721.35
ASTERDM	733.95	697.15	735.05	739.55	691.75	2346.22	890.95	519.80	196	695.60
Astha Spint	37.53	34.15	36.61	36.90	33.96	1212.08	140.01	33.96	-	-
Astra Micro [2]	1652.60	1636.70	1651.40	1663.60	1621.00	270.44	1960.00	835.90	89	1634.35
Astral Poly [1]	1375.00	1370.40	1376.00	1384.10	1366.00	258.13	1767.95	1311.90	55	1377.20
Astrazeneca [2]	6254.50	6186.00	6210.00	6289.00	6120.50	56.73	9850.00	6130.00	89	6188.75
Atal RealTe	12.03	12.58	11.88	12.63	11.70	2281.14	36.70	11.70	-	-
AtherEnergy	1407.00	1425.00	1416.50	1441.00	1405.00	3085.29	1744.00	542.50	-	-
Atlanta Elec	1634.20	1608.10	1615.00	1652.50	1600.00	85.26	2152.60	707.60	-	-
ATUL AUTO [5]	438.75	448.15	440.00	454.00	440.00	83.53	596.65	381.00	23	449.80
ATUL.	5982.50	5915.50	5980.00	6064.50	5881.00	61.20	7198.20	5563.00	25	5926.60
AU SFB	1005.20	1010.30	1001.90	1015.10	995.20	1358.17	1144.65	719.45	27	1015.00
AUGMONT ENTE	1062.20	1086.55	1074.00	1138.50	1014.30	2989.28	1138.50	806.05	-	-
Aurionpro So	634.20	622.10	639.50	645.00	620.00	128.40	1247.15	620.15	31	622.70
Aurob Ph [1]	1697.70	1672.00	1696.00	1707.20	1649.30	1138.61	1739.60	1066.00	37	1666.50
Aurum Prop	220.31	232.37	221.80	238.54	220.06	461.82	264.64	151.90	-	-
Austin Engg	158.00	171.52	159.72	176.45	155.50	54.15	178.00	110.00	-	-
Authum Inv	541.80	546.60	542.85	559.00	541.00	158.57	3318.70	400.00	-	-
AUTOIND	81.99	82.66	81.11	84.25	81.11	106.74	103.85	48.41	15	82.41
Avadh Sugar	793.45	800.20	793.45	817.10	786.60	100.92	885.00	307.75	24	801.05
Avalon Tech	2302.00	2296.70	2205.00	2319.50	2180.00	2010.77	2618.00	777.30	-	-
Avantel	149.22	154.06	149.02	156.50	149.00	1744.91	215.00	117.05	-	-
Avanti Feeds [1]	747.50	717.80	751.00	759.10	715.00	468.69	1592.30	631.45	21	718.95
AvenueSai	15.36	15.12	15.31	15.52	15.08	7376.76	20.50	12.92	-	-
AVT Natur [1]	92.20	91.29	93.00	93.49	90.41	232.45	101.80	53.34	20	90.73
Awfis Space	247.10	244.10	249.35	250.70	242.60	196.59	639.40	229.05	-	-
Axis Bank [2]	1212.10	1226.00	1201.10	1237.10	1201.10	6178.74	1418.30	1125.50	15	1226.00
Aye Finance [2]	159.70	155.89	160.70	161.29	155.00	864.88	197.95	155.00	20	155.75
AYM Syntex	285.95	292.15	292.35	300.25	290.05	44.13	330.00	144.35	91	291.70
Azad Engg	2914.20	2963.20	2941.00	3127.90	2875.60	5708.54	3127.90	1360.00	-	-
B										
Baazar Style	405.00	384.75	409.00	409.00	384.75	1886.37	447.10	229.95	-	-
BAJAJ AUTO	10811.00	10874.00	10779.00	10953.00	10779.00	313.71	12470.00	8490.10	28	10860.00
Bajaj Cons [1]	493.00	495.55	499.00	503.90	493.45	260.25	691.15	232.00	29	495.35
Bajaj Elect [2]	309.85	303.40	309.00	315.00	302.15	155.81	561.05	300.70	-	303.55
Bajaj Fin [1]	973.80	959.40	981.50	981.50	955.80	6625.62	1177.60	788.40	33	961.25
Bajaj Finser [1]	1742.40	1731.00	1742.40	1748.00	1702.10	1086.21	2194.65	1598.15	125	1732.80
Bajaj HCare	335.00	327.20	337.80	338.00	325.15	84.33	509.90	272.35	-	-
Bajaj Hindus [1]	19.98	19.54	20.09	20.51	19.41	12481.02	26.00	14.89	-	19.57
Bajaj Holdng	10600.00	10788.00	10686.00	10805.00	10655.00	40.12	13245.00	8597.50	40	10781.65
Bajaj HsgFin	81.26	82.00	81.33	83.40	81.33	4275.07	113.45	72.65	-	-
Bajel Proj.	170.20	164.90	168.93	172.56	163.50	199.11	219.64	135.10	-	-
Balaji Amine [2]	2142.10	2118.50	2143.00	2179.00	2095.00	117.15	2627.95	905.15	35	2117.30
Balaji Tele. [2]	91.74	91.26	91.74	93.78	90.71	130.43	132.55	70.00	-	91.49
Balkrish Ind [2]	2126.20	2117.00	2121.60	2155.00	2105.70	119.71	2775.00	1971.50	30	2118.20
BalmerLawrie	161.59	161.16	161.00	165.65	161.00	90.99	213.00	148.35	11	161.25
BalramChini [1]	672.90	662.85	678.00	688.40	654.00	1285.69	781.00	393.40	41	662.85
Balu Forge	501.15	496.35	505.00	511.95	493.50	310.85	678.00	341.05	-	-
Banco Prod [2]	595.65	606.30	598.30	617.45	598.30	110.12	879.60	503.00	21	605.45
Bandhan Bk	185.31	178.23	184.01	184.37	177.26	13031.63	220.70	134.30	21	178.60
Bank of Maha	79.16	79.37	80.00	81.50	79.37	19568.17	94.50	54.70	8	79.50
Bansal Wire	327.65	323.45	330.35	333.95	322.00	109.68	370.00	222.50	-	-
BASF India	3435.60	3447.80	3445.00	3515.80	3438.60	10.89	4821.00	2906.90	24	3449.60
Bata India [5]	620.35	618.75	620.40	627.00	617.05	60.00	1236.85	605.55	46	618.60
Bayer Crop	3602.70	3627.60	3615.00	3665.80	3615.00	21.12	5133.00	3575.00	22	3627.95
BCL Ind.	32.42	31.79	32.42	32.74	31.51	223.78	42.08	25.53	-	-
BDL [5]	1085.10	1110.10	1091.00	1127.60	1091.00	1193.04	1633.15	1090.00	78	1109.05
Behari Lal	447.05	485.60	451.90	529.95	449.60	15602.00	548.00	415.00	-	-
Belrise Inds	240.52	240.36	240.50	244.14	240.00	1036.66	268.20	142.59	-	-
BEML [5]	1966.60	1992.40	1956.60	2002.80	1956.60	204.72	2276.75	1361.10	90	1991.90
BergerPaints [1]	448.20	455.45	451.15	458.75	449.25	302.32	594.20	391.50	45	455.05
Best Agroli	17.86	17.53	17.74	18.25	17.33	672.93	464.15	12.30	-	-
BF UTILI [5]	508.90	507.75	512.00	525.00	504.00	73.55	834.00	369.00	-	508.45
BHAGIL [5]	377.85	406.45	382.00	413.50	378.00	364.83	413.85	128.15	24	404.95
Bhagira.Chm	240.25	238.55	240.00	242.75	235.05	78.14	316.90	170.60	-	-
Bhagynagar [2]	408.10	411.15	405.00	422.00	400.05	87.64	469.80	92.00	-	414.35
BHANSALI [1]	124.00	124.40	124.00	127.19	123.75	743.88	138.50	75.52	16	124.80
BHARAT BI [5]	2123.70	2095.20	2129.40	2163.70	2091.60	13.88	3403.40	2009.45	21	2097.05
Bharat Elect [1]	387.75	388.30	386.40	391.00	385.00	9671.14	473.25	380.35	46	389.85
Bharat Forge [2]	1942.00	1926.00	1931.00	1944.90	1891.60	1059.26	2293.00	1182.85	76	1922.90
Bharat Paren	1926.00	1792.80	1945.00	1948.00	1756.40	15.98	2277.60	1125.70	-	-
Bharat Ra [5]	1005.70	1003.90	1008.10	1030.00	998.50	28.00	3030.25	1000.00	12	1004.10
Bharat Wire	167.18	164.36	166.95	169.66	164.00	98.89	262.20	149.15	16	164.70
BharatCoking	33.50	32.80	33.49	33.55	32.45	4485.55	45.09	29.74	-	-
BharatSeats	213.61	212.38	216.13	217.12	210.50	50.39	263.18	133.60	-	-
Bharti Airte [5]	1771.20	1757.00	1775.20	1779.50	1753.70	8080.36	2174.70	1745.00	64	1758.15
Bharti Hexa	1409.40	1424.50	1409.40	1438.00	1401.00	102.46	1955.60	1398.00	-	-
BHEL [2]	413.35	415.50	415.10	421.80	411.70	8153.81	446.75	229.70	60	415.00
Bikaji Fds	531.15	521.80	530.00	543.00	516.00	174.43	768.50	516.00	-	-
Billionbrain	183.52	183.91	184.10	187.65	183.08	24545.48	227.20	112.00	-	-
Biocon [5]	377.00	370.30	378.00	381.20	370.30	1849.49	447.00	337.20	200	371.00
BIRLA CORPN.	849.90	840.05	850.00	857.80	839.00	20.63	1345.00	773.90	26	840.20
Birla Eric	368.95	381.15	372.00	387.35	371.45	654.41	418.00	104.00	25	381.60
Birlasoft	269.05	271.70	270.00	280.30	269.90	1727.42	474.00	267.40	-	-
Bk of baroda [2]	227.68	230.55	230.40	235.70	230.29	10920.67	325.55	223.90	6	231.00
Bk of India	130.11	130.24	130.89	132.73	130.24	5018.15	178.45	118.90	5	130.50
BL kashyap [1]	50.90	50.36	50.61	53.44	50.00	421.04	63.60	40.79	20	50.40
Black Box	812.80	804.80	820.00	854.60	800.25	1137.62	1103.00	444.30	-	-
BLS [1]	219.55	218.26	219.55	223.93	217.23	602.31	358.90	217.60	61	218.25
BLS e-Svc	321.10	328.60	323.00	332.00	321.10	445.29	339.80	124.30	-	-
Blue CloudSo	20.23	19.90	20.35	20.82	19.56	4389.31	24.50	18.85	-	-
Blue Jet Hlt	549.60	538.05	555.00	562.35	535.00	399.67	692.90	325.00	-	-
Blue Star [2]	1529.50	1518.00	1525.00	1541.10	1502.10	615.61	2032.00	1432.00	87	1517.45
BlueDart Exp	4576.00	4629.00	4574.90	4654.20	4539.30	14.41	7030.15	4523.60	35	4625.20
BluestoneJew	806.05	794.85	806.20	812.00	782.00	805.92	969.90	399.80	-	-
BluspringEnt	143.11	141.74	145.80	147.80	140.10	149.66	152.50	43.98	-	-
Bom Dyeing [2]	106.70	105.62	106.75	107.84	105.00	316.53	180.55	92.10	104	105.95
BombayBu [2]	1355.00	1357.40	1362.40	1378.80	1350.00	24.69	2135.00	1301.00	118	1358.85
BoranaWeaves	296.40	278.20	297.80	297.80	275.00	66.41	420.00	215.35	-	-
Borosil	276.21	293.38	282.00	300.00	279.41	1096.44	363.40	213.73	-	-
Borosil.Ren.	452.50	458.15	452.95	470.80	452.95	523.40	721.00	374.40	-	-
Bosch Home	1934.40	1876.70	1950.10	1979.00	1851.20	72.92	1979.00	1021.30	-	-
BOSCH	45700.00	47100.00	45960.00	47545.00	45960.00	30.39	49629.50	28650.05	59	47100.00
BPCL	299.35	303.20	301.95	308.25	301.10	5525.50	391.85	266.55	9	303.00
BrainbeesSol	184.37	179.94	184.37	187.00	178.35	2624.71	389.65	163.37	-	-
Brigade	563.05	575.25	559.10	586.85	559.10	566.67	801.56	461.25	54	575.90
BrigadeHotel	56.14	56.96	55.85	57.80	55.85	282.04	87.79	54.36	-	-
BrightcomGr [2]	9.28	9.22	9.20	9.42	9.20	3466.18	15.12	7.71	-	9.24

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Pasupati Acr	75.20	72.73	76.10	76.89	71.87	180.67	81.29	40.41	-	-
Patanjali Fd	371.40	363.00	369.70	372.25	363.00	1344.95	614.05	328.20	-	-
Patel engg [1]	26.45	26.45	26.41	27.45	26.35	1520.75	38.52	22.08	7	26.48
Paushak	668.30	665.25	672.50	680.90	651.20	26.25	826.75	342.50	-	-
PayTM	1683.00	1678.00	1701.00	1708.00	1667.10	2424.28	1855.50	930.60	-	-
PB Fintech	1081.00	1063.90	1087.00	1098.00	1031.40	8915.21	1964.20	1031.40	-	-
PC Jeweller [1]	13.23	13.20	13.29	13.74	13.11	227698.09	14.87	7.45	-	13.20
PCBL	330.45	331.10	330.45	339.80	330.15	1026.59	394.00	226.50	-	-
PDS	348.95	352.30	350.00	357.00	349.85	61.45	418.50	246.05	-	-
PENNAR IND [5]	180.28	184.00	183.00	187.25	182.10	783.07	279.80	128.90	25	183.45
PERSISTENT [5]	5162.00	5279.00	5200.00	5397.00	5200.00	611.25	6597.00	4242.65	48	5285.00
Petronet LNG	282.95	284.50	285.10	288.90	284.00	2419.30	326.40	235.45	10	284.90
Pfizer Ltd.	3912.90	3875.30	3916.00	3933.80	3833.50	39.85	5561.55	3831.05	23	3875.65
PG Electro [1]	493.15	493.45	499.90	506.00	493.45	825.73	644.90	436.85	128	494.95
PGIL [5]	1290.40	1282.10	1297.50	1324.60	1280.00	87.28	1356.55	605.50	205	1283.35
Phoenix Mill [2]	1929.00	1935.00	1940.40	1963.40	1916.20	421.35	2168.65	1465.30	221	1946.45
PhysicsWall	125.15	123.48	126.05	126.70	122.00	5681.88	161.99	77.72	-	-
PI INDUS. [1]	2288.80	2310.00	2290.00	2322.80	2270.00	174.01	3829.90	2193.60	25	2306.00
PiccadilyAgr	602.85	592.35	606.90	613.25	588.55	87.46	809.70	515.00	-	-
Pidilite [1]	1461.00	1465.10	1481.00	1496.90	1465.10	940.93	1707.95	1259.45	58	1471.00
Pilani Inv.	4027.70	3956.50	4050.00	4127.00	3901.80	5.71	5976.00	3810.05	133	3970.05
Pine Labs	171.55	171.79	172.00	176.75	169.14	19780.22	284.00	134.73	-	-
Piramal Fin	2127.50	2043.90	2098.00	2127.50	2012.00	230.03	2326.40	1260.00	-	-
Piramal Phr	209.07	206.52	209.00	210.40	205.21	2240.52	231.93	132.30	-	-
Pitti Engg [5]	1131.40	1139.50	1132.00	1154.80	1131.30	35.90	1228.15	677.20	43	1139.80
PN Gadgil Jw	585.05	590.15	585.00	599.00	581.55	257.82	736.40	503.00	-	-
Pnb Gilts	71.89	73.99	72.00	78.90	72.00	2682.74	101.45	58.75	13	74.16
PNB Housng	1098.20	1120.00	1098.00	1132.50	1095.90	1164.22	1210.80	730.00	12	1123.55
PNC Infra [2]	129.80	133.18	130.05	134.89	130.05	790.72	296.80	116.25	6	133.10
PNGS Reva Di	513.40	511.65	517.60	524.95	508.70	78.61	644.00	324.25	-	-
POCL Enterp	139.89	137.42	139.89	144.86	136.15	35.69	168.97	135.91	-	-
Pokarna Ltd [2]	718.05	705.70	724.40	737.75	702.25	79.84	1147.35	692.55	-	706.80
Poly Medicu [5]	1644.70	1673.80	1639.90	1684.50	1625.80	118.03	2093.95	1184.00	50	1674.95
POLYCAB INDIA	8102.50	8026.00	8102.50	8177.00	8026.00	494.72	10126.00	6663.00	-	-
Polyplex	1061.30	1055.00	1066.60	1117.50	1050.00	38.59	1267.75	743.00	67	1056.30
PonawallaFin	443.00	443.85	445.10	453.90	442.20	687.45	570.40	361.20	-	-
Pondy Oxides	461.60	452.65	464.20	466.65	450.00	373.69	1619.00	427.60	-	-
Ponni Sug(er	384.15	372.20	382.30	394.20	370.05	21.77	454.20	253.50	11	371.45
Power Finan	324.10	325.50	325.85	332.50	325.00	9986.22	486.45	320.80	5	326.00
Power grid	261.50	260.50	261.50	262.00	258.10	9769.84	324.80	250.05	16	260.45
Power Trad	155.75	155.56	156.00	156.39	154.70	1233.69	229.40	149.90	13	155.60
Powerica Ltd	599.75	600.60	607.00	620.85	598.00	308.63	676.95	365.10	-	-
POWERMECH	2397.20	2490.50	2488.90	2535.00	2442.00	293.61	3008.85	1718.00	23	2490.65
Praj Ind.ltd [2]	307.75	305.85	307.75	312.50	304.50	391.10	427.75	273.05	40	306.20
Prakash Ind.	121.62	123.72	120.85	129.00	120.62	750.60	173.00	110.00	7	123.80
PRANAV CONST	100.18	100.10	101.50	103.15	97.25	2087.33	165.10	96.49	-	-
PRASOL CHEMI	840.15	839.10	868.25	914.90	812.30	2133.29	914.90	601.00	-	-
Precam	117.16	116.78	117.65	120.19	116.30	78.59	208.00	104.05	31	117.00
Precision Wr [1]	500.15	492.45	497.50	509.00	490.25	310.96	524.00	181.60	52	491.45
Premier Enr	870.00	870.10	868.30	883.00	865.20	1144.01	1134.00	660.00	-	-
Premier Expl [2]	675.30	684.10	676.00	685.70	676.00	494.97	829.95	378.80	107	684.40
prestige Est	1417.50	1481.90	1425.00	1493.00	1420.50	1284.00	1804.65	1090.45	352	1482.00
Pricol Ltd [1]	749.35	747.60	752.00	763.90	742.15	240.48	822.35	500.30	42	749.45
Prime Focus [1]	317.50	316.00	318.65	326.00	313.35	3709.51	367.25	161.05	-	316.05
Primo Chemic	27.38	26.64	27.90	28.00	26.40	448.25	29.80	16.10	-	-
Prince Pipe	255.85	255.75	257.75	261.70	255.00	55.17	352.20	205.00	-	-
PRIORITY JE	293.64	301.60	305.00	326.80	297.80	517.50	329.55	209.61	-	-
Prism Cement	109.27	108.74	109.89	111.29	108.25	221.38	165.80	97.70	54	108.75
Pritika Auto	18.40	17.08	19.00	19.00	16.91	394.24	20.99	10.41	-	-
Privi Speclt	3605.50	3586.60	3605.00	3624.00	3557.30	102.69	3785.30	2339.50	-	-
Procter&Gam	6871.50	6798.50	6904.00	6956.50	6782.00	44.98	14471.65	6781.00	28	6800.05
ProstarmInfo	135.83	134.66	134.71	138.50	134.05	156.33	208.70	114.64	-	-
Protean EGov	666.65	659.30	666.65	684.40	651.65	574.56	909.50	444.00	-	-
Prozone Rlty	56.20	56.52	56.10	57.70	55.85	1330.70	72.77	39.55	-	-
Prudent Corp	3098.70	3129.20	3105.70	3150.00	3084.20	30.36	4105.50	2121.00	-	-
PSPPROJECT	782.65	767.00	787.00	803.90	763.95	62.42	1142.00	569.30	45	766.40
PTC Ind.	22535.00	22190.00	22535.00	23245.00	22035.00	20.72	24125.00	14499.00	-	-
PTCFIN SER	28.00	29.08	28.00	29.49	27.65	2963.29	40.51	23.78	8	28.97
Pudumjee [1]	94.67	97.22	94.50	99.80	94.00	344.26	127.00	63.11	10	98.58
Punjab Na [2]	111.75	113.06	111.80	114.90	111.80	15255.06	135.15	98.50	6	113.40
PUNJABNSIND	21.11	21.33	21.10	21.47	21.09	1167.89	32.47	20.46	11	21.34
Puravankara [5]	204.84	206.34	205.00	211.20	204.54	81.71	288.65	160.00	31	206.85
PURPLE STYLE	530.75	547.90	527.00	556.00	526.95	97.34	588.90	501.05	-	-
PVP Ven	55.91	53.12	54.50	56.88	53.12	2852.03	72.16	23.10	47	53.20
PVR Inox	1190.10	1242.70	1197.90	1262.60	1187.00	711.17	1357.80	907.40	-	-

Q

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
Quadrant Fut	542.15	547.45	545.60	567.20	540.30	852.16	567.20	248.55	-	-
QualityPower	1614.30	1584.80	1610.10	1675.00	1572.30	267.71	1675.00	581.00	-	-
QUESS	342.10	334.95	342.10	346.00	332.05	513.19	386.35	166.05	20	334.85
Quickheal	145.92	144.49	146.00	149.79	143.35	78.44	371.00	125.00	-	144.85

R

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
RACL Geartech	1588.60	1594.80	1581.40	1616.80	1570.20	32.65	1927.70	921.80	-	-
RadiKhait [2]	4364.00	4366.00	4408.90	4516.00	4365.10	387.85	4747.95	2504.60	83	4360.05
Raghav Prod.	1718.10	1809.00	1737.80	1824.00	1731.00	153.48	1943.70	561.30	-	-
Rail Tel	259.25	265.65	259.10	281.00	258.65	6564.88	400.80	245.00	-	-
RAIN [2]	215.41	213.94	213.50	219.99	212.30	2138.95	251.95	99.85	-	213.90
Rainbow Ch.	1367.80	1314.30	1360.80	1383.00	1305.10	363.56	1610.00	1084.00	-	-
Rajputa Sta	165.45	168.36	166.88	171.00	166.31	279.57	202.22	101.70	-	-
Rajratan Glo	466.15	461.60	465.00	470.75	458.50	36.27	563.95	305.55	-	-
Rallis India [1]	199.96	199.73	199.70	200.86	198.05	503.04	315.50	196.70	17	199.80
Ram Ratna Wr	583.80	582.40	589.70	597.00	578.65	193.83	669.20	268.00	-	-
Ramco Systm	553.70	554.60	556.00	572.30	552.20	42.41	968.20	342.50	68	554.55
Ramco Cem [1]	844.25	845.55	849.90	869.00	842.05	205.67	1214.00	822.50	107	846.45
Ramco Inds. [1]	310.10	307.60	310.05	323.70	305.15	172.76	395.80	230.70	21	307.15
RAMKY INFRA	294.05	279.10	291.05	301.00	274.50	161.27	706.50	275.30	10	280.30
RANE MADRAS	1380.90	1351.90	1397.40	1405.00	1348.50	51.91	1439.45	612.50	30	1353.10
Rashi Perip.	925.35	953.50	930.15	1004.70	930.15	1657.05	1004.70	313.05	-	-
Rashtr.chem.	108.11	109.97	108.20	111.90	108.20	2028.73	157.40	106.10	14	110.00
RatanindiaEn	25.66	26.06	26.00	27.58	25.45	5394.56	54.50	24.40	-	-
Rategain Tr.	830.00	851.55	835.00	870.00	823.40	381.97	1050.00	437.00	-	-
Ratnamn M [2]	2833.30	2725.50	2822.50	2833.00	2715.10	42.22	3342.35	1900.05	54	2721.70
Ratnaveer Pr	331.15	330.75	332.65	344.40	328.20	6063.42	344.40	130.50	-	-
Ravindra Enr	149.12	149.67	149.12	151.50	146.51	173.98	196.45	117.07	-	-
Raymond	1185.75	1213.05	1185.75	1241.00	1185.40	1545.04	1241.40	320.40	-	1215.20
Raymond Life	660.55	642.05	664.45	669.25	638.20	195.23	1246.40	628.25	-	-
RaymondReal	672.55	669.95	676.00	684.90	666.60	620.73	741.95	349.00	-	-
RAYS OF BELIEF	255.96	234.64	255.96	256.89	230.60	300.64	267.61	208.03	-	-
RBLBank	402.00	403.35	405.00	412.35	403.35	3855.69	429.55	261.70	72	404.55
RECL	292.45	299.00	294.00	301.75	293.00	6842.34	390.40	292.20	5	299.40
Redington [2]	405.45	407.00	405.45	413.50	404.40	4204.33	419.55	191.25	23	407.05
Redtape	117.48	117.60	118.00	119.20	116.50	211.19	158.99	107.53	-	-
Refex Refrig [2]	272.05	265.25	272.05	279.75	264.00	312.70	382.05	188.00	13	266.00
RegaalResour	88.64	88.08	89.47	91.19	87.60	119.21	103.00	57.27	-	-
Relax Foot [1]	291.50	291.20	291.55	297.45	290.80	115.88	455.45	236.55	39	291.20
Reli Indinf	677.05	677.35	676.00	687.45	673.00	39.55	963.65	620.50	99	676.95
Reliance	1182.00	1187.00	1182.00	1196.50	1181.70	16376.79	1611.20	1182.05	41	1187.50
Religare ent	232.05	228.91	232.60	235.00	228.00	1077.32	284.85	197.00	-	228.85
Remsons Ind [2]	111.56	113.93	113.43	124.80	112.97	869.57	152.40	75.36	30	114.86
Renaiss.Glo	164.27	165.02	165.90	167.60	163.28	340.64	173.80	85.00	-	-
RENTOMOJO	502.15	510.35	505.10	532.40	505.10	2511.33	581.95	482.45	-	-
REPCO HOME	343.65	341.70	345.00	346.25	340.00	51.21	455.40	333.90	5	341.90
Respon Ind [1]	168.09	165.38	168.02	176.59	163.35	390.37	242.25	117.80	-	165.75
RestaurBrand	91.98	91.58	92.25	92.45	90.00	1853.91	111.15	57.15	-	-
Rhetan TMT L	16.69	17.51	17.52	17.52	17.51	9861.68	34.87	14.42	-	-
RHI Magnesit	393.20	384.85	393.90	398.90	383.75	469.41	508.30	323.05	-	-
Rico Auto [1]	126.22	126.92	126.50	129.18	125.65	579.78	157.90	78.10	62	127.25
RIR Power El	188.08	184.10	190.00	197.90	183.11	2667.40	213.94	154.00	-	-
Rishabh Ins	723.85	703.00	723.90	729.70	695.00	122.46	852.00	315.00	-	-
RITES	192.31	209.05	192.60	218.90	192.60	50416.24	259.30	175.10	25	209.35
RK Forgings [2]	714.65	702.30	719.90	724.00	699.10	529.47	772.40	460.15	105	701.55
RMC Switch	210.37	209.58	213.77	223.19	207.96	40.75	530.00	194.10	-	-
Rolex Rings	190.58	190.09	192.11	193.99	188.25	1052.37	1423.10	99.79	-	-
Rossari Bio	427.70	417.95	430.00	434.60	416.00	70.44	690.30	375.00	-	-
Rossell Tech	1481.70	1503.20	1480.00	1525.00	1455.20	253.11	1525.00	551.90	-	-
Roto Pumps	63.26	64.58	63.73	65.55	63.57	473.63	80.77	47.50	-	-
Route Mobile	447.20	445.00	446.00	456.55	444.05	67.89	819.75	410.70	-	-
RPG lifesc [8]	3089.20	3037.10	3103.60	3112.80	2986.00	46.59	3130.50	1731.25	43	3036.35
RPOWER	19.77	19.69	19.77	20.39	19.63	19097.26	50.70	19.46	-	19.75
RPSG Vent.	833.85	850.50	837.05	873.90	835.00	40.38	1179.00	551.90	-	-
RR Kabel	2523.20	2518.60	2530.00	2537.00	2477.00	254.65	2983.80	1181.60	-	-
RSystems Int [1]	298.69	279.90	300.00	303.70	269.51	12512.63	446.55	213.50	14	277.30
RTNPOWER	6.87	6.89	6.80	6.98	6.80	10508.62	11.94	6.69	-	6.89
Rubicon Rese	1609.00	1619.40	1601.20	1635.00	1577.70	228.31	1899.00	570.75	-	-
RUPA & CO [1]	132.39	130.52	132.10	133.88	130.00	90.77	209.60	109.50	13	130.35
RVNL	197.90	201.76	198.70	209.65	198.25	17689.29	400.70	195.15	-	-

S

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	Qty	52 WH	52 WL	PE	BSE Cl
S&W Solar	171.08	171.18	170.75	177.60	170.10	1116.55	260.80	148.00	-	-
SaatvikGreen	414.50	413.55	415.50	421.60	410.00	33.02	567.00	328.00	-	-
Safari Ind	1430.90	1429.60	1439.90	1439.90	1418.10	58.65	2507.10	1363.10	-	-
Sagility Ind	42.54	42.58	42.69	43.40	42.38	11436.38	57.89	35.83	-	-
Sai Life Sci	1559.90	1524.50	1565.70	1577.90	1516.40	537.18	1697.00	783.85	-	-
Sai Parenter	502.50	529.30	500.05	539.95	500.05	352.16	706.00	400.00	-	-
Sai Silks	76.19	76.27	76.00	77.63	75.90	385.22	223.03	75.37	-	-
Sakar Health	1121.85	1093.05	1116.40	1143.80	1082.00	58.26	1229.85	345.50	-	-
SAKSOFT [1]	139.78	139.43	140.00	143.67	136.61	169.14	222.50	108.00	22	139.65
SALASAR [1]	4.16	4.08	4.16	4.30	3.80	14749.41	11.53	3.81	-	4.10
SALSTEEL	97.08	99.06	99.87	101.53	97.00	1173.62	101.00	26.11	-	98.93
Salzer Elec	535.65	536.40	535.70	546.00	530.35	18.50	953.30	488.65	21	536.15
SambhvStee	162.24	164.90	162.45	167.31	160.11	5951.53	167.31	81.42	-	-
Samhi Hotels	149.34	153.68	149.35	155.00	149.35	803.68	217.30	127.00	-	-
Samman Cap.	136.48	136.54	136.94	141.19	136.00	4575.01	192.95	129.00	-	-
Samvard.Moth	158.56	163.26	160.35	164.10	160.35	15308.00	173.27	101.01	-	-
Sanathan Tex	515.00	508.15	524.00	527.75	505.00	99.23	544.30	352.60	-	-
Sandhar	582.70	585.90	583.00	599.95	583.00	133.19	764.10	423.90	19	587.20
Sandur Mang.	182.69	182.18	181.27	184.69	181.00	268.85	273.00	160.80	-	-
Sangam India	645.55	626.90	642.35	650.55	619.85	27.71	675.95	391.50	25	628.55
Sanghvi M [1]	454.00	455.20	457.10	471.90	452.40	204.77	532.40	221.00	24	456.05
Sanofi ind	3072.10	3057.00	3080.00	3175.00	3051.60	15.07	4896.00	3050.00	20	3058.80
Sansera Engg	4362.20	4537.50	4450.00	4571.00	4317.30	247.14	4743.50	1364.20	-	-
Sapphire Fd	211.05	212.08	211.48	216.92	209.45	448.92	310.50	139.91	-	-
SaraswatiSDL	83.92	75.81	80.88	80.88	74.30	224.22	90.69	46.15	-	-
Sarda EnMin [1]	500.35	497.30	500.35	507.75	495.10	213.97	624.00	452.75	20	496.70
Saregama (I) [1]	493.45	506.55	498.90	518.65	495.35	643.87	574.85	305.65	42	507.05
SarveshwarFd	3.44	3.49	3.45	3.56	3.45	1207.66	6.64	2.50	-	-
SASKEN COMM	1658.80	1672.70	1680.00	1709.80	1650.00	12.71	2785.05	993.05	29	1661.65
Satia Ind.	68.48	69.70	68.70	71.26	68.70	198.88	83.80	50.80	-	-
SATIN	237.69	232.20	239.30	239.30	230.15	386.11	274.20	136.25	7	232.10
SBC Exports	54.73	58.29	54.99	59.50	54.83	15616.37	59.50	21.15	-	-
SBFC Fin.	84.46	85.48	85.40	86.36	84.70	642.93	123.00	79.60	-	-
SBI Cards	581.00	578.05	585.15	591.25	578.05	582.33	965.00	565.45	-	-
SBI FUNDS M	517.80	516.05	517.80	524.45	514.00	1541.38	624.95	514.00	-	-
SBILIFE	1735.00	1696.40	1724.00	1729.50	1681.00	1813.20	2132.90	1653.00	65	1691.15
SchlossBanga	533.60	573.80	532.00	586.95	532.00	1251.66	586.95	384.50	-	-
SCHNEIDER [2]	1192.70	1203.40	1197.30	1226.80	1190.00	249.88	1548.30	572.60	149	1204.50
ScodaTubes	130.14	124.87	127.75	127.90	124.03	553.57	181.48	110.00	-	-
SE INVESTM [1]	78.59	76.41	78.00	79.10	75.62	7129.86	94.84	30.00	28	76.31
Sedemac Mech	3485.60	3494.50	3499.00	3587.00	3460.80	178.98	3596.00	1413.10	-	-
Senco Gold	328.30	320.95	329.00	332.70	320.00	502.58	430.00	276.00	-	-
Senores Phar	1403.70	1385.80	1403.70	1413.00	1370.00	268.54	1599.00	662.45	-	-
SEPC	5.10	5.02	5.15	5.19	5.01	5233.53	12.24	4.65	-	-
Servote.Pwr	71.34	70.25	71.10	72.19	70.04	364.90	141.50	57.51	-	-
Seshaasai Te	368.80	369.95	372.15	377.80	368.20	48.58	437.45	209.11	-	-
SFL [5]	631.50	634.10	637.30	645.10	630.00	76.85	832.00	460.75	45	633.80
SG Mart L	755.95	750.75	760.85	769.05	743.00	125.10	860.60	313.10	-	-
SGFinserveLt	595.30	604.35	595.30	613.20	593.20	293.14	727.45	323.00	-	-
Sh Renu Sug [1]	22.54	21.89	22.60	23.02	21.73	8847.06	31.34	21.06	-	21.88
Shadowfax Te	280.85	280.25	282.00	289.80	278.15	7428.81	292.20	98.55	-	-
Shaily Eng	3040.80	3063.00	3042.70	3125.00	3042.70	80.02	3615.20	1770.90	-	-
SHAKTI PUMPS	458.00	461.35	459.95	471.00	458.60	477.18	834.85	455.50	30	461.50
SHALBY	142.01	138.65	142.00	145.88	135.00	263.67	271.45	125.70	13	139.05
Shank Jewel	88.80	90.25	89.80	94.44	89.24	3014.63	115.90	87.25	-	-
Shankara Bui	1244.20	1231.00	1249.10	1257.90	1221.10	84.71	1380.00	636.00	-	-
Shanti Eduln	188.92	189.64	187.84	191.49	187.21	129.98	239.96	172.90	-	-
Shanti Gear [1]	601.65	579.90	604.80	604.80	571.60	120.37	741.80	385.70	66	581.90
ShantiGoInt	306.85	308.60	308.00	321.00	306.15	3315.95	333.09	155.00	-	-
Sharda Crop	721.45	723.50	719.15	734.85	719.15	58.85	1297.80	714.95	9	723.25
SHARDA MO [2]	971.25	956.95	964.75	986.85	953.05	37.17	1189.00	701.85	17	957.90
ShareInd Sec	205.68	205.01	206.58	208.90	202.50	703.87	233.35	115.36	-	-
Shilchar Tec	4032.70	4084.00	4050.00	4105.60	4036.40	9.91	5399.00	2852.50	-	-
SHILPA ME [1]	1055.75	1047.20	1060.00	1075.00	1033.50	492.22	1075.75	260.00	131	1045.75
Shipping Cor	272.90	270.50	273.00	275.95	269.75	1048.77	368.50	195.45	8	270.50
Shiprocket L	119.99	120.16	120.00	123.97	119.51	1916.19	156.90	116.64	-	-
Shiva Cement	14.91	13.76	14.50	14.50	13.00	694.86	17.94	13.00	-	-
Shivalik Bi	1111.30	1071.70	1140.00	1148.90	1060.00	233.74	1215.70	368.60	-	-
Shivalik Ras	411.35	403.45	414.80	423.00	400.00	45.38	471.00	206.40	-	-
SHK	140.33	141.02	139.96	142.78	139.65	181.37	251.70	111.70	-	141.05
SHOPPER ST [5]	418.95	415.00	410.00	426.00	410.00	26.63	558.60	267.00	-	415.30
Shree Cem	21900.00	22345.00	21900.00	22400.00	21900.00	20.96	30274.00	21595.00	53	22244.70
ShreejiShipp	763.30	770.40	764.00	774.00	764.00	359.79	774.00	222.00	-	-
SHREEPUSHK	481.90	492.75	480.90	505.05	480.90	70.02	544.75	273.40	35	492.15
Shringar Hou	215.91	224.60	216.85	231.00	216.79	2130.48	266.50	166.00	-	-
Shriram Fin	971.50	982.70	972.20	987.00	965.10	5552.50	1153.70	603.15	-	-
Shriram Pist	4749.20	4653.70	4774.40	4774.40	4620.30	75.70	4843.00	2525.80	-	-
Shriram Prop	69.86	69.21	70.15	70.64	68.51	334.58	99.44	60.57	-	-
Shukra Pharm	60.30	62.09	60.96	63.36	60.77	6037.72	63.36	40.06	-	-
ShyamMetalic	1074.00	1065.00	1076.90	1078.50	1055.00	235.25	1148.00	746.00	-	-
Siemens Ener	3199.00	3200.00	3211.40	3322.80	3200.00	666.70	3968.00	2115.00	-	-
Siemens Ltd. [2]	3710.00	3725.60	3721.10	3789.10	3720.00	183.30	4149.40	2827.00	104	3761.95
Sigachi Ind	28.76	28.80	28.83	29.46	28.74	1852.94	40.85	16.65	-	-
SignatureGlo	754.45	727.15	750.00	761.85	721.05	331.50	1153.90	705.20	-	-
Signpost Ind	257.85	262.00	257.00	268.85	256.95	48.74	336.80	191.41	-	-
Sika Interpl	1025.45	1014.35	1033.95	1039.00	1010.00	12.20	1359.40	870.10	-	-
Silver Tou.	140.59	140.49	141.50	144.80	138.86	261.02	1690.20	100.50	-	-
Simp.Inf [2]	242.85	245.50	242.90	255.00	241.00	73.28	317.70	136.00	44	247.45
Sirca Paint	408.05	410.10	409.00	416.30	409.00	138.31	539.00	385.00	-	-
SIS [5]	418.65	419.10